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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, November 12, 2025

Date	Wednesday, November 12, 2025
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	7h 48m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z_lRERsxSAo
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:00:29] good morning uh it's 9 a.m and i'll now call this meeting to order um i don't think we have anybody

[00:01:11] participating remotely this morning we are all present and accounted for i know mr monk is running units behind this morning but what we would like to do is go ahead and begin with item a please good morning president creasy superintendent gulligson and board members my name is amanda vetril i'm the director for the office of advanced learning and i'm pleased to be here this morning

[00:01:45] to discuss universal screening and its potential impact on students in the commonwealth do you want me to go through these slides okay sorry okay maybe our specific slides okay so while we're waiting if you all remember we requested some deeper information here about greener tools used

[00:02:23] across the state as identification tools for our gifted learners and so we have this wonderful presentation this morning ready for everyone thank you please note on the second slide the recommendation from the superintendent of public instruction and how the research from the the Fordham Institute and NAEP with regard to advanced learners reference in the October meeting continues to be relevant to this potential prescription first I would like to review the regulatory requirement related to screening as part of the gifted identification process

[00:03:00] in Virginia I believe this will help level set our conversation and create a clear distinction between screening and universal screening. In Virginia, per the gifted regulations, all school divisions are required to screen students annually for giftedness.

[00:03:18] This should include a review of all relevant assessment data for grades K through 12. As part of this screening, many divisions in the Commonwealth choose to offer a universal screener, which is the practice of assessing a particular grade level using an ability or aptitude assessment.

[00:03:36] Because a norm-referenced ability or aptitude test is a requirement for the gifted identification process in Virginia, divisions often use the universal screener assessment to fulfill this requirement. If a universal screener isn't offered, or in addition to a universal screener if it is, divisions should always use other data points to screen students for potential gifted referrals.

[00:04:00] I have listed a few commonly used data points on this slide, but this is certainly not a comprehensive list. Universal screening is a targeted way to talent scout and look for students with high ability. As stated, it is not a requirement in Virginia, but it is widely considered an evidence-based best practice. As someone who came from a school division with a universal screener, I can give a boots-on-the-ground perspective of how school personnel can use this data to look for talent. After the assessment is given, school staff, including teachers, school

[00:04:37] counselors administrators gifted resource teachers etc receive scores often reported in percentiles of students schools should use that data to look for high ability students in the building and start to move students into the talent pipeline exposing them to additional rigor accelerated content and perhaps referring them for the gifted identification process without this measure schools rely on teacher referrals parent referrals or other traditional assessments to grow the advanced learning pipeline in elementary school these tools are important

[00:05:13] and should be part of the discussion but there can be gaps what if a teacher has a bias in thinking that gifted means a student that always follows the rules but the screener shows that a second grade student who is sarcastic and doesn't pay attention is full of potential or the multilingual student who scores low on vowels due to the language barrier but has a 98th percentile score in the nonverbal section of the screener these are real life examples and these are the students that without a universal screener divisions may miss currently we know that about 86 school

[00:05:50] divisions in virginia as of 2024 practice universal screening most often using the cognitive abilities test or cogat or the naglieri nonverbal ability test often referred to as the in that as stated on the slide the remaining 45 school divisions are required to screen students but they are not required to test students using this type of assessment until an official referral has been made this creates disparity in how we nurture talent in the commonwealth depending on zip code some students receive the subjective measure of potential and others do not the next slide

[00:06:29] shows where the divisions that do not have universal screeners are located and as you can see most are in rural areas please note that this data was self-reported in early 2024 which may create a slight variation in the data for the current school year to give a bit of the national perspective i will share that most states do not require universal screening and if it is required most are unfunded mandates in my research and working with colleagues in other states i do want to note that south carolina is one of the few states that both mandates and funds excuse me

[00:07:03] two universal screeners to level set once more universal screening is best practice but it is ideal when coupled with using local norming practices which is looking for talent using top scores at the building or division level having a statewide screener would really allow my office to dig in and support divisions in using this data effectively and start building conversations about local norms to give a real life example many divisions have a percentile cutoff score they may use for gifted identification in some school buildings i have personally worked

[00:07:40] in there was not a single student that met that cutoff score that does not mean there were not advanced learners in that building so we must change the way we think about advanced learners in growing the pipeline. How can we shift thinking among our educators to look at top talent for their school building? How can we nurture the talent that does exist in every school building in Virginia? It may mean a gifted identification because Virginia uses multiple criteria and one test score cannot prevent a student from being in or out, but it may not mean a gifted identification.

[00:08:15] However, it does create an awareness of advanced students within a school building that need advanced opportunities this slide indicates the cost estimate for one grade level for purposes of the calculation second grade enrollment has been used as you can probably tell this is an area of passion for me and i would like to dig into the why of how i think this can advance education in virginia first this was mentioned at the last board meeting but having a statewide screener would benefit advanced students that have to move between divisions for various reasons and provide

[00:08:52] greater consistency of identification throughout the commonwealth to address the second and third bullet students that score in the high range on a universal screener should be students who are scoring high on state assessments and advancing into accelerated pathways for middle school and high school a universal screener provides the first data point to look at this vertical articulation of the advanced learner pipeline if high ability students are not moving into those pathways we can work with divisions to start asking where those gaps are and how additional support can be

[00:09:29] put into place to ensure that talent is not lost virginia has made so many gains in advanced learning and middle school and high school over the past few years but we need to continue to grow the pipeline of advanced learners in elementary school and i believe universal screening is an important part of that to close i would like to read a statement from the virginia advisory committee for advanced learning vacal this was a point of discussion at the meeting two weeks ago and received strong support president creasy and members of the board the virginia advisory committee for advanced learning strongly supports a board prescription on the standards of quality

[00:10:07] to require and fund universal screening for giftedness at grade 2 presented at the october board meeting as proposal three universal screening accompanied by the use of local norms is widely considered to be best practice in gifted identification vacal believes that early identification of high ability learners is critical to feed the pipeline of advanced learning in the commonwealth and serve the needs of virginia's students the committee also considers it important that a single universal screening tool should be used statewide and that such screener should be an established nationally normed aptitude test no assessment or data source

[00:10:45] currently employed statewide would be appropriate for this purpose repurposing existing data or attempting to establish a novel assessment tool would not appropriately fill the need for universal screening at grade 2. we encourage the board to support this step in supporting advanced learning in the

commonwealth respectfully mark levy chair of the virginia advisory committee for advanced learning and thank you so much for your time i'm happy to answer any questions and i have a couple of questions and i'm sure maybe dr northern does too um first of all thank

[00:11:21] you so much for this presentation um second of all i hope you had the opportunity to watch our discussion from last month and those um different questions that were brought up then um i guess just to start you know are there so personally i like the south carolina model i've looked at it watched it for years um i have family who teaches in south carolina and they have talked to me about this for years um so i think i'd like to get to a point where we're doing a screener that is able

[00:11:57] to identify ability and achievement i think that's probably something that's really critical because um i think that's the piece that we're really missing so in the school divisions that are using um the cogat or some kind of universal screener like that but we have many other divisions that are not are using something totally different i think it's sort of the wild west if you will as far as how we're identifying uh kids in this particular area um we have i guess what the long

[00:12:32] and short of our conversation last month was around we want to be able to compare apples to apples where right now we're comparing apples to oranges to grapes to bananas to whatever and so i think at the end of the day this board and i from we just what we discussed last month really wants to see some real unification as far as how all school divisions are doing both the subjective and objective measures i think there are perhaps some more guardrails that we can put up

[00:13:07] around how teachers are given the tools that they need to understand what gifted identification really looks like as you spoke to earlier they might just say you know oh well you know so and so seems to to be really on it and so maybe that that means they're gifted and while in fact it doesn't the other piece i think is really crucial is do we have a screener that we can address multi-language scenarios is there an opportunity for that is that out there yes so a few things

[00:13:46] about that i agree with all of your points um i my personal recommendation if this moves forward would be to advocate for a full battery universal screener which um would include a non-verbal component um also for some students when i was in my old school division it also allows them to test in their native language so there's really two two pieces that facilitate that okay um the i guess ultimately whatever guardrails what we put up i just really want to see how far we can go in

[00:14:22] eliminating that bias and identification because i think that's really a problem um and what else oh how are we able to connect all of this information gather the information and then connect it and use it for your purposes so would va connects be a means by which we could determine how many kids are being screened in a school division whether you know they have been identified by what means all of that is that available data to be received i know we're not

[00:14:58] collecting it necessarily now but so i i think so um currently we do collect a gifted annual report we do receive how many students are identified per school division um i think if with implementation of a universal screener we could really reimagine what the vertical articulation of data looks like divisions of course do record what students are identified so we could of course request some data seeing you know what that trajectory looks like as well as and i kind of reference this i think

[00:15:34] it's also really important to connect that data with if we have high ability students per that universal screener are they scoring advanced on on the standards of learning assessments and and if not

are are they going into you know accelerated math and and other courses in middle school and if not sort of where are the gaps how can we address them because i think there could potentially be a lot of underlying issues that exist that we don't know about now because we don't have that first data point yeah i really like that idea i'd love to see a list from you guys of just those

[00:16:08] kinds of data points that you think are really critical to not just you know screening kids but also because as a gifted teacher myself years ago i always said to my kids you should the expectation is that you will be scoring at least past, I expect past advance because of the position that you all are in. So I do think that data is really critical to the whole picture as well. So however we want to start pushing on that, I think that's great.

[00:16:45] I will also add to that, you know, typically most universal screeners have a pretty robust parent report that goes home. So I think it also invites parents into that conversation of you know your student is above average in this area and so that can really help divisions start a conversation about these are other opportunities. I am a full believer that the younger we start to have these conversations with families and in students about all the great advanced opportunities Virginia has the better. So one final question are we gathering any data on once students are screened

[00:17:20] they are identified um we had a number of school divisions several years ago that were doing holistic gifted programs when some students may be gifted in math others may be gifted in language arts or but they're all in the same cohort taking the same level of course or do we have data around whether or not school divisions are still doing that all-inclusive program of study versus a more in my opinion a more supportive means of educating those students where they are gifted

[00:17:56] rather than you know perhaps hurting them by putting them in a place that they're not i think we'd really have to collect that data i mean currently the areas of identification and the service options that divisions offer are really local decisions and so they're of course in a gifted local plan but we we could we could certainly work with the gifted coordinators to to talk about what specific services look like and how they are doing that and you know additionally there's quite a few divisions in the commonwealth that don't have gifted resource teachers so

[00:18:32] you know the entire gifted services are within the classroom um and and you know that that also creates just some disparity too dr northern thank you so much um i'm super excited about this obviously um a couple things that i think bear our consideration um you know i worked on this national advanced working group and the one thing that i think kept coming up is that we don't want a single age-based screening so we actually want to be able to identify have identification

[00:19:08] opportunities and as many grades as possible at elementary school to widen that pipeline um and it's best to have both norm referenced and criterion reference measures so the uh the co-get is a norm reference measure as you know so that's basically saying kids of the same age we can we can compare them nationally and we can have this like we wanted kids performing at a certain percentile right where the criterion reference test is okay these are predetermined sort of learning standards um and this is the content that all kids need to know and it's a benchmark

[00:19:40] so um we have the kindergarten readiness program the vkrp that's given to every single kindergartner and i think it's a wasted opportunity i mentioned this before um it is it would be a great compliment because one we're screening kids even earlier and we know that sometimes even grade two or

grade three kids are already not caught up in those services um so if we could have both a norm reference with the you know kogat or whatever we choose and we could use a vkrp for that

[00:20:12] hearing referenced at kindergarten um that i think would even be a more robust way to continue to um you know identify these kids because a lot of folks again they they they don't like that there's just one opportunity at second grade and then you miss it you know that's it so the way that we can move ahead is if we have a consistent i mean every time we have a consistent measure at a grade level that should be an opportunity to identify kids and you can also just do i mean one way that we widen that pipeline is just say it's the top 10 of the kids in a school absolutely local you have a local

[00:20:47] norming as well so um anyway that would be my suggestion i know it was you know in a way it it doesn't cost extra, right? We're already having the VKRP for kindergartners. So I hope that we can move that direction. I think that's a great direction, and I'm happy to reach out to Jenna's team and further that conversation. Other questions or comments here? Ms. McPherson?

[00:21:17] I also am in favor of the universal screening test at grade 2, but equally as concerned about universal screening at later grades especially at sixth grade for universal testing because we're talking about the 3E readiness and how are we going to start measuring what students are being attracted to I think clearly at the sixth grade level we need to make sure that those that were in the second grade that were identified whether they're on track whether they've fallen off track and others are now posted to do certain things so even if we don't do it every grade or don't have

[00:21:56] the funding to do it at every grade level. I do think that by the sixth grade, we need to have a universal screening. I would agree with that. I would say, I think the divisions in Virginia that have the most robust gifted identification programs have two universal screenings, one typically in the primary grades, and then one, you know, fifth, sixth grade. I think it varies a little bit per school division, but I would agree that is certainly best practice in an area I would like to eventually, you know, get to. So is there a model out that you all have on your website or

[00:22:35] how, you know, gifted coordinators or any other person in a school division that might have this responsibility, given the size of the school division, sort of a best practices handbook for them that could include that at least for now until we hopefully get this in place, you know, that says, look, because I know you saw how robust our conversation got last month where we talked about, hey, look, second grade's really not the only time. You know, a kid could just be advanced in language and score really well. We need to re-evaluate them. Maybe in, I know some schools, you know, they change, some is middle school seven, some middle school six, however they,

[00:23:15] however school divisions, you know, move from elementary to middle. But I do think that that's critical that they have a like ms mcpherson said you know that additional hey let's just double check here let's just go back and make sure that we're we're identifying them again putting these students in the right places um and uh so that that i think is just one really important piece is that if we don't get enough of this covered enough money to do this fully then i think that we should certainly have some sort of best practices manual that says please please do the

[00:23:53] right thing and have another opportunity for screening later on absolutely i think we could certainly develop some sort of technical resource document i think vacal could really be an integral part of that work absolutely that could be a good gone um and then one one thing i know um hope that jenna can run in here but i don't because i don't want to speak to this wrongly but just to address what dr

northern was talking about as far as vkrp i think the only hiccup there is going to be that in a lot of spaces across the state because we have such extensive public private partnerships

[00:24:33] in our early childhood programs not all of our private um early childhood providers are participating in vkrp and so that could be a problem and i saw jenna load in just now she she could speak to that. Jenna, are you hearing me? You know I was going to ask this question.

[00:24:51] I'm always hearing you, President Creasy. I was hearing you. No, I was just speaking about how isn't it still the case that not all private early childhood providers are participating in VKRP? So you know, we have a lot of private providers in those rural areas where we don't have enough EPI seats. So you know, that's just an extension. It could be a problem. I don't know how kindergarten is addressing it once they go into the public school division if that's a a gap that they're filling I don't know if you could speak to that for us yeah so currently uh we have Virginia

[00:25:29] kindergarten readiness program has been developed for three-year-olds and for four-year-olds it is required for all three and four-year-olds in the Virginia preschool initiative uh 25,000 kids uh across the commonwealth ballpark again much mostly four-year-olds so let's call it 20 22,000 or so four-year-olds, 3,000 three-year-olds.

[00:25:51] It's also required for the mixed delivery, so a small subset of children receiving preschool experiences in private child care. And then it is all kindergartners, and that's roughly about 80,000 to 85,000 kids a year required at the beginning at the end of kindergarten.

[00:26:09] They have a middle assessment as well that I believe is still optional. It covers literacy. The literacy component is vows. and as well as EMAS, which is the direct math assessment.

[00:26:24] And so what's good about that is it's done, each teacher does it or support staff does it with the kids versus like being on a computer or something like that. And then the teacher does a, the self-regulation and social skills is a behavioral rating scale.

[00:26:43] So you could use both the literacy and the math components. now we have kind of three buckets for um the preschool and so you look at sort of who's sort of emerging who's strong you could really you know i think they would be very cautious about high stakes attached to it because it's a very fluid developmental stage but you could start to see which kids are are particularly emerging and then i think and you all are familiar with this as are our colleagues in um teaching and learning but what is so important about vowels as compared to PALS is that it does capture much more about language and language comprehension.

[00:27:22] So, right, there's more likely that it could be part of a comprehensive package of understanding which kids are, you know, potentially have sort of greater content knowledge and more sophisticated thinking skills, right, versus PALS, which is much more just focused on decoding and things like, you know, you can be advanced at first letter sounds, but that's not necessarily as meaningful as a language type assessment. If I come out of a family day home, if my child comes out of a family day home, and then we are in public kindergarten, I will,

[00:27:58] or my child will eventually get to that point, just not early on. Yeah, and we track, and each year there's a report that goes forward in terms of who does not, but the numbers of kids who are in public school who do not participate are very, very, very small. And we're trying to expand. We do pay for preschool vkrp for anybody who is in vqb5 who wants it and so we've been really like so for example we've

been working really closely with head start because the head start program standards are you require an assessment there's it's a choice from the from the federal government but encouraging more and more folks to use preschool vkrp so we can understand that growth

[00:28:36] over time dr north i wonder too i mean we could just they're doing at the beginning the end of kindergarten right so we might even just wait and look at the one at the end of kindergarten you know maybe the first one shows promise and we're like oh yeah maybe we want to wait to see the second one is before we make a firmer decision um and i agree with you i i think we ought to concentrate on the literacy and the math because if i understand it the other component is you know mental well-being social skills that's what type of thing obviously important indicators but not what we would traditionally think as advanced um capability yeah it's things like uh persisting at

[00:29:15] at a task being curious my guess is that they would be somewhat predictive of a child's success or a student's success but I think it is harder it's also um more subjective because of it's a teacher evaluating that based on sort of a totality of behavior versus the emas and and vowels are um a little bit more norm referenced um I I think it we would we and we've sort of talked a little bit about this with with the goal of VA Connects is supporting folks to take in the multiple points

[00:29:49] across the the spectrum and because we do connect the state testing identifier over time you are also able to understand what the results are from the you know from the preschool VKRP through to VKRP, through to VGA, through to SOLs, right? All the letters. And that's really important. I know that you've seen the slide before connecting even the literacy screener, right, to third grade reading and being incredibly predictive. It is not published yet, but our professor colleagues at UVA

[00:30:26] have also looked at math. So even your EMAS or your math score at the beginning of kindergarten is highly predictive of your third grade reading so there's just there's really important data and i think we will continue to want to support the divisions to use that data to kind of understand sort of both you know who which kids are learning at higher rates i think it also is helpful to understand where there might be gaps right where if you sort of kid comes in very ready and then comes out of that year you know not making the gains that you would expect it sort of gives you you the opportunity to intervene. I think if you read that data, if you all are able to anonymize

[00:31:04] some of that just for the board's edification on like what does this full picture look like, because I think we do hear a lot of these, you know, tidbits of what kind of data that we collect here, but to be able to see student A and here is what, here is just the entire picture of their data from this from the start to and i don't know what year we've achieved at this point in va connects you're one okay well sort of two for for vows launched on va connects last year

[00:31:40] have to sort of absolutely visualize this right now absolutely and we can certainly could invite our colleagues from uva as well the other thing i should note is that the budget for the last few years has also required vkrp one to three to sort of begin to develop that um and really with the focus on obviously we already have vowels and have vowels through eighth grade so it's really focusing on a math assessment and then determining kind of what uh type of um uh behavioral uh scale rating scale you would want to use um you know the our colleagues at uva surveyed the field felt like

[00:32:15] there was not consistency and i can pull out that uh report in terms of even kind of assessment and screening kind of outside of valves across first and second grade third grade is a little bit more crowded um with the the vga but it does speak to the points raised earlier about a ton of variation and it

makes it really hard apples to apples to understand if we are laser focused sort of what we've been able to do with vla um to kind of getting kids to third grade reading you know it is harder to do that in the area of math because you have these moments as you noted

[00:32:52] dr northern where you see all the kids on math at the beginning in the kindergarten and then you know there's a lot of tools being used by our divisions but it's hard to then kind of track that statewide and then they just pop back up again for vgas yeah i just want to add i mean this could be a very big deal right to be able to use um vkrp in this way like we know like just so much data says like we have to catch kids earlier it's why we care so much about reading right like we're trying to do all these things around early early literacy we should be doing the same things around kids that showing potential for giftedness you know catch them earlier so they don't get lost

[00:33:30] so i don't know of any other state and i could be wrong that um that is using data to identify kids this early to intervene quickly because we should be intervening on the on the advanced front just like we're intervening on the kids that are struggling um so i think this is a phenomenal opportunity so thank you well and i know i'm going to go down a rabbit hole and you're going going to love this rabbit hole, but I also sort of along that technical slash best practices opportunity. I mean, is there not a way for us to say, guys, we've got all of these divisions doing 52 different, using 52 different assessments to identify this, that, and the other thing,

[00:34:09] you know, is there a way that we can really say, here are some good measures that we'd like for everybody to try to come together and use a little bit better because I guess my biggest problem is how we continue in this apples to oranges situation just with a plethora of opportunities out there and I get it it's about local control but at the same time we want good data and information on how we move students from one point to the next to the next to the next and

[00:34:47] and move them into greater and greater achievement levels so um i don't know what you guys think about that but i'm sure amber loves it but well i think outside of you know just technical assistance and providing professional development um what i'm hearing you say in my mind really goes to a gifted regulation change which of course you know those have not been updated since 2012 um and as they exist now they do require multiple criteria but divisions just have to choose at least three one of them does have to be a norm reference referenced assessment but we do not

[00:35:24] specify specifics of what they must choose and that is different than in other states there are other states that that do give divisions a list of you know assessments or teacher rating scales or whatever it may be that they have to to use right now that is pretty loose per the regulations but i think what i'm hearing you say would really require a regulatory change yeah and amanda if you would do us this favor i think perhaps the board might be interested in this too y'all yell at me if you aren't in this but what i'd like to see is your recommendation on any kind of regulatory changes that should happen in order to kind of tighten the guardrails a little bit

[00:36:03] there and maybe you need to take it to vacal i don't know but um you know the sooner the better okay yes i think vacal could certainly review some items they're a great stakeholder group we're fortunate to have them dr northern i'm sure it's commonly used assessments already just kind of the gold so i mean i'd be curious this is 86 use it the most commonly used then we at 45 so I'm assuming right we've already got a pretty broad um spectrum they're already using

[00:36:39] what what I think would be the recommendation so that's good news yeah anybody else here thank you I think I'm turning it over to Melissa for review of the language yes thank you if you would refresh your um agenda you should see I think another Melissa am I right okay yeah the standards of quality prescription documents there i don't think it's a presentation though right um it's just the

[00:37:19] report itself good you may have to refresh your screen because um it is an attachment to um today's item and it's also um item f attachment for tomorrow's thank you but you may have everybody there um so it's the attachment under item a or it's the what's it called item a attachment one yes good morning president creasy vice president hanson members of the board superintendent gallickson you didn't think you would get rid of me so easily did you

[00:37:56] i'm back again um today um i am presenting to you the draft soq report that needs to be transmitted to the assembly and the governor and it will also ultimately become part of your board annual report as well once you agree upon the content um the first page is just a transmittal letter that mrs creasy will sign on behalf of the board once you agree to the contents of the report so in the past few months we've been talking about your prescription items so i'm going to jump down to page three of the report and we you know we've gone over your constitutional authority many times

[00:38:35] so we we don't need to do that jumping down to page three of the report document you wanted to include from your previous prescriptions the student-weighted funding formula recognition that that that has seems to have stalled or at least slowed in the assembly that committee that's supposed to be working on that has not met for a while so um that recommendation is included as your primary recommendation prescription one to continue the work on the student-weighted funding formula um and much of the information is included from your 2023 prescriptions

[00:39:10] and unless as you as we go along if there are changes or additional information you want added please stop me and let me know i'm based on each prescription but this is again pretty much a reiteration of your 2023 recommendation that has not been achieved yet by the general assembly your second prescription again was to modernize the data collection system there was initially funding placed in a previous budget recommendation for that and that through the budget process and the general assembly process ended up being removed from the budget

[00:39:47] there were some modifications for instance to the virginia iep system um but the the modern student state statewide student information system was not achieved through the budgetary process so that again is a reiteration from your 2023 prescriptions that are very old very dated student information system is at end of life and really needs to be modernized and the funding that needs to be associated with that the original budget amendment was included in a a larger

[00:40:21] budget amendment to modernize a number of systems in state government from tax to dmv i believe as well as the statewide information system so while some funding was achieved for the other agencies our statewide information system was taken out of the budget so we that advocacy is included in your report again now moving on to the prescriptions that we discussed at length in your previous meetings the universal screener is in the prescription three that i've laid out there

[00:40:57] for you i've i've drafted the legislation to amend standard one of the standards of quality to add in the language that would mandate the universal screening, it's in red underlined language. SOQ1 is rather lengthy but it's in, let me find the page for you, it's on page 14 of the actual report, it's 16 of the pdf.

The red language is there and adding that mandatory language to the for the screening in second grade using the universal assessment prescribed by this

[00:41:36] board and if you scroll to the end of the document or the end of this legislative piece for SOQ1 you're going to see some additional red language that is an enactment clause that requires the board to amend its existing regulations so you can prescribe that assessment there and those regulations that they currently exist now there was a question about norm reference and criterion reference testing the current regulations do provide for the norm reference testing and so you'll be adding this universal screening process to those regulations um there's also the opportunity

[00:42:11] because it is you know the board has some broad discretionary authority in its regulations to prescribe changes to those regulations um if there are concerns about the referral process but there are a number and amanda's here there there's three criteria that can be used in those regulations there's not just one um criteria but um amanda will be integral in the development of those regulations so it achieves the you know the board's desires to include making sure we're testing kids at other ages but there's nothing in your regulations currently that prevents recognition

[00:42:48] and evaluation and referral of gifted students so they can test children now at fourth grade and fifth grade but it's a voluntary testing we budgeted out the cost estimate for your universal screening at grade two and that came to be 1.74 million dollars. And so I did hear the discussion about mandating the sixth grade screening. So if that is something you do want to mandate, we'll have to go back and do some estimates to determine the fiscal impact of that because you will be putting it in the SOQ. Budget language has already been prepared for the 1.74

[00:43:26] four million dollar um request because yes the process is the budget language has to go to the department planning and budget in the governor's office and your soq prescriptions have to go to the assembly and legislation has to be um patroned and and successfully pass the assembly to amend the soq so it's a two-step process so we want to make sure the budget language achieves what you want as well as the statutory language so if you want us to go back and cost out um the one point in addition to the 1.74 million we can do that or you can possibly put the recommendations to

[00:44:02] test uh at grade six in your regulations that would not be funded in particular because it wouldn't be in the soq but um i don't in the superintendent you know can tell you if there are any other budgetary concerns i can't speak to but um you know you do have re-benchmarking coming up and uh so those are things to consider but i just need to hear from you if you want me to go back and either mandate it at grade six or if you want to consider it in your universal um in your the document you want the best practices document or your regulations to recommend uh

[00:44:37] additional testing at sixth grade dr northern just wondering why we can't use our s i mean our standardized test in sixth grade and i'll leave that to the answer the regulations currently require um nationally norm-referenced tests to be used for identification i mean they certainly can be used for screening they should be used for screening but for formal gifted identification

[00:45:15] thinking out loud here which is often dangerous um when we possibly have a better chance of just getting the second grade screener um passed than an additional screener at sixth grade i think that if we create some sort of technical assistance manual that strongly encourages the use of you know for continued identification and maybe that's how we would want to um the sort of the language we would want to use is continued identification um not necessarily the term identification so

[00:45:54] maybe we need to define that somewhere amanda um to use sol data that may be the way that we get around that or adding it to the regulation somehow as well i do think you can add the sol data use that's already being done given the tests are already being given they're already paid for the the assessment contract and then they can be utilized for another purpose at least put in the toolbox of the school divisions in those regulations so they're not limited thought and the regulations do kind of have a catch-all to use other valid and in procedures um and so that that

[00:46:33] That language essentially is a catch-all, but they could rely on that now to use SOL testing. They wouldn't have to wait for any regulatory changes. However, it's always best to make things specific in a regulation on its face. So we could add that language as we go through the regulatory process.

[00:46:50] And perhaps whatever you just spoke of, the other, is there a way for us to sort of require the division if they're going to use another mechanism for them to let the department know what they're using or not? I mean, if you put it in your regulations, you can put a reporting requirement in there.

[00:47:12] And I certainly will defer to our OAG if I'm misspeaking. But I do think that because you have the regulatory authority, because right now the language in the regulation is additional valid and reliable measures or procedures. So it depends. I don't know if you have a data collection mechanism currently um but you do have an audit provision in the in the statute i don't know how if you're auditing all school divisions every year but you certainly don't you think we would want to know i think we probably need to have a not necessarily approval but a mechanism

[00:47:46] for gathering those additional procedures that school divisions are using to do that if we can add that piece to the regulation your your recommendation for us sure i mean i'm happy so currently we we do have a gifted annual report divisions report on services they uh they offer qualifications of their gifted coordinator and then just raw data about the number of you know students identified students referred etc and we do have a review process with their gifted

[00:48:21] local plans it's a technical review process but it's more of a peer review process at this point it's not one where we are pulling out specific pieces of data i think we'd have to kind of reimagine what that would look like but i think that's really helpful and valuable data to know i can also go back in the enactment clause and put that in your um a prescription that in the enactment clause that the board shall include a data collection measure in there so that we can put that in the regulations and it'll be part the enactment clauses is part of the acts of assembly

[00:48:55] so that would be in there that'd be great anything else on this one you good dr norther no we're just on this this particular item is is that does that express the desire of the board and i can move on to the next item okay so again as you scroll down to the end of that legislative piece that is where the enactment clause is on page let me get you there just in case and then again it simply says that you know the board shall amend its regulations to comply with the conditions of this act and it's

[00:49:34] on page 24 of the report itself and 26 of the pdf so I will add into that enactment clause that the board shall include in its regulations data collection and I'll work with Amanda to get the correct language that will get the kind of data collected that you will need to assess the screening process whether the universal screener continues to the one that you prescribe is what works for you because you may have to go in later and change regulations if you find that you're not collecting the data that you need or that the assessment is not what you need so but yeah for

[00:50:10] the purposes of this I will add that to that red language so moving on to the the next item the student safety item that you talked about with the the need to renew the background checks of existing employees that that currently is in early childhood but it's not in the k-12 environment so um as we talked about that piece is not in the soq but you were going to submit as part of your report um a a recommendation for a legislative package for an amendment to that

[00:50:42] section of the code about background checks so on page 25 of the report i see drafts began amending that section of code 22.1 296.2 and if you scroll down again you will find red language adding a subsection d to page 27 that will that in order for the folks to remain employed they have to submit to that renewal of the background check that school divisions are required to conduct it and it will be from the date of employment so the school divisions aren't having to do you know

[00:51:18] background check in so many background checks at one time they'll be a rolling basis where they'll do it from the date of employment it will apply to all temporary part-time and full-time personnel just as the initial background check does the school divisions will be able to pay for that or they'll be able to apply it to um to the cost of up to the personnel um it will happen at um and i added it to subsection d uh and a subsection e so that it applies um as well to searching the

[00:51:54] database for found a complaint um cases of child abuse and neglect um that is there as well in order to capture renewal hopefully the um social services is notifying school divisions of that but there could be things that occur in other states or that we make sure we're aware of and background check and checking of the database may ensure that something doesn't get through so that again is the legislation that I've drafted for you and if I don't I'll throw it

[00:52:29] out there if there are any suggested changes you want to the background check legislation can i ask you a question i might be missing it on subsection e do we have to say do we have to repeat the every five years like we do in d um i i did it as a repetition because d applies to the background check that goes through the central criminal records exchange and um e applies to the back to the um database search right um so that's why i set it out in two separate sections so we wouldn't have to repeat that the child abuse and neglect search needs to happen every five years too

[00:53:08] well i felt that you did um it may be that we can i can go back and i felt that it needed to be set set out separately so it's very specific in the statute on its face so in other words e would would require every five years despite the fact that it doesn't say it explicitly is that right um i can go back and repeat that in there we probably should those two checks need to happen at the same time only because um i mean we see the issues with cps and so those child abuse and neglect searches are just as important as the fingerprint check and is every five years for

[00:53:47] that database because there's a cop more of a cost associated with the background check than there is the um ten dollars for the child abuse and neglect um well it's actually it could be more it could be up to forty dollars depending on whether they maintain a copy of the fingerprints and whether it the type of check that gets run um but and we've we've costed that out as a potential cost but for the back for the um checking of the child um neglect and um found a complaints database is five years what you want or do you want something more often no i think i mean unless the board thinks that five years is sufficient i think every five years is sufficient

[00:54:25] run it and coincide it with the fingerprint it just makes it easier from an uh administrative standpoint. Okay, I'll go back and make sure that we repeat that there. And the only other thing that I have

a question about, and you will remember this likely, when these were required to be done through DSS, remember that when DSS changed to field print, there was like a five or six year period that the checks were paid for not through the school division can you do a little research

[00:55:03] there jenna might know a little bit more about some of that intricate details and maybe even jeff too okay um but that's worthy of us looking at because this is going to be potentially you know a fiscal hit on the local school division as well so i want us to make sure that we're looking at the do you remember that um yeah well i will say that when we've explored this that is a fiscal not only is it fiscal but the hris systems that we have don't always easily crack it right it's

[00:55:42] oftentimes a necessity of yeah and the information you know yourself but i'm not i'm not married to that idea i just wanted to know the impetus was there and how that was handled back then um but potentially the sheer volume might decrease the cost dr ackerman you good i think i think volume wise you know there's a means by which that can be handled financially in a

[00:56:16] different way other questions or concerns here dr northern i have something potentially new or the or the or prescription oh so not not this that's okay so we get through first so i will get with jeff to see if they have any inside yeah thanks and i will add in the five-year

[00:56:49] petition in the paragraph and then finally the student safety concerns that you um talked about previously was about the um appointment or election of a school board member who may have uh some misdemeanor charges that didn't preclude them from uh running for the local school boards and a heightened scrutiny of individuals who would serve on school boards in terms of their contact with children and some background checks related to that and the last discussion we had

[00:57:22] was that of course the board could not make those changes to the soq to create those heightened protections so the idea was to communicate the board's concerns to the listed members potentially from the governor to the secretary of administration to the chairs of the privileges and elections committee and so um to authorize the chair the board president to do that i've included it in your report as a report to the assembly that that's your plan so unless anything's changed from that

[00:57:55] or you have additional items that you would like added to that letter and i will once you approve the report I will work on the draft letter for the president to sign is there anything additional Dr. Northern just um and I should have said this when you were on this item just clarifying things on the student-based formula section I'd love to signal to them one thing they could be looking at is to embed teacher comprehension I mean teacher compensation reform in the school finance formula

[00:58:34] what we're actually seeing is some a couple states that are because it can be very um dicey to talk about teacher compensation reform they're embedding in the school finance formula that the poorer a a campus is a school the more those teachers will get paid so now how that's i mean texas is one that's done this already and there's got all this you know uh documentation about how to do it but i do think that's one thing that they should be planning for and looking into and i just like to um kind of flag that for them um because i think it's a really promising compensation reform

[00:59:10] and we talk a lot about how teachers who go into high need schools and are teaching struggling kids that they should be paid more and this is a way actually that's pretty exciting that states have figured out um you know a potential way to do that so i would just flag that for him um the other thing is just on page 14 do we need to mention the vkrp since that's not a new that's not a monetary addition so i thought

maybe maybe it didn't need to be added on page 14 where we have the red line for the second grade do we need to mention potentially the vqrp in kindergarten

[00:59:46] i mean in my opinion that would be somewhere where you would put the regular in the regulations rather than in here but if you desire it here i will put it up it's fine and my other one my potentially new addition just wanted to talk through this um i'd love to signal our belief this board's belief in high expectations so i wonder whether it couldn't be something like you know mandate transparent review process going forward periodically with subject matter experts to ensure continued alignment to nationally benchmark standards something like that is that

[01:00:24] a place where this should be done could be done in terms of a process that we make transparent relative to i feel like i'm personally concerned right that there could be some slippage right and i think if there's going to be a process by which we revisit this that we should make sure it's transparently done and and that it's periodically um you know done and reviewed now just to clarify do you mean in terms of the soq itself or the gifted program or i think just similar to the um plan that we've talked about in the finance so it's like a plan that this board right would

[01:01:04] continue to evaluate the alignment to nationally benchmark standards so i'm just asking the board whether that's appropriate to signal that attention or not in a document like this i think maybe that's suited for the strategic plan perhaps um i think that signals well enough there um and i think our work to enhance that document that will take place in what december i think a little bit more

[01:01:40] strongly that that might be a good place for us to do a little bit more narrative around that um and and certainly um would give the strength to to that statement and just to support that um this board has that authority to do that all the time anytime and um if the general assembly doesn't know that already um that would be you would be hard pressed to communicate it any better than you already do when the work you do but that's lies within your constitutional authority already and so i mean we certainly can make a statement in your comprehensive plan that that's

[01:02:17] going forward for the you know that that's going to be what you um continue to do um but statutorily you don't need that anywhere in the soq you already have it thank you yeah i've always struggle with oh this particular document how it works thank you anything else that anyone has to add here thank you miss Velasquez I know we'll make some tweaks and have the new document ready for you tomorrow what we're gonna do at this point is take a five-minute break and then we will go into closed

[01:02:56] session to handle our licensure matters okay hey we are back and mr. Hanson we

[01:19:48] please read us into closed session move that the Virginia Board of Education EDUCATION CONVENE IN A CLOSED MEETING FOR THE FOLLOWING PURPOSES: DISCUSSION OR CONSIDERATION BY THE BOARD OF EDUCATION OF INFORMATION RELATING TO THE DENIAL, SUSPENSION, OR REVOCATION OF TEACHER LICENSES SUBJECT TO THE EXCLUSION, SUBDIVISION 11 OF SECTION 2.2-3705.3 PURSUANT TO SECTION 2.2-3711A40 OF THE CODE OF VIRGINIA AND CONSULTATION WITH COUNCIL REGARDING SPECIFIC legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant to virginia code section two point

[01:20:23] review dash three seven one one eight of the code of virginia and the legal counsel to the virginia board of education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter

participate in the closed meeting so moved okay dr ackerman aye mr green aye mr hansen mcpherson hi miss kilgore ashton hi mr monk hi and chair votes aye we are now in closed

[01:20:54] session thank you you're back mr hansen will you read our certification to return to open session

[01:30:56] please we convene today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure

[01:31:32] that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes dr ackerman aye mr green aye dr northern hi mr hanson all right miss mcpherson aye miss kilgore ah miss ashton aye mr monk aye chair votes aye okay um in case 2025-42 the chair will entertain a motion to issue a license so moved any discussion dr ackerman aye miss ashton

[01:32:11] Hi. Mr. Green? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. McPherson? Aye. Mr. Monk? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. And chair votes aye. Thank you very much. That concludes our executive session wrap-up there, and we will move to item B, which is the K-12 student enrollment overview, and Ms. Berta.

[01:32:42] thank you good morning president creasy members of the board superintendent gulickson this morning we are here to share some information with you on the virginia k-12 enrollment and historical view this is a collaborative presentation between myself and deputy superintendent of budget and finance stacy longest and dwayne mcclary deputy superintendent of innovation student pathways and opportunities as you look at the agenda for today we're going to review the enrollment trends and staffing levels across Virginia take a look at what the enrollment trends have been statewide

[01:33:22] look at the enrollment highlights by division also look at the highlights by region look at the birth rate trends in Virginia taking a look ahead at what our enrollment projections look like for the future and then some solutions and future planning for our school division partners on slide three as you look at the slide that was shared from dr rosa's computer screen is not

[01:33:55] moving up here are you good you've got it awesome there we go slide three one more slide awesome um on this slide as dr rosa shared with the board in july the enrollment trend in virginia is on a decline while staffing levels in virginia have increased over the same time period there have been record investments in public education and we are working with divisions to ensure best practice and use of the funds as this slide shows declines are in the early ages which indicates falling

[01:34:31] birth rates a deeper drop in k-12 k-2 students suggest a downward enrollment trend that won't change anytime soon and there is a brief bubble in the birth rates during 2019 and 2020 which will attribute to kindergarten students in 25 and 26 but then show a sign of declining again as dr rosa shared in the transition years being kindergarten sixth grade and ninth grade it could indicate that families are opting for other choices whether that be private schools charter schools or homeschooling their students also in a recent article that dr rosa published she noted that

[01:35:08] nationally we should expect expect a decline in enrollment each year of a half of a percent stacy Longus will now share some additional enrollment trend data with you from March 31st of 2015 to March 31st of 2025. You can go to slide four. Before the pandemic, statewide enrollment patterns in Virginia closely aligned with birth trends, offering a relatively stable and predictable

[01:35:43] outlook. However, the onset of COVID-19 disrupted that trajectory, leading to a sharper decline of nearly 40,000 students in public K-12 schools and introduced a new era of uncertainty and complex enrollment dynamics. Today, two opposing forces shape the landscape, a decade-long decline in birth rates and a modest rebound in school enrollment following the 2020 drop.

[01:36:10] These competing trends have made forecasting and future enrollment increasingly challenging. As we approach fall 2025, we will be closely monitoring average daily membership, also called ADM, data for emerging shifts and signals in enrollment trends.

[01:36:28] Slide five, please. The chart highlights the five school divisions with the most significant changes in average daily membership between 2015 and 2025, based on March 31st actual reporting.

[01:36:47] Fairfax County experienced the largest decline in ADM with a decrease of 6,921 students represented in red. Loudoun County saw the greatest increase, adding 8,306 students shown in blue from 2015 to 2025.

[01:37:09] They are currently seeing a decrease where neighboring school divisions have been seeing an increase based on some recent articles regarding Prince William. Slide six, please. So between 2015 and 2025, student enrollment trends show growth in regions three and four, while regions one, two, and five through eight experience declines.

[01:37:39] The most significant increases occurred in northern Virginia and to the east, whereas the Tidewater region saw the steepest drop in student count. Can we go to the previous slide really quickly?

[01:37:56] I would really be interested to know, and this is probably something for the whole team, what the LCI is in these localities, because that's a really important piece to this puzzle. I mean, it wouldn't be the first time in some of these divisions that are showing some increases that there has been a little bit of exaggeration in some cases based on that LCI issue.

[01:38:30] So I'd really, you know, in future presentations, maybe like to see how that measures up. Just want to make that comment. Mr. Hanson. This is maybe a little unrelated, but even going back to slide three, I would like to have the red line bifurcated of the number of employees and how many teachers versus how many administrative personnel.

[01:38:57] I just, I want to, I think this slide would be more helpful to understand what the growth rate in teachers has been and also the spread is for the administrators. Sorry, we might jump in from time to time.

[01:39:18] No worries. This is my first time. so this is definitely longest first time doing a presentation so um don't get too much fire but here we are all right are we good to move on i'm sorry um right region two obviously is showing the most significant decline and i say as you indicated that's the hampton roads region is it possible for you at some point to give us the data as the by city the hampton roads region so we can see exactly and at some point you know down the road i'd like to compare what our

[01:39:56] expenditures have been in that area to the decline and to begin to see you know what resources we put into the area compared to the decline that we're seeing here in terms of just enrollment yes ma'am i'd also like to add to that and maybe this is a little bit deeper for you miss mcpherson but if we're seeing such a decline in enrollment i'd like to see what the decline in employment is then so in other words is are we matching so if we've lost six almost 17 000 students here

[01:40:31] is that are we also seeing a decline in you know the number of staff that's also there i do think and i hear you loud and clear we're happy to get that data i do think for sharing one of the things that is attributing to region two specifically during the 2015 to 2025 time period is changes on our military bases because a lot of those school divisions are linked to the transition that happens from our military bases and since that time we've had some closures or downsizing at the federal level by way of military bases shipyards etc so i i don't want to say that's

[01:41:08] a firm but by being a practitioner in the tidewater region i saw that myself by working in some of of those school divisions over this time period. So I do think there's an additional attributing factor that doesn't exist in the other regions across the state so extensively like it does in Hampton Roads. Is that something that we could, are those numbers just from a sheer population standpoint available? You know, so for example, you know, does, you know, does the Secretary of wars department keep that kind of information about population shifts from those military

[01:41:45] branches? I don't know for sure. We certainly could ask, but we also could look at census data in the same time period to see if we could link pieces of data together to come up with a synopsis for you. Mr. Mott? I appreciate it. Also, too, looking at the five divisions, I think maybe another way to look at that, too, by percentage of ADM, what that growth looks like. I think there's of smaller divisions that are probably experiencing some great percentage growth as well and and don't want to do another plug here but i know this is a lot of requests for data and knowing that we pull

[01:42:23] data only a few times a year and and we've kind of got some different systems that's the edgenomics in here and and census data that i hear you i think this is just another reminder that we might be able to to act a little quicker on some of these not just a couple times a year if we've got actionable data that's good and we've got a system that collects that because right now we're getting a lot of requests that we've sent your way just in the past five minutes that i think if we had a unique system and a statewide system we'd be able to pull that information that data set real quick so i appreciate the work to gather the data and the systems that we have to have now but just want to remind the board that i think this is a great opportunity for us to

[01:43:00] really provide future boards and the agency with some real real-time data that will allow the board to act quickly. And I also think that I'm particularly interested in the in the drop because it's going to have a carryover effect in terms of space availability, consolidation of schools, closures of schools, so that we'll be able to see like who's asking for money versus what the enrollment is. So going forward, we'll have some additional data for that. Great. We'll get that

[01:43:36] information for you. On slide seven, Virginia birth rate trends from 2015 to 2024 revealed a steady decline with a brief uptick during the pandemic years of 21 and 22. This uptick provides slightly higher kindergarten enrollments in the 2025 and 2026 and next year in the 26 and 27 school years.

[01:44:06] these birth rates serve as a critical indicator for school divisions informing enrollment projections that directly influence staffing levels and funding allocations across communities it is

anticipated that birth birth rates will continue to decline in future years if you go to the next slide taking a look at the future projections i was able to find a study that was done by our partners at weldon cooper through uva on what the demographic projection looks like

[01:44:43] for k-12 students over the next several years and you can see from that chart um on your slide there is a significant decline expected and anticipated by over 30 000 students by 2029 so this is definitely an area where we will continue to monitor and closely support because this is the key driver of our state budgets by way of funding because this is one of the common metrics that we use to allocate funding to schools so that is linked in the slide projection too if you'd like to nerd out on their demographic table you can do that you can see it by region but did want to

[01:45:22] provide you what the landscape looks like moving forward so moving to the next slide as we've talked about significantly today but you've also heard the superintendent and many of our presentations recently talking about trends and headlines and just seeing how some of our school divisions across the commonwealth are needing some support and to help them to noodle through some things that they have not had to experience in recent history and so we are working this will take a little bit of time but it is our commitment to work on a toolkit for school divisions to help

[01:45:59] provide better technical support, policy considerations that they should think about. Our span of control is limited, but we want to be good partners to help provide that landscape and support for school divisions. We are also, as many of you have indicated, trying to look for that root cause and figuring out why families don't want to be in our public schools. Is it academic concern? Is it transportation routes? Is it school climate? Are there some other things that we should be building into our toolkits to help mitigate that student loss for our public school systems. And also there are a few school divisions that have gotten creative with the

[01:46:35] virtual Virginia system and are trying to persuade homeschool students to be part of their virtual Virginia platforms because then they get the state revenue for the ADM. So we have seen that shift happening as well as a creative solution and how to plan for the future. I'm going to allow dwayne mcclary to share some other solutions and future planning options yes ask a couple questions first um number one with home school students counting towards adm through use of virtual virginia isn't that only if they are full-time virtual virginians so if they're taking one

[01:47:13] class here one class there that's not applicable that's correct okay so just clarifying that second of all in the root cause analysis how are we able to potentially use the statutory school climate type survey that was required years ago i remember senator mcclellan actually um patron that legislation is there a means by which we can use that to help um analyze or at least dig for some of these root causes to try to grab that information yes the the dcjs school climate

[01:47:49] survey still happens um that is an area where we can look i don't think it's going to be one comprehensive answer i think it's going to be very regionally based um and that's something that we want to look at too to see if we can see themes in certain areas and pockets of the state um to help support the toolkit and i mean because quite honestly if we're just looking at migration of military personnel there's really nothing that any of us in this room can do anything about nor is it you know the ability any ability for local school divisions there to do anything about either just a fact but if there are other circumstances that we can address yes dr northern i would just

[01:48:28] say in the toolkit as you think about putting that together and you probably already know this but marguerite rose's edunomics has done amazing work around um not necessarily consolidating because that's really politically tough um but how schools can she calls it learn to be small so in other words you know two schools can share administrative staff like a principal at both schools um and she's got a bunch of other suggestions um but i really do think that given the politics around this some of her suggestions around learning to be small

[01:49:04] would be helpful for the toolkit as well thank you for that and uh stacy and i were at our recent professional development and heard from iowa who actually did job sharing so that is something that i'd like to partner with some of our other states to see how they've done it well to bring some of that to virginia i think we just go through the motions sometimes and we just have to start thinking more creatively and differently to help our our school districts next slide please next

[01:49:38] slide so here are a few solutions that we're actually looking at promoting to these districts after we look at the kind of the root cause analysis we're also looking at some best practices and also looking at supporting districts with those who are actually asking for how do we become more marketable to for our students and our parents so a few of these solutions are seat time flexibility so really reimagining and looking at the statutes we have in place for the waivers that can waive the 140 hours like being able to reimagine what that could look like

[01:50:12] in a work-based atmosphere, in a competency-based progression. We're also looking at the small learning communities. So this allows a more personalized cohort where larger schools could actually utilize and pull more class grades and bands together to actually consolidate resources to be able to be sustainable moving forward. And also looking at the connected pathways, and this could be around the future-ready skills, project-based learning, apprenticeship, and military participation kind of goes, dubs very well for our three models.

[01:50:47] Dual enrollment is definitely something that we're looking to help districts look more at, so helping them understand how are they helping our high school students earn college credit and make themselves more attractive to families and more cost-efficient post-secondary opportunities.

[01:51:04] And ultimately, also looking at some options for districts around out-of-zone and open enrollment for districts uh to be able to help support them in moving forward so those are just a few solutions and best practices that we're looking at to be able to promote and share with districts and divisions uh to help them with their enrollment opportunities and i'll now turn it back over to christina yes sir um i'm sorry christina but um this listening and reviewing the presentation thus far and we're talking about best practice toolkits in terms of how we can reverse these

[01:51:42] enrollment trends and actually improve enrollment have we considered more of how to incorporate education options as a solution to potential solution in terms of reversing these trends very specifically right charter schools i meant you mentioned home schools that's great but charter schools specifically how school districts and school divisions can utilize this to invite them become more marketable of the parents wanting to enroll their children in public schools i think with the new division that i'm leading that's the goal the goal is to share all the options that we

[01:52:22] have charter schools lab schools all the available options so our goal is to magnify that and ultimately support districts and what their root causes are and help them identify what those root causes are and understand what are the solutions and actually funding models that we have available to help

them move forward right so kind of what i'm hearing that i guess perhaps maybe sometime within the next city 60 days as we work to perfect what these toolkits look like correct that it could potentially include what i just kind of recommended in terms of charter schools as a potential option to give kids in the school system so that would be an option included in it thank

[01:52:59] you all right moving to slide 11 just a couple of other operational solutions and future planning opportunities is one being transportation modernization and working with school divisions to reimagine and modernize what student transportation looks like to allow for greater flexibility and to eliminate barriers to student access i think you've heard superintendent gullickson's passion about transportation and so i know we will be working on that over the next several weeks additionally school construction and facilities planning this ties right into your school construction assistance program and trying to revamp those guidelines to allow for that

[01:53:37] innovative creative thought partnership to leverage dollars that are available to them from the state so those are two additional solutions that we are going to work through in a toolkit to help provide next steps and by way of next steps moving to slide 12 we are working to prepare for December's re-benchmarking presentation to the board that will be delivered to you on December the 11th in a reflection of what the next biennial budget looks like.

[01:54:09] We are in the process as we were developing this slide deck still had not had complete closure from school divisions on their fall record collection for their student enrollment and so in order for us as a team to be able to process what fall enrollment impacts are for the budget that is an important piece and so we've been shaking down the phones emails all of that with several school divisions who needed to get their data locked down in order for us to be able to provide final data for policy decision making process so we are unable to continue that until that is done and we will continue to shake the trees on that so you will know all of this is

[01:54:48] reflective as of March 31st 2025 you will know no later than your January 8th meeting we're hoping at the December meeting if we can get clearance to share all of that information what the actual fall enrollment looks like this year to see if it is in line with what Weldon Cooper's projection showed with that still steep decline happening so more to come on that front we just aren't in a position to share that with you today but we hope this was helpful and if there are any follow-up questions. We're happy to answer those. Question for you. On slides 10 and 11, I know you guys are talking about solutions here. Is there a means, this is going to be the theme of the day, I feel

[01:55:28] it coming through. Is there a means by which we can hold another technical assistance type document that talks about the best practices in these particular areas? Because I do think that divisions need a resource to shepherd them here. And so, you know, the more, you know, we're not telling them what to do, but the more that we can provide them the resources to be better, do better, and more, then I think that there's that opportunity, you know, again,

[01:56:02] technical assistance document type thing. Yeah, how I envision that is the toolkit would have one-pagers that folks could really pull very quickly to do they could do to help make them better as a resource so that that's how i kind of envision that toolkit so that it's very it can be broken up and not overwhelming that's what we want to avoid thank you other questions or comments here thank you miss burda thank you team okay so before we move to item c do we need to take

[01:56:38] a quick break so that presentations can get set up is that right hold for a tech moment i think no Do you need a, is it locked in up there for your item?

[01:56:55] They should have it. Okay. Are we okay?

[01:57:14] Provide an overview of the Virginia College Partnership Lab Schools and the proposed contract modification for you.

[01:57:41] Before we delve into the proposed contract modification, we'll do a high-level overview for myself and Dr. Karen Sanzo will be also joining us, and I'll introduce her shortly. Virginia Lab Schools are transforming education through innovation and strategic partnership by expanding access to high-quality, career-aligned learning opportunities across the Commonwealth.

[01:58:05] Designed and operated by Virginia institutions of higher education, these schools are built in collaboration with business and industry to align academic programming with regional workforce needs. With a strong focus on career pathways and real-world readiness, the Lab School Network currently represents more than 60 school districts statewide and is projected to serve over 5,000 students in the next two years, positioning Virginia as a national leader in educational innovation and workforce development.

[01:58:40] Go to slide two, please. Next slide. The lab school initiative has successfully transitioned to full operation status and continues to rapidly expand across the Commonwealth.

[01:58:57] All 15 lab approved lab schools are now open and operating, establishing a comprehensive statewide network in partnership with over 60 Virginia schools and 20 colleges and universities. As of 2025-2026 academic year, the network's enrollment exceeds 3,800 students. This scale underscores the network momentum and projected impact, which is set to affect over 5,000 students over the next four years, directly supporting the Commonwealth's long-term workforce development goals.

[01:59:35] I would now like to share a few examples of successful sustainability efforts that the lab schools have accomplished. As lab schools implement their plans to enroll sustainability, to ensure sustainability of their students and programs beyond the startup grant funding, schools have shared multiple strategies they are using to expand their income and also in-kind support.

[01:59:58] For example, Code RVA, which is with the Virginia Commonwealth University, has secured $1.5 million in funding from the Scarborough Family Foundation to support teacher residency staffing. This investment is augmented by sustaining corporate collaborations from CarMax and the Herndon Foundation, which helps expand access to dual enrollment opportunities.

[02:00:21] Together, these efforts demonstrate a diverse philanthropic portfolio that supports both operational and institutional components. The Smith Tech School of Computer Science innovation and design at old dominion university has established corporate partnerships with svt robotics domas technologies and canon ist and life net health to co-fund bike nights and other family engagement stem events this collaborative between the philanthropic and industry partnership is directly connected to the regional workforce sectors and enhanced community visibility and

[02:00:59] ensuring that the supporting provided by the financial sustainability and meaningful alignment. Another example that we have that is going well is with the data and science computing application lab with George Mason University. This program has documented a $250,000 HVAC investment

and transportation service provided by Frederick County along with tuition subsidies and teacher professional development support from gmu this in-kind supports integrates higher education

[02:01:36] local government and technical infrastructure serving as a model for shared capital investment those are just a few of the great opportunities that we're seeing and sustainability models that we're seeing from our lab schools next slide please next slide please i would now like to introduce dr karen sanzo the executive director of the center of educational innovation and opportunity old dominion university old dominion university serves as a critical and strategic partner managing

[02:02:15] the largest lab school system in the nation through its center of educational innovation and opportunity the odu led nine school network is designed to create explicit pathways for k-12 to higher education and careers in high demand sectors this network includes four odu operated sites focused on aerospace maritime systems computer science and integrated stem these programs are supplemented by partner schools at mounting uh gateway emory and henry rona college

[02:02:51] paul d camp and jumanna community college i would now like to turn it over to dr sanzo who will go into more detail that's why i skipped a slide about a lot of the successes that are happening with the lab schools dr sanzo thanks hi good morning and thank you so much for the opportunity to come and speak to you today i serve as the executive director for the odu center for educational innovation and opportunity and i also come to you as a career educator in virginia i started my career as a middle school math teacher at sims middle school in hampton and this is my

[02:03:29] 28th year working in public ed in virginia and this really is the most exciting point of my career and being able to work with all the lab schools at the center as mentioned we support the 15 college partnership lab schools across the state as they help drive educational innovation we work with divisions and higher ed partners and industry partners and others as we learn about emerging and best practices engage in research and development and help build sustainable partnerships that strengthen the future of public education in virginia our goal is to not only innovate with the lab schools, but to ensure what we learn scales across the Commonwealth. And so the lab schools

[02:04:08] function as research and development engines, identifying what works, refining it, and then sharing the models and tools and insights across the state so every student and educator can benefit. Today, as you heard, we have so many different school divisions that are partnering with 20-plus institutes of higher education to design and implement and innovate career-connected learning environments that meet the unique needs of their regions.

[02:04:33] In addition to all of the K-12 and higher ed partnerships, we are also authentically collaborating with industries across the Commonwealth. Lab school students are experiencing health care firsthand in hospitals, exploring aerospace at NASA Wallops, partnering with Huntington Ingalls Industries and Newport News Ship to learn about careers in shipbuilding and welding, working with QED systems and marine engineering and industrial services, and partnering with Birdsong Peanuts with our youngest learners to study the journey from farm to peanut butter, which I am looking forward to sharing this

[02:05:08] virtual reality interactive project, which will not only be for our youngest in STEM, but we will be able to share across the state with all of the elementary schools. These collaborations demonstrate how lab schools are aligning education with our industries, giving students a sense of purpose and a glimpse of their own future.

[02:05:27] Last Friday, we had every single eighth grader on the Eastern Shore come to Eastern Shore Community College, 10 plus partners out there. They got to experience Aerospace Day. 50 of those students will be able to come into the Aerospace Academy. However, they've seen their opportunities for aerospace on the shore and they'll be able to learn about the industries out there.

[02:05:46] And it's just an amazing opportunity. At ATIU and W, students have participated and partnered with Dogren for the robotics and data science clubs. Our students at Smith Tech or middle schoolers on their own wrote commercials and produced them, showcasing creativity and applied technical skills.

[02:06:05] At the STEM Academy, our students collaborated with the U.S. Coast Guard. Lab school high schoolers across the state have participated in the Congressional App Challenge, applying logistics and computer science principles to solve real community problems. And we have students who are deeply invested in education careers.

[02:06:22] at the end of this year, they will be able to enter college with associate's degrees and educator pathways. Each of these examples reflects what makes the initiative so powerful is that students are learning through doing in ways that connect directly to their communities and careers. The results are clear and encouraging. Students are earning dual enrollment credits.

[02:06:43] They're engaging in project-based learning tied directly to industry competencies and reporting higher engagements and stronger senses of belonging. And many of our students are letting us know that they feel that higher education is accessible and relevant, and they now have clear pathways from their current studies to future college and career opportunities. This past April also, we hosted an innovation summit where we had over 250 educators across the state. These were not only lab school educators, but they were educators from all the, from many of the divisions in the state and higher ed partners.

[02:07:20] What we did at that space, and we're doing it again in March, you're invited, March 23rd and 24th, where participants have a common purpose to advance innovation to improve student learning outcomes. Educators were able to learn from one another, co-design new ideas, and build a shared vision for what's possible in education.

[02:07:38] Through that work, we've launched Networked Innovation Communities. So again, lab school educators, non-lab school educators coming together. The first networked innovation community is around instructional innovation. We have a couple of different subgroups that are working around curriculum and other pieces. The other ones that are launching coming up are around educator preparation, design thinking, research and development, and educator preparation.

[02:08:00] And again, bringing together our lab school and non-lab school educators together to think deeply and thoughtfully about innovation and how to scale the work that's taking place. We're really focusing on creating this sustained statewide ecosystem. And again, bringing in industry partners so that we're ensuring that we're co-designing the curriculum and the work.

[02:08:19] The Innovation Summit in March is going to have an attention and a focus on industry collaboration. And we're also making sure that when we ideate, again, that it doesn't stay local, that we're able to scale. So we're moving from early pilots to this coordinated statewide model for educational innovation while also being attuned to what's happening in Virginia and partnering with other entities so that we're collaborating and not competing with the initiatives that are already taking place. So together,

we're able to keep talent local in Virginia, strengthen communities, and prepare for the next generation of Virginia's workforce. I was also asked to come here and speak

[02:08:56] to the material change policy and procedures for our college partnership lab schools, which is important. The planning grants that we had gave us an excellent runway for collaboration. Dr. Sanzo, can we pause right here? Yeah. Are there any questions before we move into the contract mods?

[02:09:18] Dr. Monk, are you good? Okay. Sorry. Sorry. I'm a professor by trade. I can just keep talking. Do you want me to keep going? Ms. McPherson? I just wanted to say I had the opportunity to attend the opening for the STEM Academy at Booger T and the Smith Tech one at Oscar Smith.

[02:09:38] And both are just excellent programs. consistent with the governor's announcement recently what he says the one size of education does not fit all so lab schools have a very very important place now in the delivery of education to students and i see based upon the map that we do need to expand more in the rural areas because a lot of our educational data is speaking to the fact that we've got to open up more programs in the rural area and obviously everybody knows i'm a big component of hvcus and the place that they

[02:10:10] will play in educating students because a lot of students see students that attend HBCUs as role models for them. And so given our historical past in that area, I just want to make sure that we understand that they will play a significant part moving forward. But in the rural area, we do need to expand. And I've looked at this policy, and I think that that policy is also going to help in making sure we have some consistency. Yeah. So I'll share with you that we are looking at the rural areas and ensuring that we have uh saturation in all areas especially

[02:10:47] our rural areas to ensure that students have this opportunity i also think this can dovetail into the student enrollment opportunity um so we're thinking across not just uh vertically um but i also uh superintendent gillickson and me have she shared with me an hbcu opportunity we're actually looking at supporting opportunities for charter and lab school opportunities so part of the the new division is to start reaching out to those individuals and developing some opportunities.

[02:11:14] So yes, that is on our list. And part of what we're doing with the network is we're collecting and curating the practices that we're finding are working, or at least to share and then to scale those up. So as new models come on board, they also don't have to learn, right? And kind of, we're able to help people learn collectively and, you know, have the experiences from what we've already done. And I do appreciate you coming to those launches. And I think that highlights, too,

[02:11:45] the partnership piece of it, how deeply these partnerships help propel innovation. Okay, great. So I'm sorry, Dr. Northern has a question. I'm just so pleased with these lab schools who have been able to secure this additional funding. And I'm just wondering, I mean, obviously, that's tough work. Is part of your assistance at the center, is it actually helping them to do some fundraising and giving them tools and help you know because this is a big part right given that we were not able to secure that additional funding we wanted for for lab schools

[02:12:24] that they they learn how to fundraise on their own and are you providing technical assistance for that type of activity so that is part of what we've been doing early on we were working on supporting with grants but as with a lot of things that's come to a pause right now so we've been looking at nsf and other ones and so we have been working with some of our partners especially the ones that we're serving

as fiscal agents to help think about how we engage with those partnerships and then we're going to be hosting other opportunities to help with fundraising because it is a really significant piece of it and in addition how do we also work with our partners

[02:13:01] directly to leverage some of the existing funding that is already taking place we've been very fortunate ODU for example to be able to deeply partner with the school divisions to really think thoughtfully about how to leverage existing funds already yeah mr green um uh deputy superintendent had mentioned that currently i think around 3 800 students are in lab schools projections in the future somewhere around 5 000. um is there any reason or what is like the biggest barrier because Because I'm really big on scale.

[02:13:37] Why there can't be 10,000, 15,000, 20,000 kids other than obviously money or resources? What are some of the other limitations or restrictions that's keeping us from going really big and being able to impact more students? I mean, I think that's a great question.

[02:13:54] I mean, funding is always the biggest piece of it and making sure that we have certified teachers who are able to be in those seats. i think for us looking at it from university standpoint thinking about how do we help enable faculty to get that teacher credentialing in order to meet the needs of of the students and i think that's one of those barriers that could help address some of the issues is helping our two and four-year faculty get that certification the demand is there is going to be among the parent community who wanted a different option or another the kids so it's just a matter of us

[02:14:31] being able to meet that demand by increasing the supply and available seats at the staff schools for these kids i will also add it's a lot going into it so it's looking at space making sure that universities that have the space to do it having the resources making sure that they're fulfilling the same qualities that our k-12 schools are held to in hiring of teachers so it's a lot that goes into it i will say there are there's a lot of momentum and people asking questions i've gotten a lot of emails around from other universities about can we collaborate with other universities we're like yes so there's more there's momentum there we're just trying to help them go through

[02:15:07] the technical assistance technical assistance and i'm so grateful for dr sanzo for stepping up to the plate in odu for helping not just their nine they're helping all 15. and talking about that scale i had the opportunity to attend the dsca opening and it was really striking to me the parents that participated and these are pta parents and traditional k-12 public education that were coming and saying we love this we want more of it and so think about you and even saying

[02:15:43] how can we advocate and tell other parents about this engagement so really want to think about how we can engage parents in being the voice box for this opportunity for students in their localities as well yeah i think um for the division we're we have a team meeting coming up next week and we're looking at how do we develop a kind of a one-stop shop for parents so that they can see kind of bring superintendent gillison's vision to life how can parents see their options within their division within their region by just clicking on one button to be able to see public private everything in

[02:16:22] one place so we're looking at how do we develop that for parents okay so on to the next okay great okay so i was also asked to when i came here today to speak about the material change policy and procedures for virginia's college partnership lab school so the planning grants that we received were excellent and they gave us the runway for collaboration as we developed ideas and built prototypes and refined those prototypes into the full lab school applications and that process of

[02:16:59] moving from concept to implementation was itself an act of innovation and so as you know these are living systems of innovation that change they engage in iterative cycles of research and development which is at the heart of our lab schools so we're continually testing instructional strategies we're learning from data we're collaborating across the network and we're also adapting to workforce and community needs and we're able to share these insights and change itself is evidence of innovation in motion the proposed material change policy and procedures reflect that reality they provide clear expectations and consistent structure for

[02:17:39] how these changes can take place and how they should be communicated and reviewed my notes are stuck but at the same time they also give us the flexibility transparency and accountability that we need for innovation to thrive the the policy helps to ensure clarity coordination and shared understanding across the schools and the universities institutions of higher ed and the department of education the policy supports agility by giving us a predictable pathway for

[02:18:12] proposing and documenting changes allows transparent communication but it also helps us ensure sustained innovation by allowing us to have that process of continuous improvement without unnecessary barriers it gives us that balance between structure and flexibility so i want to say thank you so much for your ongoing support and the opportunity to be here today to speak about the lab schools and all of you are invited to come to our summit march 23rd and 24th and to visit our schools thank you and where's the summit going to be dr sam it's going to be at old dominion university the first half of the day is going to be lab schools learning exchange with

[02:18:51] all of our lab school educators and then the remainder day of a half everybody across the state's invited our rfp for proposals for the state's going to come out in the next couple of the days. Thank you. 23rd and 24th, right? March 23rd and 24th. Thank you, Dr. Sanzo, for that support.

[02:19:11] I wholeheartedly appreciate you and also the impact that you're having on lab schools, but not just lab schools. If you heard her, she's also having an impact on other teachers outside of lab schools to be able to bring those thoughts and visions and innovation, not just to lab school students, but all K-12 students across the Commonwealth. Next slide, please. Pursuant to statutory statue 22.1-349.3 the code of virginia the board is responsible for reviewing and providing lab school applications and entering the contracts with lab schools these contracts

[02:19:49] state that any material change require amendments to the board contract and for each with each lab school the material change and procedures for virginia college partnership laboratory schools provide the mechanism by which approved lab schools may request and obtain authorization for significant change to their approved scope and operation next slide the proposed policy defines a material change as a change of such magnitude as to alter the significant significantly

[02:20:23] the labs school mission goals legal status scope of its offering autonomy sponsorship method of delivery of its program financial stability and are the locus of control over the local over the lab school this includes the expansion or alteration of school mission anything establishing a new location or branch adding or discontinuing major program components grade levels or significant change to budget finance or career technical programs next slide

[02:20:58] please rationale for action approve of this policy a policy ensures that lab schools operate under clear consistent expectations when proposing change that could result into the modification of their contract this framework strengthens oversight ensuring compliance with statutory requirements and

provides a purpose for determination determination and notice of material change and promotes transparency in decision making across the lab school network.

[02:21:32] Next slide. Superintendent of Public Education recommends that the Board of Education approve the material change policy and procedures for Virginia College Partnership Laboratory Schools on a first and final review. I'll take any questions. That will be on our agenda tomorrow, so we will take action on that tomorrow. However, are there any questions here?

[02:21:57] make sure you're saying well obviously significant is a word that is subject to interpretation yeah i understand that this is just a first change that's going to help us along in building consistency and obviously at least as we gain more experience in this area we'll probably have to modify the policy more but i kind of congratulate you on the first step for trying to bring consistency and we don't have people like applying for money getting money deciding to do something else and the board never hears about it until somewhere down the road so i do appreciate

[02:22:33] the fact that this is a beginning policy did that comment our biggest goal is to ensure the quality of education for our students so i think that's a huge mechanism for us uh and so we definitely you know whenever we approve this there are definitely opportunities to come back and revisit because as you know things change and rules are only made because they're broken dr northern just to clarify original uh policy did not define material change at all and what we're doing is adding

[02:23:09] uh definition of material change the definition and the uh approval process yes i just wasn't sure what just making sure it was understood correct thank you all right thank you okay we do need to take a quick break here so that our virtual presenters can be um looped in and then we'll come back and do item d so that's um we'll do that item and then after item d we'll take lunch

[02:23:46] that's good with everyone all right we'll hold till we get everything technologically hooked up

[02:23:53] thanks everyone and we are working on we're starting with item d and um i will ask the

[02:38:34] imagine learning team to introduce themselves if they would before they begin um with their presentation for us good morning my name is christine bawley i am the regional sales director with imagine learning and i'm here with my colleague kimberlyn rivers and i'm going to go ahead and pass it on good morning president creasy and the members of the virginia board of education thank you for the opportunity to share this vision rooted in partnership i'm dr kimberlyn rivers i'm the senior vice president of school services for imagine learning

[02:39:12] and a proud licensed Virginia educator administrator and actively licensed division superintendent thank you so much we're excited to have you all here today if you would like to begin your presentation we are ready for you we do have the slides in front of us just so that you're aware

[02:39:42] of that okay i believe just tim did i need to cue that up or no we have it in front of us you can just proceed we have it in front of each of our computers on our computers so if you want to

[02:40:13] just go through your presentation we're right there are you able to see my screen are you able

[02:40:46] to see my screen can one of you in the back chat with her that we don't need to see the screen oh certainly yeah maybe i needed my mic on okay much thank you so much i just wanted to start off

[02:41:21] with an opening story about myself um when i began my teaching career my first day of school began with a key a classroom and a deep desire to serve but like many first-year teachers i had great

motivation but limited guidance and those early days taught me that the talent and heart are essential but teachers also deserve to structure mentorship and continuous learning to keep growing alongside their students and imagine learning we believe that when teachers are supported confident and connected learners flourish that's the foundation of the model

[02:41:58] i'll share today staffing issues are not temporary a lot of times they are structural while we encounter educator shortage let's maximize our reach building a system which empowers retention confidence and excitement in every virginia teacher and teacher leader for the instructional years ahead our current imagine learning instructional model and staffing i'd just like to talk to you about that allow me an opportunity to share what that is and how we

[02:42:31] continue to improve it year over year since we began serving virginia schools in 2008 education has involved and so has the needs of our learners our students are navigating new technologies diverse learning paths and complex social social challenges teachers need the same continuous development that we expect for our students a framework of mentorship collaboration and reflection that sharpens their skills and keeps instruction relevant. That's what Imagine Learning's

[02:43:06] digital first hybrid co-teaching model provides. A way to expand support, ensure quality, and sustain teacher growth across every classroom. We are currently actively serving and partnering with about 40 Virginia school divisions to be able to serve over 3,800 enrollments that they would not would have struggled to serve on on their own we partner with districts to expand capacity of their existing building personnel consistent educators build relationships

[02:43:46] over time through use of a variety of tech tools and resources teachers can get very specific targeted feedback to inspire mastery of the standards of learning when we think about teaching potentially expanding our ability to upskill our provisionally licensed teachers we think about how do we maximize capacity discovering ways to maximize capacity expand and empower a thriving continuous teacher pipeline we can disrupt education in a most amazing and inspirational way

[02:44:22] the opportunity the opportunity before us is both practical and inspiring to make every classroom a mentorship hub where experience and enthusiasm meet by pairing provisionally licensed or novice teachers with experienced certified imagined learning educators we create a dual teaching partnership that blends digital excellence with human connection using virginia department of education approved courses and curriculum as the anchor teachers can co-plan

[02:44:59] co-create and personalize instruction for every scholar and by teachers i mean the virtual teacher from imagine learning with the in-classroom provisionally our novice teacher the outcomes we hope to see or we aim to see are holistic and lasting student growth personalized consistent instruction increased teacher confidence and retention greater cost efficiency and scalability and stronger family and community trust in education this model creates classrooms where

[02:45:35] teachers feel supported in addition to our learners students feel seen and learning feels personal it's the power of two collaboration at the core we call it the power of two one experienced educator one emerging teacher and one shared goal student success together they collaborate to plan lessons, interpret data, and refine strategies. The experienced imagined learning educator models instructional mastery while the novice teacher connects directly with students, bringing energy,

[02:46:13] empathy, and growing confidence in the actual physical classroom. This partnership not only benefits learners, it grows the next generation of skilled Virginia educators. The next slide is the hybrid co-teaching model in action. Inside these classrooms, instructions will feel dynamic and connected. The certified Imagine Learning teacher provides virtual modeling and coaching through our Imagine Learning virtual portal, and while the novice teacher facilitates in-person engagement,

[02:46:47] manages student relationships, and builds trust directly with their student community. both educators are actively reflecting teaching and growing ensuring that students experience continuity care and rigor in every way this model highlights personalization engagement and competency-based learning the model on collaborative planning and engagement engaging engagement using both in-person and online instruction with the imagine learning virginia department

[02:47:23] of education approved courses as the instructional anchor customization no two no two classrooms are look alike and no two learners learn the same way that's why this model is built on flexibility and personalization teachers review data identify learning trends and adjust instruction each week it allows for intervention where needed acceleration where possible and support for every scholar from those catching up to those ready to leap ahead instruction in this model isn't copied it's co

[02:48:01] created imagine a virginia where every teacher begins their journey with confidence every classroom has both expertise and enthusiasm guided and learning and where every scholar receives personalized high quality instruction this is more than a partnership it's a movement to elevate the teaching profession and strengthen our educational future. As I reflect on my own journey, the first classroom, that first day, I realized how much potential was waiting to be

[02:48:37] nurtured. This model represents a promise that no teacher stands alone and no student goes unseen. Together we can ensure Virginia classrooms are not defined by shortages but by strength, by mentorships by excellence and by endless possibility thank you president creasy and the members of the board for your time and your commitment to virginia educators and students and we hope to partner with you in this model that allows our experienced teachers and in fact

[02:49:14] the staff of experienced teachers that we have as an average of 17 years teaching experience to support the novice of provision and license license teachers within the classroom are there any questions here are there any questions jump into some questions dr northern trying to understand the basic model maybe i just haven't have enough caffeine um so in plain language is it you have

[02:49:46] a novice teacher paired with a experienced teacher who serves as a mentor and the novice teacher meets with this mentor teacher, like just like a cooperating teacher, you know, as as a student teacher and data together. But the novice teacher is the one who has the kids in front of them every day. And is it just for is it for all novice teachers? Or is it just teachers who I saw some reference to special education in here? Is it is it? In our current model, we have special education

[02:50:25] support also built in every student that is served by our teachers in this collaborative model would receive exceptional support in relation to accommodations and modifications we would teach the teacher how to make those accommodations and modifications for learners in the classroom in addition if we as we need to participate in iep meetings with the novice teacher we're happy to do that as well to model participation and additional data that may be needed to support

[02:50:59] those meetings. In relation to the digital curriculum, both teachers would plan together what portion of that Virginia-approved course would be delivered asynchronously and what portion of that course would be delivered synchronously through live planning and teaching within that particular class in addition it'll allow for oh sorry in addition they will use data to to structure dynamic groups where they can specifically work on personalization

[02:51:37] and skills development and also helping learners who want to accelerate accelerate and also working with learners who need additional skills support to support those through a personalized approach teacher is also teaching the kids veteran teacher isn't just providing novice teacher is that correct the veteran teacher would be modeling um instruction for the novice teacher with the kids yes okay i just didn't know that teacher was sort of behind the screen behind the curtain or whether they were actually teaching with that uh teacher uh with

[02:52:16] the kids okay that's helpful thank you i just want to wrap my head around what the model was other questions so maybe one of the two of you can answer this question for me but how what does the data look like from um the 40 divisions that you're already working in how what is the data for provisional licensees look like um what is what are some success data that you have to show if that's something that you could share with us i know that's not you know part of your presentation today but that would be interesting to see at a later date

[02:52:54] we can provide um information on the data of how our students are achieving in the state of virginia i do not have that present in the presentation today but i do would i would like for you to take a moment to go back to the model i believe it's on slide four with the instructional layers of support and i'd like to explain that a little bit more uh in this model this is a model that is currently currently being supported and delivered in virginia what the teacher of record at the top

[02:53:31] of the model in this case it could be our imagine learning certified teacher of record who is licensed or it could be someone it it could be our imagine learning teacher a teacher of record who has that certification teacher is in charge of and well i would say in charge of instruction but in this model they'll be collaborating with what we would call the on-site mentor the on-site mentor and mentor in the bottom right hand corner of this slide is the person who was in the classroom ensuring student safety collaboration and engagement through collaborative

[02:54:09] support our teacher of record or our imagine learning certified teacher would be able to help the on-site mentor co-collaborate and co-plan and co-design lessons to decide whether which portions are to be delivered live and which portions are to be student-led where students are actually in the online curriculum continuing to do that on their own in addition in this model we also have on-demand tutors who are real-time tutors and it's akin to let's say the students

[02:54:47] have access 24 7 access to the curriculum the on-demand tutors is akin to what you would referred to as before school tutoring during school tutoring and after school tutoring those on-demand tutors while the student is actually working in their course this additional layer support provides specific support on concepts that students may be struggling with while they're in school or either while they're outside of school when they're working to get uh they're working in their courses that live tutor also provides support through whiteboard and chat and also

[02:55:25] through phone again that's an additional layer of support in addition to the imagine learning teacher and also the on-site mentor specifically designed when a student needs support and when they're

outside of that school setting in addition we will offer professional learning and ongoing support to that particular teacher as well dr northern are you using the same curriculum that the rest of the school is is using i see presents engaging rear estate standards aligned content

[02:56:04] is that content similar different aligned with the existing curriculum a district may be using we are actively on the virginia multi-division online provider list all of our courses that we offer for the state of virginia through that particular program are via videoe approved courses and aligned in terms of pacing because certain districts may pace courses differently we can

[02:56:34] alter or customize that specific course to the pacing for that particular district mr muck talked a lot about building level administrators how do they play into this uh layer of support that you've got here certainly well i believe uh first of all for building administrator principals always set the tone for their school so often with these with these setups we do ask that there is a meeting between that the school the school community is involved and there is a meeting that includes

[02:57:11] a school counseling director a school testing coordinator also a principal or the principals of principals one of the aps on the principals leadership team to actively ensure that the student and the teacher are being supported in addition we are able to provide additional evaluation tools for walkthroughs as those administrators are are looking at the learning occur in the classroom and determining what's what's effective we have a tool that we can we

[02:57:46] can share to support that administration team in addition we have an imagine learning virtual portal where the administrators the counselor counselor can immediately see student progress teacher communication and additional ancillary tools or ancillary activities that might be used to help the students learn all of that is visible 24 7. ms ashton yeah i don't have a question i just have a comment i have used imagine learning and i really just applaud the innovation around

[02:58:23] this we do need to find new ways to bring in new teachers who are mentored with those experienced teachers and my experience with imagine learning is that it really is teacher friendly in terms of the tools the platform and the resources which can really be an obstacle for teachers learning new curriculum new platform and so um i'm just excited about the pop the pilot and really seeing how we can get more teachers into the profession so thank you and i know christine you and i talked

[02:59:00] a little bit about your your um particular uh region seven relationships is there is that something that you all want to highlight there sure i'm happy to talk about that um we've been working kimberlin's been working with region seven as well region seven created a consortium if you will uh as as a way to provide virtual learning for their homebound students i'm sorry homeschool

[02:59:33] students in all the different divisions in region seven so they wanted a way to be able to have those students be part of the district but still allow them that freedom to take courses virtually on a full-time basis so we have partnered with region seven where we provide the teachers of record with for them and we work very closely with them and they do have um they have they have an administrator that works with all the divisions in region seven and we help fund that

[03:00:11] administrator by collecting um an additional fee that then is a pass-through fee back to region seven so that they can find the pain for the administrator to oversee the program and so we have been doing that for the last three or four years with region seven right kim yes that kind of speaks to a little bit

of what we you all talked about earlier in how do we get those home school students to be part of the divisions so that the divisions can get back. The one thing

[03:00:45] that is very different about Imagine Learning is we do not, we only pay for our teacher services and the division ends up with better than half of the ADM for the students. Thank you. Are there other questions or comments here to both thank you so very much for your presentation today

[03:01:17] we're always looking for what divisions are doing differently in terms of opportunities for us to be able to spotlight these kinds of things for other divisions to learn from so we're thankful for your presentation and your participation today so with that we thank you so much thank you you all have a great afternoon thank you have a great afternoon appreciate the opportunity thank you okay and with

[03:01:51] that we are going to take lunch we will come back at 12 45. okay thank you we are back um with item

[03:54:14] e for beginning of our afternoon session superintendent gollickson would like to introduce

[03:54:56] okay great uh well this has been a very um big focal point for the board over the last handful of years on our partnership and collaboration with VOE and VEDP to make sure that we're really aligning our student experiences towards what industries, both high demand and emerging industries, really need. And we are so thrilled to have a new executive director at the Virginia Office of Education and Economics. I've had the pleasure of working with Wendy King

[03:55:30] in her last hat over at the Senate Finance and Appropriations Committee, and we are so thrilled for her love for data and dollars to really help guide and be a thought partner for both the agency and as we staff the board on the work that's underway. And she is part of the group I've mentioned before, where we meet weekly to monthly to bimonthly across the education and workforce agencies. And so we are so thrilled to have her here. And Duane, if there's anything else you

[03:56:08] want to add, but I stole the thunder to introduce Wendy and how we're so excited about this agenda item. Thank you, Wendy. She's so eager to talk to you. I would like to introduce Wendy Kong. She's currently serves as the executive director of VOE.

[03:56:25] Prior to working at VOE, Wendy served as the lead legislative analyst for education at the Virginia Senate Finance and Appropriations Committee. She also led leadership roles at the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia and the Virginia Community College System, where she focused on higher education finance, workforce programs, and policy evaluation.

[03:56:47] Wendy started her career as an analyst in the Joint Legislative Audit and Review Commission and serves as a math teacher in the Peace Corps. So I'd like to introduce to you, Wendy Vu.

[03:57:04] - Well, thank you. I think I got a double introduction there. So appreciate that. And Madam President, members of the board, thank you for having me today. We do know this is a very high important topic. And so we're really happy to present this to you and also get a little bit about your questions and feedback as we've been working through this.

[03:57:23] So just to give you a little background regarding the Virginia Office of Education Economics, which you've heard of is often called VOWE. This office was established in 2021 through legislation. And it really was trying to look at how can we bridge education and workforce data together and really think about gaps and alignment.

[03:57:47] And could we have an entity that could really look at both of those things? One that wasn't housed in education, in the labor market because often those two would look at them differently but what can we do to bridge those together and that really was where the voey office was established so we are located in the virginia economic development partnership so we aren't sitting in education and we're not sitting in labor market and there's a lot of benefit to that we do get to learn a lot about what bedp because they are our main economic development group that is working on a daily

[03:58:22] basis with employers to attract them to Virginia and they also work with with the companies that are looking to grow in Virginia but outside of EDP we're also talking with our Virginia Works partners because they are also working with employers and learning more about them so some of that is for us to listen to what we're hearing from both and figure out where we can bridge those together so the other work that we are doing is we help support the board of workforce development and the development of a high demand occupation list and that was actually um one was completed

[03:59:01] back in 2024 and it is done every two years and so we are helping them with the current list that they are working on and it serves a variety of purposes but it really is supposed to look at what occupations are out there what jobs and what's happening moving forward and we're also working with partners to gain feedback as part of that so we appreciate being able to talk to you today um i also want to talk about a project that we're also working on in parallel and once we figure out these high demand occupations there's a lot of interest of what

[03:59:36] credentials align to that and that is a little bit more complicated process but we are working actively with the department of education with you with the cte pieces as well as the community college system in terms of what credentials they are offering and also looking even the registered apprenticeship programs to really think about where do we see alignment there where can we where do we see gaps and how can we think about that more and so that project is happening kind of in parallel with this process as we move forward with them in terms of the high demand

[04:00:10] occupation list so there are a lot of variables that go into this list and it focuses on openings it also looks at job growth it looks at wage thresholds and it's also looking at um you know sources of data and so right now the list that we currently have which is we call it the 2024 list it was approved by the board of workforce development looks at these different areas and so what you'll see in this presentation that's been provided to you is what the current criteria are and that's that middle column and then what it's considering for the future piece

[04:00:49] so openings is one and they want to look at a minimum number of job openings of 100 job openings for the year and then we're also looking at a second component growth the current list is looking at at least a one percent growth that's occurring and this next proposed one is looking to say well we know that the market's changing but there's still potential to look at just stable growth so right around zero percent but you need both you have to have at least 100 openings and you need to have some growth with that in addition there is a median earnings threshold

[04:01:29] which is 200 of the federal poverty level at the 2024 level that was about 29 000 knowing that there's some inflation that's moving to 31,000 with the list. There's also some looking at the sources of data.

[04:01:46] And in the past, we are using the Bureau of Labor Statistics projections, and that's some national data sources that come to us that look at those projections of ocean openings. That's using some historic data and some other pieces to really kind of look at signals for projections moving forward.

[04:02:03] We had some feedback that they'd also like to see if the Virginia Employment Commission, Virginia Works also does some projections still based on VLS data that we should look at both of those and take the better of the two. There's not usually a lot of difference, but it's also just recognizing where our state's doing some work in that area.

[04:02:24] So those are just a few of the changes in terms of what that list composes of. And before I kind of dig into what we're finding so far, I'll kind of pause there and see if there's any questions from the members.

[04:02:43] - Mr. Mock, or I'm sorry, Ms. McPherson. - Thank you. When looking at the list, basically are you looking at what is needed in the Commonwealth or needed nationally?

[04:03:02] - Yes, for that, we're looking at what is for Virginia. And one thing I'll be able to show you in a minute is we also have the ability to filter that at different levels across the state. And we even have that for superintendent regions that are available. So the statistics are drawn from what our local employers basically are indicating that they need where the high demand is coming from.

[04:03:26] So has there been any merger or consideration of the data, because I'm big on high career payment industry-wide, okay, based upon what new AI and new technology is talking about they need, okay?

[04:03:46] Because as I look at the category that you got on high demand, it doesn't necessarily line up with the information I'm getting and learning about what's going to be needed as we talk about data centers, as we talk about all of the new industry that is coming to our area, and that there's going to be a high demand for that.

[04:04:08] Like, for instance, I think I didn't necessarily see, NVIDIA, for instance, has predicted that plumbers and electricians are going to be among the next millionaires in the United States. So that's why I'm trying to say there's going to be a new high demand that's not necessarily related directly now to what Virginia employers may be needing now.

[04:04:30] And are we going to have a crosswalk that tells us that those industries are going to be the next new high demand areas? And so, Madam President, I want to make sure I do the formalities, Madam President and board members.

[04:04:48] So the current list that we have does project for the next five years. It's based on these Bureau of Labor Assistance occupations. Plumbers is some of those. think maybe the list that you might be seeing in the next few flies ahead are ones that are getting added to it but there's also an existing list and and I will say plumbers are on that list and so it does try to do its best to forecast what's happening in the next five years but we've also had a lot of conversations about that as what Ms. Gullickson was saying in terms of the the discussions these are based on historic activities and what we are hearing from employers and there's

[04:05:28] modeling that's taking pace and these models do their best to try to to to predict the future and bls has even noted we know that ai is changing and there's only so much that they can predict there are some things that happen um you know either in a region or that these models may not pick up and the examples i've been giving lately you've seen in the news the announcements of AstraZeneca and Eli Lilly coming you know that's not something that a model knew we just found these out in the last few months so you can often have something that happens regionally that is not

[04:06:06] always picked up perfectly in the models because they are doing their best based on historic data to project that the other example we gave just last week was we met with the Newport News shipbuilding and they had some layoffs that had occurred and the model was picking up the layoffs layoffs and they were projecting less welders and they said we know we need more welders and this model's not picking it up because again it's doing historic data one thing i'd like to say is we often think that this data serves as a conversation starter and not an ender because there's things that are always happening out in the economy that a model doesn't predict but it's a way to start the conversation

[04:06:50] that we built in the opportunity to to add to this list because a lot of the students may not want a credential in some of these areas that you have on the list and so i don't want us to limit them i want to make sure i think i think we need to remember that this is not a list that's specific to education so we're not we're not specifically driving this and that may drive cte programs to some degree um but that this list is not something that is driven specifically by education oh yeah

[04:07:27] absolutely i get that yeah and i guess the session the under question i have for this is this this totally makes sense in terms of high demand in the next five years and but what's underneath it is what are the skills even for these jobs that i do think go into ai and innovation and technology that some of these jobs are not your kind of standard like you know career tech jobs they're actually technology jobs and so that's the part i think that's connected to the education

[04:08:01] piece is how do we get under what are the skills required for these jobs so that k-12 can actually be be preparing our our students for these opportunities is that work that like a next step is a great this is a great start and then the conversation starter is well what are the skills you need for these right yeah madam president and um member the uh pieces yes we actually have um even a whole dashboard that is looking at trends and job postings and john metal linux and what we have seen is the major skills and we are able to divide that up by both credentials that are

[04:08:38] putting showing up in job postings as well as um kind of that soft skill durable skill however you want to call that as well as some um the middle areas kind of the technical pieces that they're looking for and we're able to do that even by career cluster and again that's that conversation starter so we we've had some discussions i was just meeting with virginia works and even talking with the um your cte director about how can we create those conversations say this is what we're seeing with that and then also blend that with being housed at the virginia economic development partnership and with our partners with virginia works what are we hearing from employers to help

[04:09:14] build those because we know those conversations are really important but we're starting that conversation using some data mr monk i don't want to opine on this too much but i appreciate you saying that this is really a conversation starter because one of the challenges i think that maybe we can discuss and go through is in the education field i think historically we've used some of this information as the end-all be-all and when we look at credits that folks are receiving and then the direction that our CT pathways are going in, this data really drives that. And so

[04:09:51] students are being placed in a position of, okay, if we want to get to this section, then maybe I need to go towards these high demand careers as labeled by this data. But there, as you alluded to, there are many factors that are swirling around in the Commonwealth that can better inform, you know, this data is a great piece, but there's also some practicality. So appreciate that component i'll save some other questions for the ends thank you okay i'll keep moving along in terms of what we're doing but um one

thing i note and i've got a few screen scots of our dashboard but you have the ability to filter by different regions you can also look at clusters and you can

[04:10:30] also do a filter by certain education levels so as you're trying to think about what data is available there's an opportunity to kind of dig a little further with that um this is again just the the slide here just shows you kind of a visual of what that is and then as i mentioned there's some of these screenshots that we have and i won't go into a demonstration is that you have the ability to filter by queer cluster you can do it at education level and you can even look at just different regions of the state that are available one thing to note as we're updating it i mentioned

[04:11:06] the different criteria change it's really not a huge significant change that is something that that we're looking to provide but with the updates to the list we do find um with that that slight change in the wage threshold combined with the um the job openings as well as the growth factor that we are with the updated list that is under review with the virginia board for workforce development is scheduled for consideration in december does have some occupations that are looking to be added to the list as well as some that could be coming off and i think a few things that were just mentioned are actually a good point when i get to ones that'll be removed because we just have met

[04:11:43] with the board one of our members and he said we really should rethink that one because of some of the criteria in that conversation that got started as a note i would like to note that the occupations that are being provided that are being added to the list are across all education levels so there's some that you'll see listed here that don't require any formal education because this list is being uh used for a variety of different reasons um including other workforce programs across many different um departments of agencies that the interest was to be able to show all the

[04:12:21] different occupations that are there so that's why you'll see several here that are on different areas i will note when you see there's some green the green is what's added it to the list they've hit a percentage growth threshold or their their earnings got higher so that's what's triggered them to be on and this list is what's being added i know there was a question earlier of saying well are there are plumbers on that that's because they're already on an existing high demand occupation list um one piece they're all listed here i'm happy to answer any questions

[04:12:55] about the ones that are listed but to the point about the removal one of the ones bookkeeping accounting and that is is kind of the top one for removal it's got a one percent decline but if you look on the left side there are still a high number of bookkeepers that we're going to need so you're starting to see the signal that yes technology is impacting it we're going to be seeing less growth but in the next five years you know is the number going to be the 4600 openings or maybe slightly less this is where they're doing their best to do the protection for bls but there was a lot of discussion even this morning to say well we are still going to need

[04:13:35] to train people so you know should we think of an exception for this because we have so many job openings that we need to train um and so again as the board's considering that those are feedback we're we're bringing back to them and and how we can look at that when they look at that for the next month when they meet so again conversation starter and this is where we get good questions with those things um in terms of next steps of what we're doing i've talked a little bit about this is under consideration as part of the board of workforce development's annual or biennial review we have been doing a lot of stakeholder outreach and appreciate your feedback today

[04:14:13] and that's going to be something that we bring back to the board of workforce development in december as they look to look at these changes so again we're looking at the occupation piece we're also working on that credential alignment perhaps there'll be an opportunity to come back to you as we continue that work um with that and where those conversations can continue but with that i'll be happy to answer any differential questions that you might have comments earlier

[04:14:50] around can you help me understand how this data is collected i see you've got job postings um but one of the things that i think our agency has utilized is the median salary as well as that posting data um and we've already talked a little bit about some of the things that maybe aren't take into account there? What is taken into account outside of the job posting component?

[04:15:14] I'm mainly thinking about, you know, many of these industries that are hands-on are really small businesses. So they may not be posting a job publicly. It might be via word of mouth or they've got the apprenticeship program that's moving folks through. What goes into that factor to create a high demand role? Madam President, I'm a member of the board. This is a very good question. We use the job openings data which is slightly different it's based on employer surveys in terms of what types of occupations are hiring in which is a little bit different um and so so those estimates

[04:15:51] are based on kind of actual employer activities that are occurring and it can include the small businesses as well they're part of this data collection thing and actually there's been in some delays on some of those data collections with with the um with the shutdown but the job postings is a little bit different and you're 100 right we don't often see job posting data in certain areas skilled trades is the one we hear the most frequently about um where they're they're getting people through word of mouth um we're often trying to look at both what is the projection for openings and then are we also seeing a posting intensity for those different

[04:16:29] areas too because that's almost a real-time signal and so um and that's where those conversations sometimes if we're not seeing the projections showing like we talked about with the shipbuilding are we seeing them posting it more and that's where those two data points can come together but to answer your question is are we factoring in those job postings we're often going off the openings because of the conversation starter because that's a historic model that we have postings can often fluctuate pretty quickly depending on what's happening and have a lot more nuance to them and that's where those conversations come in in terms of how can we

[04:17:03] we interpret that and think about more what we need to do regionally. Mr. Monk. I appreciate that. That is very helpful. If you were kind of an educator thinking about, hey, if I need to teach five years from now, 10 years from now, what does that curriculum or those courses look like, then it sounds like this data definitely would be helpful in that. What other pieces of information would help inform that, that maybe this data doesn't provide of the types of classes? You know, I think we talk about AI, that's an easy one to talk about, but, you know, that may not have shown up, right, in this data.

[04:17:41] So what other things should we be thinking about collectively to inform decisions as we go down the road? I think that's a great question. I think I'd like to categorize it into a couple different areas, right? Because if there's people who are looking for the long-term jobs that are getting the bachelor's degree, we see those degrees that don't always line up, but actually they're very much needed.

[04:18:05] And I won't, I won't survey who on here may have majored in psychology, but we usually have one or two poking up, but yet they're doing valuable jobs across the area. And that is actually the, in most

states, the one, two, or three top degree awards in any area.

[04:18:22] And they're very applicable to all of them. And so when we talk about bachelor's degrees, sometimes it's a little broader because we know people can go across different majors and still be very valuable in the workplace. And what we're seeing in those areas is what is AI proof? And institutions have been talking about this a while. We're always going to still need those communication skills. We're always going to need to know how to do the human interaction. These are those things that technology can't replace. People like me coming to talk to you, you know, how do we communicate well? How do we problem solve? And then how do we manage AI?

[04:19:00] we've talked we had a lot of conversation about computer science four or five years ago we thought that was the biggest area we needed we had a shortage in that area so maybe the AI is going to help a little bit but we're still going to need them is what we hear we may need less but they're going to need to not know how to program but this whole notion of code vibing where you're managing the AI code so how do we teach to a way that people continue to adapt to technology that even when they went into college might have already changed by the time they graduate.

[04:19:30] So I think a lot of it, what we hear in that area is how do you adapt quickly? How do you problem solve and how do you teach those skills? That's kind of probably a core foundation. In the CTE area, it might be more technical 'cause that's a short term training turnaround.

[04:19:45] And so you might be thinking differently about where this data is relevant in terms of do we need the HVAC and the plumbing and maybe there's not as much technology changes that are happening there. And so I don't mean to say it's different for each thing, but you might be good to think about what is it the different parts?

[04:20:04] Is it your base education or is it current technical skills based on those CTE people and how you probably need a bit of both, right? And maybe there's also some short-term certifications as we start to think about economy shifts that can help people get a quick job as they continue to think about other things they wanna do in their careers.

[04:20:24] Because in K-12, you are trying to train them for lifelong careers. And yes, but you also want to prep them for that first job out of college, out of school or college as they get there. - Ms. Ashton, did you have a question? - Okay, Superintendent Gullickson.

[04:20:40] - Great, thank you so much. One of the elements that you have on the 24 list versus your proposed list that was on slide four was this notion of regionality. When we first produced this list, I know the field was really nervous of like, we're limited only with our students to the high demand industry sectors for say superintendent region five.

[04:21:05] And so curious, it just says under consideration, if you can help the board better understand that. And then I have one other question for that'll inform our next conversation. - Yes, yeah, I apologize for not covering that. The region compete component pieces, and we were just talking with our workforce board member this morning about that.

[04:21:24] There is an interest to have more of that. One thing is when the 2024 list was developed, the dashboard had not been developed yet. And they said, oh, wow, we can actually see by region. And so they may be okay with that option of being able to see a region and you can sort by that, you can look at it by different education level and the cluster and understand that more.

[04:21:46] So there may be an option for us to be looking at that. There was another consideration is, could we do an additive piece? something didn't come on i'll take the bookkeeper one or it's about to come off but there actually is growth in a certain region could we add that to the list and that's something they want to consider i think the piece that has come up of is really the conversations like if we've already got that available would it be best for regions to sit down and kind of us help them walk through that list and say you know even one is high demand we're not seeing as high demand in yours so you you might wanna think about that as well.

[04:22:20] So we're looking at the different regional options. So one is either doing an additive one based on an extra set of criteria, even if it has no growth overall, but had growth in a region. The other option is just being able to display it like we currently have.

[04:22:36] So I have more to be able to report back after the December meeting, but those are two options we're looking at. - Well, we appreciate the superintendent's regions being added on there. Dr. Williams, I know you helped with that. second question informs, as you know, the next agenda item is on our Perkins plan. And so we've been really drawing more attention to apprenticeships, which is also on your list. Can you just speak to that on how that's informing your high demand list as well? Yes. So the apprenticeship data is actually coming from the Virginia Works, and those are apprenticeships that they are connecting with

[04:23:11] based on their federal registered apprenticeship program I don't want to speak to what you're doing in your Perkins plans I don't know if those are apprenticeships as well or maybe the pre-apprenticeship but if the board had said if there were 10 or more apprenticeships and they are thinking that's a demand because an employer is actually working with that apprenticeship if there is something that you're doing that's getting that employer piece at a k-12 level and we're not picking it up

[04:23:39] that's certainly something we could talk about. Dr. Northern, did you have a question? And this may be a question for Dr. Williams, but so when I'm looking at the list, I mean, for instance, environmental engineers came off the list. They're making $102,000, but nuclear engineers made it on the list. So I guess I just want to make sure that we're not so tightly aligning our pathways to the ebbs and flows of this list, right? Because obviously we still want kids to be environmental engineers, even though they're coming off the list.

[04:24:13] list. And I assume that we are not going to be creating career credentials and pathways for jobs that have no upward trajectory. Like, obviously, we need dishwashers. Everybody knows we need dishwashers. But there's no upward trajectory. That's sort of a, you know, doesn't have a lot of potential for advancement. So I just want to make sure that when we're talking about, because sometimes I look at these and I'm like, oh, gosh, don't want to reward some of these that don't have upward trajectory but the point remains that the pathways we're creating don't necessarily directly

[04:24:49] align with every single one of these occupations on the list correct and um maybe mr williams might have more to that one thing i do want to know these are occupations at a six-digit level sometimes what we've found is you might see nuclear coming off but yet there's still a nuclear that's like one adjacent occupation nearby and so this is the challenge in that larger project of credential mapping um where you may have something where it's like we don't need this nuclear but these um occupations and the degree programs i'm thinking in high red well

[04:25:24] uh translate to another area and so this broader notion of sometimes that cluster is a way to look at it and filtering by cluster can be more helpful in those pieces because um this is we call it a six-digit SOC so it's a standard occupation code but yet there are people who have the same major that kind of can fulfill multiple SOC codes across that so I think that's a really good point and where you want to think broadly and that's where we did add those clusters as well I believe there's an update to the clusters too so we might be able to do that so again great great question and we

[04:26:02] want to look broadly on those areas just I wanted to reiterate this AI point as well because I think that we're in this great sort of area of unknown right now and what i look at when i see these ones that have added most of them are not desk jobs right you got retail salesperson a maid a food prep worker a dishwasher a food server i mean these are not desk jobs um so i you know whether we're seeing the tip of the iceberg with ai or not yet but i do think that we probably need to really be asking those types of questions so there's certainly people that have already done projections relative to what classes of occupations they think are quickly going away i mean in my

[04:26:41] industry it's it's a copy editor we used to pay for copy editing for every single one of our reports and now ai does that and it's it's basically you know position that's no more so anyway to the to the extent that we can continue to push on that um that would be great thank you madam president just one final note here too and some feedback as well i know the salary component that you have here is important. I think about years ago when parents said, oh, our kids got to go to a four-year post-secondary component. And now we've realized that maybe there's some other

[04:27:17] options that our learners can go to that are just as great. Fortunately, I think when we see this median salary, sometimes parents might say, okay, this isn't where I want to push my child. So I don't know if there's an option to look at kind of highs and lows of that. You know, I look at some of these roles and know that obviously depending upon where they reside in the state, maybe this number is more accurate than other areas. And so I know this is data that we collect and utilize for different reasons across different agencies. But I think in this particular instance in the

[04:27:53] education field, if there's a way to see a little bit more info into that salary piece, it may make folks feel more comfortable of, hey, you know, I look at truck driving here and that's one that maybe in my area of the state is probably double that in terms of salary, but I think Southwest might not be. So just trying to get a little bit more of a picture of what that might look like. And I know the dashboard only has limited capabilities, but that might be an idea as well. But appreciate the work and had a lot of questions just because I'm interested in it. So thank you. My contact information is at the end of the slide. Please

[04:28:30] feel free to reach out to us um we're happy to kind of continue any additional conversations offline thank you thank you so much we appreciate you being here with us this afternoon okay moving to item f friday item f uh the perkins state plan is a document developed at each state under the carl d perkins career and technology education act perkins also known as perkins 5 to guide its career and technical education also known as CTE programs this plan outlines how the state will

[04:29:06] use federal funding to improve academic knowledge technical skills and employability for secondary and post-secondary students key components include statewide vision a commitment to opportunities a focus on high quality programs and data-driven decisions to support students in high demand career fields. I would now like to turn it over to Dr. Williams, Director of CTE, to give you an

overview of our Perkins State Plan. Good afternoon, everyone. President Creasy, members of the board, Superintendent Gullickson, Dr. Anthony Williams, Director of the Office of Career and Technical

[04:29:43] Education, and happy to be with you all again. And thank you for the introduction. I do have a few slides that I would like to share with you all today. And just to provide a general overview of our work, our current work, as we are engaged with developing a new four-year state plan.

[04:30:05] I just want to discuss some primary components, the primary components for the state plan, which includes Section 1, which is our cover page, and I want to discuss the narrative descriptions. And so our narrative descriptions outline the state's vision and strategic, I'm sorry, and strategy for career and technical education programs. These descriptions identify our plan for implementing CTE programs across career clusters and career sub-clusters by aligning them with workforce needs and ensuring accountability for those results. Key components

[04:30:42] include the alignment with the academic and technical skills needed for employers and as identified by the Virginia Board of Workforce Development, the process of approving CTE programs of study that align to the National Career Buster Framework, an explanation of how career and technical education courses and programs integrate academic standards with technical and employability skills, a description of the school performance and support framework and how that framework supports student academic and technical skill attainment, and a detailed

[04:31:16] description of how funds are distributed. Part three, our assurances, certifications, and other forms. The video we agree with these assurances, certification, and other forms required by the Strengthening Career and Technical Education for the 21st Century Act, and the governor provides joint signatory authority to ensure compliance and accuracy with the submitted information. These insurances ensure that funds are used to support and improve career and technical education programs that align with the state's economic needs.

[04:31:49] Part four includes the budget, which includes a detailed plan of how we will use our grant funds to develop and improve career and technical education programs annually. We include an outline of how the annual grant funds will be dispersed for secondary and post-secondary CTE programs. Finally, our state-determined performance levels. Perkins V state-determined performance levels are state-determined targets for core indicators of performance in career and technical education programs, including graduation rates, academic achievement, and post-graduation success.

[04:32:27] You also see references in slides three and four. Slide five includes the Perkins V program quality indicators for secondary education, and slide 6 identifies the post-secondary Perkins 5 core indicators administered by the VCCS. It is important to note that when exploring the state-determined performance levels of reference in slides 3 and 4, these are the recommended percentages for the 25-26 school year. We are at a point where we are reaching our ceiling as far

[04:33:01] as the percentages that are required across the academic core academic areas language arts mathematics and reading in addition to that you will see several opportunities for students to achieve with our changes to our criteria for high quality work-based learning and then our presentation for industry recognized credentials tomorrow that prompt us to revise our state state plan and our state determined performance levels moving along to our timeline here this

[04:33:38] is a very aggressive timeline but i have a great team of individuals we have been collaborating with the vccs virginia works virginia vdp as well as voi to collaborate on consolidated definitions okay so consolidated definitions and programming around industry recognized credentials workforce needs what are the primary needs of the commonwealth not only now but within the next four years. And so our next step, which you see in step two on November 21st, we've identified approximately 50 stakeholders from around the state that's going to be assisting

[04:34:15] with providing feedback regarding our narrative descriptions for our Perkins state plan. That group, we don't anticipate all 50 being able to join us, but section 122 of the act actually requires specific representatives from the state that must be at the table and must provide us with feedback. Our goal following that November meeting is to consolidate that feedback, make the technical revisions necessary for that plan, and then we will discuss during two virtual public hearing meetings that will be held in December. Following those public

[04:34:53] hearing meetings we will release the state plan for public comment which according by by federal requirement has to be released for a period of 60 days our plan then is to present to you in january the a strong plan this would will be a plan that may require some general technical revisions but but ultimately we would like your feedback as to the changes and the direction that the commonwealth is going specifically for career and technical education. It's also important to note that our

[04:35:29] plan for secondary education and CTE administration that falls under the Department of Education. There's also a post-secondary component to the plan that's administered by the Virginia Community College system. So we are all engaged in this process concurrently as we are working with our respective boards to obtain approval for our state plan. We would like to get the governor's signature. We have that pending technical revisions in January. And by federal requirement, this has to be submitted to the U.S. Department of Education by March. So we are well ahead of

[04:36:09] our deadline. And of course, as we are trying to many, many pending initiatives that we're trying to finalize, such as industry credentialing. We have some work around our advisory committee that I will also be presenting to you tomorrow, but all of that work is critical for those narrative descriptions as identified by our state-determined performance levels. At this time, I would ask if any of you have any questions. Mr. Rock. Yes, appreciate it, Dr. Williams. Thank you. Excited

[04:36:43] about the new Perkins plan and the opportunities and appreciate the timeline there. As we think about kind of the last discussion, I know a lot of the focus has been on high demand and want to maybe better understand how, I think that's a good hanging point, right? We want to make sure we're putting people in the right places at the right times. But as we go through this conversation around the Perkins plan, how is that also driving with some of the other feedback that our previous presenters shared that, hey, maybe this isn't, it's just one piece of the puzzle as well. Is that

[04:37:23] being factored in to the Perkins plan proposal there. Yes, I think that's very helpful to understand and I appreciate the feedback from the previous presenter. It's important to note that this is a data element that's used as a critical first step in the decision-making process, but it's also important to utilize this data in order to project future opportunities for students. And so to the point that was made, every opportunity is not going to be directly aligned to a high demand occupation. And that's identified also in our 3E readiness framework. Yes, there are additional incentives for those that are fulfilling the need of those high demand occupations,

[04:38:00] but we've also provided pathways for students to fulfill the requirements of a CTE sequence and other related industry recognized credentials through cluster programs and pathways. And so we do have a variety of options that are available, but this serves as a mechanism for decision-making. And so that is a critical first step. In addition to that, it brings us all together. It consolidates our workforce agencies. It brings us to the table to determine what are the true needs of the Commonwealth and how can we develop programming and pathways into post-secondary education. Mr. Mung. Thank you, Madam President. And I know that much of this will probably be

[04:38:40] determined based upon the meetings you talked about and the timeline and that feedback. But thinking about the budget for Perkins, we obviously know there's some dollars that come in here that can be disseminated to localities, et cetera. I know the department has really worked to provide hands-on experiences and staffing and support to districts. Do we see that being pervasive throughout the Perkins plan as well of having the kind of the boots on the ground or the resources provided to localities to implement some of these programs? Yes, we see a continued focus on that.

[04:39:16] and I think that with the new alignment of our career clusters, I think once again with the engagement of this data through the Virginia Office of Education and Economics, it provides a more streamlined, a narrow focus that we didn't have before. I also think that this allows us to align with our community college partners. When I look back at the previous four-year plan, we were very siloed though it was one plan we did things very very differently now i see a clear alignment with dual enrollment opportunities a clear alignment with programs what i will present tomorrow is

[04:39:53] that the alignment of those post-secondary recognized credentialing opportunities and stackable opportunities so i think what you will find in this this plan is that we we truly are united to provide opportunities for our students to meet the needs of the commonwealth dr northern so on slide five i just want to understand what a few of these measures are because some of them are higher than i would expect already um so at least 25 26 on slide five these are real data correct

[04:40:28] these are the 25 26 state determined performance levels yes ct concentrators graduating from high school having attained a recognized i notice it's not industry recognized so i don't know if that is purposeful there um we're at 89 gosh we're just starting this i'm trying to figure out like because i'm my concern all all the way you know through this whole thing is that is it osha you know because we see in other states it's it's osha certification it's microsoft word so i just want to make sure that i don't know what we're picking up here we again we're just starting and we've already saying we have 89 of kids who are attaining a recognized post-secondary credential

[04:41:05] what are they getting it in question if allow me to to break that that data down for you all right so this is historical data and 89 is significant and so when i look at that let's let's define and what you see on the left for the indicator description that's a description from the federal government okay and so i'm going to define that for you uh we say percentage of ct concentrators here in the description that's what we call in the state ct completer okay and so these

[04:41:40] are ct completers are students who have met the requirements of two sequential cte courses and the requirements of graduation and earn an industry recognized credential and so what that is saying is that 89 of students have done that now reading through the data we currently have over 600 individual examinations available for students across the commonwealth okay many of those examinations may not be considered true industry recognized credentials okay and so when we look at

[04:42:17] the number of students that are achieving and meeting this indicator based on examinations that are available that may not be meeting or satisfying that requirement that's how we are arriving at that 89%. Okay. I strongly foresee that that will be, that number will be reduced based on our work around industry recognized credentials. Okay. That will be presented tomorrow. I do foresee that that will be reduced, but in order for us to satisfy our federal requirement, to modify that requirement, we have to justify why we are making that change.

[04:42:55] Okay, same question, just to follow up for the 97% that we have that are achieving any other measure of student success and CT to statewide, blah, blah, blah. And it says technical skills attainment. So what is that one?

[04:43:11] okay so we define technical skills attainment with all of our career and technical education programs we have student competencies okay in each course we bring together a panel of business and industry educators post-secondary professionals to review and validate each one of our courses so technical attainment is based on a student's ability to complete 80 percent of the required competencies of an individual course, okay? And so that's how we define technical skills attainment.

[04:43:43] So that's telling us that students who are engaged in career and technical education programming are satisfying the required competencies of that course. Competency, I'm sorry, Dr. Williams, the competency is measured how? Each course has a list of task competencies that each student is evaluated on. And I would use plumbing that came up as a recent example. The plumbing course has required competencies as determined by business and industry. And these are competencies or tasks

[04:44:16] that students must demonstrate. Each student is evaluated on these task competencies. How we measure technical skills attainment is a student's ability to meet at least 80% of those required competencies from that course. So if a student does not complete or satisfy the requirements of that course, they're not figured into that data element. And so that data element is reported by school divisions for students who have satisfied 80% of those required task competencies. Just say

[04:44:50] the same comment, you know, to have 7% is very high. It's very high. Yes. So I just want us to always be on the lookout for started those saying these are going to be strong high quality pathways and i just want to make sure that you know we're not sliding i get that this is a federal requirement um but as long as we're not counting some of these things the same way that i think would be my biggest caution is because i just don't want us to go in with already seating an expectation that

[04:45:26] clearly is not high enough are there questions or comments here Mr. Hanson are there any gaps current plan or are there any additional areas of new plan when you say gaps could you explain for me just gaps in the areas that you're looking at you're evaluating so key areas that are

[04:46:01] recommendations that we'll be bringing forth at the broad stakeholder consultation meeting number one across many of these areas, our percentages are very, very high. Virginia is leading the way as far as our achievements at the federal level, but to that point, the work that we are currently engaged in, we're going to have to sit back and reevaluate where we are and where we're going.

[04:46:26] High-quality work-based learning is also an indicator that now that we have criteria for high-quality work-based learning, we'll need to go back and we'll need to determine what is going to be an appropriate level for our school to attain. Previously it was 12 experiences, now we have six. Previously there were no requirements, now we have specific criteria. We spoke about industry-recognized

credentials, and then ultimately when we look at 5S2 here, the second line, we talked about post-secondary credits and dual enrollment credit attainment, whether that's

[04:47:01] something we want to pursue or not in alignment with the 3E readiness framework. And so that's just to name a few things. But yes, to your point is that there are gaps, there are deficiencies that we will be addressing because we want our actual performance to align with the performance and success of our students throughout the conversation. Other questions? Very much. Thank you.

[04:47:29] Do you have any questions? Comments? Okay. All right. Our next presentation, Ms. Berta. Oh, all set? All right. Good afternoon, President Creasy, members of the board and Superintendent Gullickson. Today, Deputy Superintendent Booker Dwyer and I are here to share information with you regarding the Education Flexibility Program, also known as EdFlex. So, the EdFlex program is

[04:48:06] authorized under the Education Flexibility Partnership Act of 1999 and was reauthorized through the Every Student Succeeds Act, also known as ESSA. The EdFlex program allows the United state secretary of education to authorize state education agencies that serve an eligible state to waive statutory and regulatory requirements applicable to one or more of the included programs for any local education agency education service agency or a school within a state

[04:48:39] so why does edflex matter edflex empowers schools and the state agency to innovate and redirect funds or flexibility to address specific challenges like learning loss or improving math and reading outcomes without needing direct federal approval for each change there are currently 12 states that are approved and participating in the u.s department of education edflex program including georgia indiana texas pennsylvania north carolina and massachusetts in your slide deck there is a link under the why educate edflex matters for you to take a look at the dear colleague letter that

[04:49:16] was issued by the U.S. Department of Education in September of 2025. This program permits EdFlex states to waive requirements of the following state-administered formula grant programs: Title I, Part A, Title I, Part C, Title I, Part D, Title II, Part A, Title VI, Part A, and I mean, sorry, Title IV, Part A, not VI, and CTE. For more information, there is a link

[04:49:48] that outlines the program significantly it's also linked in your slide deck so an application is submitted to the u.s department of education for review by the u.s secretary of education approval of the applications can be for a period of no more than five years and an extension may be granted by the secretary that she determines the authority of the lea of the sea and the waivers have been effective to states applying for the leas or schools to carry out their state or local

[04:50:22] reform plans to continue to meet accountability requirements as has improved proven student performance improvement. Ms. Booker-Dwyer will now discuss some associated reporting requirements with the program. Thank you and good afternoon board members. A waiver does not exempt us from the accountability requirements associated with with all the title in CTE programs and so we are still required to report how this waiver has impacted student performance so we and that would

[04:51:01] go down to the local education agency they would report to us we would have to report to the u.s department of education we have to report the number of waivers that were granted which waivers this the local education agency used and the impact of the waiver and then we also have to look at how this waiver impacted student performance because the whole point of us looking at these flexibilities is to give school divisions more flexibility to truly impact

[04:51:38] student performance and so we want to ensure that that they are actually doing that and then there's a series of assurances that we have to um to define to sign off on so in our drafted application we have included the following waiver request for consideration the first being title one waiver of carryover right now you are restricted to you must spend down 85 of your title one funds and you can only carry over 15 we are requesting the waiver of that requirement so that when there

[04:52:17] are specific needs in a school or in a school division that they could justify why they needed to carry over 20 for example they could do so without us having to abide by this this requirement and code texas and pennsylvania have successfully implemented this waiver request which allowed maximum flexibilities for their leas to utilize their title one carryover funding to meet specific student needs within the allowance for a one-year period above the 15 percent the second is related to title four if an lea receives an allocation of thirty thousand dollars or greater in any given

[04:52:53] year they must meet the requirements that are defined as minimum for each content area in the code we will continue to maintain the fifteen percent equipment and device limitation however the waiver that we would request would allow the sea to waive the mandatory minimums for each content area if an lea has a comprehensive needs assessment demonstration that they need to use funds in a particular area. This works successfully in Indiana with the requirement of the allocations still greater than $30,000. They had 20% or greater that were to well-rounded student education,

[04:53:31] 20% or greater to safe and healthy students, and 60% or greater to technology with 15% of that being on infrastructure. And they have indicated that the impact has allowed them to award lea's flexibility without that strict adherence to the splits it also encourages the innovative programming and cross-category initiatives which is part of what we're doing in our innovative work but it also reduced the administrative burden while maintaining accountability through the reporting and stakeholder consultation that miss booker dwyer talked about and so she's going to walk you through more of the academic side of the waivers

[04:54:10] and so the first waiver i want to discuss is the paraprofessional waiver right now if a school division wanted to use title one funds to pay for a paraprofessional that paraprofessional would not only have to meet the requirements set forth by the virginia department of education but also those set federally and they're not in alignment and so this limits sometimes because you're you're You're qualified to be a paraprofessional across the state of Virginia, but you can't use the Title I dollars to pay for them until you meet these extra requirements.

[04:54:48] So this waiver puts the power back, give the power back to the states to say, these are the qualifications that we believe make our paraprofessionals excellent, and we can use those Title I dollars to pay for their salaries in those Title I schools.

[04:55:04] And so that is that paraprofessional waiver. then that second waiver, this ranking order waiver. Now the name is a bit misleading because school divisions still would have to rank order their schools. However, what this waiver will allow is that after you have ranked ordered your schools and this waiver gives flexibility with how those schools are ordered, if you have additional funds after you have awarded those funds in that rank order, you can then go to the next level of school to give those Title I funds to. So there

[04:55:39] is a certain percentage range. You can't be beyond the 10 percentage points from the lowest school, from the last school that you awarded those Title I dollars to. So let's say you have a school that is

60% with students with low income, and you give them dollars, and there's dollars left over you can now go to that school that's at 59 percent instead of giving the money back to the state but it's a small window so you still can't give the money to those schools that have a significant portion of students in that are that comes from families from a higher social

[04:56:18] economic status it is still designated for those students from low economic families and this has worked well in Massachusetts where they have used this to modify how a school division is rank ordering their schools to better serve the students in those schools. The final waiver request on there is related to providing a tidings amendment. Currently, VDOE does not have the authority to grant a carryover beyond the 27-month period of a grant. We have to go specifically back

[04:56:55] to USED to request such carryover. This waiver request would authorize us to be able to make that administrative decision at the state level without having to go to USED to ask for that permission. I think this would provide us with some additional flexibility to support school divisions that we may know are struggling to spend down money for whatever variety of reasons they may have, but that gives the authority back to the states rather than having to go to the feds.

[04:57:24] We would also certainly place safeguards in place when we approved waivers to make sure that we were holding their feet to the fire, for a lack of a better way of saying it, for their extension, knowing that we could not grant any further extensions on those federal dollars. Here we're bouncing back and forth.

[04:57:47] And so there are certain things that cannot be waived, and there's a whole list of about 10 items that we cannot waive. When you click on that link in the slide, you'll see that full list of 10, and it's clear like we cannot waive anything concerning health, civil rights, we cannot waive anything regarding students with disabilities, so we're very tight in what we can waive, the requests that we can, the items that we can waive.

[04:58:15] And there's also a link there in the presentation for a full listing if you're interested in exploring what those additional requirements that cannot be waived are. - So an LEA or an individual school may apply for a waiver request based on the guidance from USED.

[04:58:34] We would implement a process with the deputy superintendent of budget and finance in coordination with the director of grant administration to be our program manager for the EdFlex in Virginia. They would have the responsibility of overseeing the application approval process and monitoring of the local education agency's EdFlex waivers.

[04:58:53] It's important to note that this would be done in coordination with other offices. this would not be a function of finance alone this would cross function into duane and tiara's worlds too just to make sure from the academic perspective we are looking at all things before we would grant any waivers a school and or an lea will be able to ask for the waivers needed during the initial grant process we would publish this item in a separate form to be filed individually as part of a grant amendment process in the initial application or amendment process the lea must state the following the regulation or portion of the statute will in which the lea wishes to have

[04:59:32] waived the purpose of waiving the regulation and how it would directly tie to increased levels of achievement and performance applicable evidence if any which indicates the waiver will improve student performance and achievement the performance measures the lea would use to track the

effectiveness effectiveness of the waiver request and how that effectiveness will be measured and reported and the alignment between the lea's stated performance measures and the long-term goals and accountability metrics stated within our approved essa plan included in the presentation is a link to the 2023-24 report to congress which provides information on how other

[05:00:10] states and leas and schools have successfully implemented edflex in their states the at 11. so the video grants team will review the waiver request for completeness and quality the grant specialist or coordinator will review to ensure that the provisions that are waived are provisions which we are empowered to waive under the edflex approved application if initially approved the

[05:00:44] videoe grant director of federal for the director of grant administration will conduct a secondary review to ensure that we have coordination between the other divisions and the other offices agree with the waiver request the director of grant administration will approve the waiver request after a collaborative review and provide no have provided they have no additional concerns we would typically review complete those reviews within 30 business days leas will include in an end of year report their progress towards stated outcomes in an annual performance report or financial end report which would be due more than 90 days after the award year in which the waiver

[05:01:24] applies. BDOE will utilize this information to determine eligibility for any future waiver requests. The waiver request process will occur on an annual basis and will cover one year or a fiscal year depending on the waiver requested, whether it's programmatic or fiscal. So by next steps, prior to submitting our waiver application to the U.S. Department of Education, we need to provide all LEAs with notice and reasonable opportunity to comment on this request. This notice will be followed through the following steps. One, a presentation to the Board of Ed, which we have just delivered on the waiver request and note that we are seeking public comment.

[05:02:05] The superintendent will send an email to all of our LEAs via superintendent's email, as well as multiple notifications in a weekly superintendent's newsletter with all of the key information in a consolidated format. Public comment and review will be obtained through the town hall forum and discussion of the waiver requests will happen on a superintendent's call with regional superintendents tiara and i appreciate the opportunity to present our edflex proposed application with you and are happy to answer any questions that you may have

[05:02:37] any questions here superintendent thank you president creasy team thank you for that robust overview especially highlighting the array of states that are already utilizing edflex for the board's reminder this is not new but it's new to virginia and so since 1999 there has been at the federal level the education flexibility partnership act and it was reauthorized in the every student succeeds act and so for those at home who think

[05:03:12] this might be a big shift we're just really seeing the great alignment to the board's priorities the general assembly's priorities the governor's priorities and the governor elects priorities around how do we continue to drive change for student outcomes and give autonomy where principals, superintendents want to seek it.

[05:03:32] And also making sure from the agency level that we can maximize every dollar to work for students and gives our team more flexibility to drive strategic decisions on those dollars and uses instead of consistently having to go back to the federal government to seek permission for what we know is best for our Virginia students.

[05:03:54] And so we're very excited about that. If you want to have more examples like the ones that you heard today and are tuning in, on the bottom of slide 10 is a great recap from other states down to individual local education agencies on the types of waivers they sought with their own departments of education.

[05:04:15] And we have great thought partnership across the political spectrum on how folks have embraced this in their own communities that Virginia is looking to for counsel and best practices so we can illustrate that and provide those as samples for divisions here locally.

[05:04:31] So I'm very excited about what this means, especially under all of our work ahead with the school performance and support framework to provide even more tools for divisions to leverage on more autonomy over dollars and making sure that they're working for kids.

[05:04:51] - Anybody else have questions before I dive in? question for you. Don't go anywhere. You're gonna run away. Okay, so this is really around how we're supporting divisions to know and understand what all of these provisions mean, and how to spend down their money. This seems to be particularly in smaller school divisions.

[05:05:18] Those who are responsible for title programs, it's it often is a secondary thought. And so They are often not very well equipped with how to just even start working on this stuff, right? It's a scary federal program that people are like, oh, or programs that they just don't want to dive into.

[05:05:41] We also have an additional kind of wrench, and that is that we have 14 bypass divisions that just came out of federal bypass. So they have never directly worked with title programs and had to really have anything to do with the exercise of working with their local schools and school divisions, how they work in the equitable services arena.

[05:06:12] and so I think that's something that I do really believe that those specifically those 14 divisions need quite a bit of support in how they work with um with and within these programs so I just want to highlight that for you all as it may not be at the top of your list of things but I personally am very concerned about ensuring that those particular 14 school divisions do have all the support that they need in order to ensure that their students in their local school divisions

[05:06:46] are getting the the all of the things that they deserve to get out of this yeah appreciate that and um our esea team is actually having calls with those 14 school districts um to share with them things but i will also say this is the passion point you've heard stacy and i both talk about this we've told a number of we've hosted a number of technical support trainings and others so equitable services is on the list if this application gets approved we would want to do lunch and learn series around us to make sure that we set everybody up for success it's new um but your your point is well taken so appreciate that and we will continue to work

[05:07:24] improve communication from the department to school divisions thank you so much anybody have any additional questions or comments here thanks Dr. Hollins welcome good noon president president Creasy board members and Superintendent Gullickson. It's a pleasure to be with you all today, particularly to inform your discussion of students within the accountability framework

[05:07:59] and the student support work that you all have been doing. It's my goal today to share with you what it takes to develop and sustain positive outcomes for students with disabilities in light of our state prioritization of higher expectations for all students. The role of the state education agency is to prioritize

key levers to make impact at the student level alongside collaborative partnership with local school division and our providers. So today we're really just going to dive into just trying to advance the slides here. Oh, look at that. It works. Perfect. So what I'd

[05:08:36] like to start off with is just talking through levers that are probably very familiar to all of you here on the dais. But most importantly, these are the things that we know through research and practice work to benefit students with disabilities. You'll see here some information around identification and eligibility of students with disabilities.

[05:08:53] The most important thing is for us to accurately and inform and with information, identify the students that need support as a result of their disability. The Virginia numbers that you see here and some of the data breakouts represents around 15% of our student population, which is right in line with the national average.

[05:09:13] And so while you see that Virginia is growing, is not meaningfully out of line with other states including our closest neighbors that look very similar to us in demographics and population we also know that once we appropriately identify students and the impact of their educational disability it's incredibly important to develop a high quality individualized education program or iep that is designed to meet their needs and see them to fulfillment and achievement in the areas where they need additional support and assistance. And many of you will be familiar with the amazing work that this administration has done on implementing add-ons to the Virginia IEP, the statewide individualized education program system

[05:09:53] that has helped to support school divisions with increased progress monitoring for students, more engagement and communication with parents and families, and increased translation capability for some of our English language learners and their families. We also know that family engagement is incredibly important, particularly the functional application of students' rights.

[05:10:16] And so making sure that not only are parents and families informed and that information is flowing directly home, but also how can we continue to support parents? And you'll see in a later slide some of the specific supports and educational opportunities we have specifically crafted for family members in order to make sure that they can access those rights and implement them fully.

[05:10:35] I want to take a minute and speak a little bit about professional development. I know this is topic that you all were incredibly interested in during our last conversation and i just want to share that we have had some really successful partnerships with folks that we hear from quite frequently here at the state board like our virginia association of elementary school principals the virginia association of secondary school principals to really have a highlight reel of opportunities that we've had over the last year that are continuing as planned and so all the way back in uh summer this summer actually june we had our content teaching academies in partnership with our t-tech network and those organizations where we were able to train 578 pre-k to 12 general

[05:11:14] education teachers and administrators in specially designed instruction back in october i talked to you briefly about our partnership with va esp and va ssp on training approximately 610 building level administrators and division leaders and instruction for students with disabilities and coming up in december we are already fully booked for our training that we have in partnership with james Madison University, with a focus on principals and assistant principals. And so I just want you all to know that the call for additional supports directly to teaching staff and administrators in buildings is happening, and we are getting really positive feedback and really constructive feedback

[05:11:53] on how to continue to make those opportunities more useful for our school staff when they're with us. I also wanted to mention Diploma Pathways. You know, we are very clear in special education what our goal is we do not hide that from anybody and we definitely want to make sure that that's something that is very clear to all stakeholders we want our students to graduate with a meaningful diploma something that creates a transition point for them to education to employment or enlistment and as you can see from the data provided on this screen in virginia we measure that success from our meaningful graduation and so this graph shows you both our target and our result for how

[05:12:32] we have improved those outcomes for students with disabilities specifically on gaining a standard diploma in Virginia and you can see that over the last decade we have set high expectations for ourselves and we have increased that target and have shown that we have jumped from you know in the 50 percentage points up to almost getting close to 90 now of students in those disability groups graduating with a standard diploma which is really on the the backs and the efforts of our school staff and making sure that those outcomes are achievable. That continuous improvement has been shown statewide and really has unpacked regionally and coordinated efforts to support

[05:13:09] teacher effectiveness which has contributed directly to the rising graduation rates you see on the slide. One thing I want to talk about is noting a pattern from what we were just talking about. Virginia has been thoughtfully increasing the target but also adapting supports to enable student success. A similar approach will be needed as we ensure that cut scores are aligned with what we know Virginia students should know and should be able to do. Here are just a few examples of how we will support the field to adapt. One, we know that students with disabilities likely require specially designed instruction in order to address the impact of their disability in the educational setting. We know they will also need assessment

[05:13:48] accommodations and modifications as part of their IEPs that will carry over from the instructional setting to the assessment setting, and we know that students may require multiple attempts on required assessments to be successful, aligned with appropriate interventions. In addition, the Department understands that there needs to be flexibility in how students can demonstrate competency, especially for our students with disabilities.

[05:14:10] This is not about lowering expectations, but is a set of agency-level policies and procedures that provide flexibility and autonomy to school-based teams who know their students best. talk a little bit about how the department will use data to support the field and using their own data to individualize supports for schools and students. First, we will prioritize schools with the greatest need and look specifically at what their needs are. As you might imagine, this will look different for elementary schools than it will for our middle and high schools. Let's use an example of an elementary school, however, for today. So let's suppose that we're talking about supporting elementary schools and data around literacy, particularly for students with disabilities.

[05:14:50] We know that with the changes and the innovations that the Virginia Literacy Act has brought, we have key levers in order to ascertain what those issues might be and how to developmentally address them. Most importantly, is the school using high quality curriculum for instruction and literacy? And with that curriculum, are we then using appropriate and students with disability-specific intervention materials that fit that need or the gap that we're seeing in the data? Bottom line, there's a lot going on in our schools. We're not telling them to start over.

[05:15:19] telling them to use the tools that both the state and their division have provided in order to make that growth and adjustment and to focus based on data. We know the importance of those early grades and ensuring identification of appropriate students, but we also know that ongoing support is going to be needed to address those areas. We also know that the IEP is a specific pivot point for students in making sure that it's aligned to their needs and implemented with fidelity at the classroom level. We also know that this is about support and not just about support that we talk about or put on a one pager but really boots on the ground and i do want to state that in special

[05:15:54] education this has been really tried and true for us since the beginning and we already have an established regional network of our training technical assistance centers that provide boots on the ground supports hand in hand with teachers paraprofessionals and building level administrators it's all about taking what we know now and improving the practice of what we've done it's also critical to recognize parents as our students first and most important educators we know that we've received a ton of questions and comments from parents who are wondering what this means for their students in particular and how we can all work together to support students with

[05:16:29] these higher expectations. I'll walk through a few of the resources that the department has created or has funded in collaboration with objective providers and parent and family advocacy and resource centers such as our state PTI. You'll see here on this slide we have some ready-to-go on-demand resources that are available to parents in bite-sized chunks that can easily be accessed on a cell phone. Things like our critical decision points training that can help parents think through their child's educational career either start to finish or where they currently are now. What decision points need to be made? What kind of assessment questions should I be asking? Do I know what diploma option might be the most appropriate for our family? We also have a

[05:17:09] family guide to special education that has been updated and translated into multiple language that's designed to walk families through the special education process, which can be really overwhelming, but how can we break it down? And we also have one-pagers associated with each of the key decision points that can help support teams as they walk and support families. And most importantly, the critical decision point in identifying students, we've created a video guide to the special education evaluation process for families that walks them through how to articulate their concerns and also know what's coming up if their student is currently being assessed or if

[05:17:43] have concerns for them being assessed for special education services. We have such an amazing array of parental and family support providers in the Commonwealth, and the department is pleased to partner with them in a way to offer objective and support for families from other families and parents, which is incredibly helpful. So our partnership with the Parent Education Advocacy Training Center, or PEATSEE, our state PTI, has staff that are boots on the ground in regions available to meet with parents either over their phone, in community centers, in their schools, next to their grocery stores, whatever it takes. PC does an amazing job of providing

[05:18:21] folks that can walk parents through and just hear their concerns and talk to them from a perspective of been there, done that. We have a lot of great opportunities to support any kind of disagreements or dispute resolution both from the state level and also amping up our work on things like facilitated IEPs. How can we help teams come together and make decisions that help provide parental and family input and as always our family ombudsman for special education is available 24 hours a day with

less than 24 hour turnaround for any parent calls or emails that come into the department which is incredibly important for us especially in this critical time now let's

[05:18:59] shift to educators before jumping into the resources i think it's really helpful to frame how we think about this work and most importantly how we collaborate with school divisions who who receive the majority of their financial resources to support students with disabilities.

[05:19:14] At the state level, we've set guiding principles that we want to see implemented in all 131 of Virginia school divisions. We know that each division is unique, so these are guiding principles, not specific rules. They help to articulate the vision, which starts with high quality grade level instruction for every student, including our students with disabilities.

[05:19:33] We know that it's important to be tight on the things that matter, and that is our outcomes, right? What do we want to see? are our expectations but we also know it's important to be flexible to the needs of a community and how we can wrap around supports to school divisions i think you'll see in some of those professional development opportunities i talked about we've tried to articulate that balance we've one made them available to schools and divisions across the states but we have prioritized working with our divisions that have identified the subgroup of students with disabilities as an area that they need help and support with those divisions and schools are first in line for those opportunities and we make sure they can take advantage of them. Virginia is also serving as a national example in

[05:20:12] this work. The National Center for Systemic Improvement has aligned closely to the work that we're doing here to show how states can lever expectations into meaningful work boots on the ground for our teachers and administrators. We know that that research is important and most importantly to share with state exemplars that are doing the same work and how we can learn from them and benefit from their experience.

[05:20:36] Finally, I just wanna note that I mentioned before our training and technical assistance centers. We have a TTAC in each superintendent's region of the state based at an Institute of Higher Education, which is one, incredibly important for staying close to what we know is effective for students, but two, it means that there is a hub for that connection for our educators and administrators.

[05:20:56] TTAC has done an amazing job in partnering with us on each of these professional development opportunities, past, current, and we hope future as well. We know that instructional resources are key for those guiding principles. School leadership and staff have to have high expectations for our students, and we have seen firsthand the embrace that they have of inclusion across the Commonwealth.

[05:21:16] IEPs must be meaningful, reflect collaboration, and also ensure to address all student needs. Students with disabilities must be taught in settings using curriculum that is aligned with state learning standards special general education teachers and administrators and administrators must collaborate on planning and delivering research-based effective and differentiated instruction we have to continue to build our expertise on providing appropriate assistive technology to accommodate our students positive behavioral supports are incorporated in school-wide approaches to discipline and we know most importantly that school divisions parents and

[05:21:53] children benefit and build relationships when divisions and parents work together to resolve problems. State education agencies are responsible for monitoring local level implementation of IDEA and

supporting improvement when needed. It has been my pleasure to walk you through today with what VDOE sees as the opportunity states now have with more flexibility to determine what to focus on our efforts in supporting students with disabilities. I'm happy to answer any questions or take any feedback? Dr. Ackerman? You mentioned flexibility in the assessment. Can you give some maybe examples or descriptions of what you meant by that? Absolutely. Great question. So with

[05:22:32] flexibility with assessment types, we also talk about accommodating students and modifying assessments when appropriate. So for example, an accommodation might be a read aloud assessment for a student or things that are successful for that student in an instructional setting that can be modified and used in an assessment protocol. We also know that it could be a modification. Some of our students are not able to be successful with the SOL test, so we could use an alternative assessment program in order to verify their skills and report on their performance. And the key to that is using the IEP, what we know is successful for students instructionally, having that carried

[05:23:08] over to assessments and continuing to work hand in hand with other offices at the department so that we're all on the same page with what that assistive technology and augmentative communication can do to support student needs. Thank you. And so when I look at slide, what is this with the graph?

[05:23:23] I love this graph and the improvement of the years and graduation. When I look at that slide and it says 85 standard, is that including the VAP? And also when you say alternative, are you referring to the VAP? Yes. When I was talking about modification of assessment types, I'm absolutely referring to programs like the Virginia Alternate Assessment Program. However, this graph only represents students with disabilities who are being tested within the sols and achieving a standard diploma with the accommodations on the absolutely and then do we know um when the parents get the reports on those new assessments about accommodations and that might not be for you i

[05:24:00] don't know if we've kind of field tested the reports with accommodations and students with disabilities and if there's any change to what that report might look like for parents uh thank you we are currently doing focus groups with families so we will make sure that at least one of those focus groups are largely from parents of students with disabilities if not more and obviously uh you know with the new cut scores this is an area that is very important and dear to my heart um and i don't know i would love at some point if if we can see what the data what this

[05:24:39] type of charts going to look like with new cut scores I know that might be hard with the accommodations to be able to know exactly what that would look like but I know we've kind of asked that before what the different subgroups look like as it relates to this and and I know some of this is tomorrow too so whether a year is enough lead time to be sure all these things that are already in place in the department of education um with my heart specific specifically for students

[05:25:14] with disabilities so because again we don't want to lower the standard everybody's heard me say that we want them taking the same assessment everybody else is taking but we want to see them graduate and employable so um just kind of laying that out there for my colleagues for questions here mr hansen it's the working relationship or disposition with us department this time i know know we've had a lot of activity the prior years but just any guidance or partnership or other priorities coming from the department yeah great question I'll let superintendent Gullickson weigh

[05:25:51] in as well I will say that we are on track with our program awards and grant functions that are the most important for us making sure that school divisions have access to funding we continue to have

questions answered and get responses from the department I will say this is a time of year where we're really busy in gathering data that we'll report not soon after, not too late after the beginning of the year. So I think that will be a critical time period to make sure that we're still on track with what the expectation is. But as I stated, I think the most important thing that the current climate is giving us is flexibility. And for Virginia, we know that we're coming off

[05:26:27] of a targeted monitoring visit from the U.S. Department of Education in 2024 that was 100% endorsing our general supervision and monitoring framework and dispute resolution, which I think puts a vote of confidence in our work, but most importantly, allows us now to turn our attention to something that we all are very passionate about, and that's student outcomes. And so that's what state education agencies do best. Any flexibility that's afforded to us to do that work in a way that's meaningful for Virginia is a win in my book.

[05:26:56] On slide two where you had some of the student data, are you just seeing any trends of younger students coming in with different types or are there different populations of disabilities or types of things that we need to be looking for down the road of some of the challenges or just the shifts that might be happening?

[05:27:21] Yeah, great question. So timely with the December 1 child count right upon us. I will say that we have been pretty steady, as have some other big state players. So one that gives us an assurance for the rates of identification that we're saying. I will say that if you talk to local school divisions, they will tell you, one, we're getting better at identifying students earlier, particularly for critical intervention, but that behavioral concerns continue to be the priority for them and how to intervene as early as possible and as critical as possible with students who have behavioral challenges.

[05:27:54] And that's rampant in everything from fiscal data to programmatic data. And so you will see a lot of the support that we've been putting out has been in working to support behavior modifications and planning. And we have some great new resources. If anybody's a fan of Choose Your Own Adventure, you guys remember that?

[05:28:10] Am I dating myself? We have a great functional behavior assessment protocol now that is a Choose Your Own Adventure. So it helps a practitioner walk through a real-life concern they may be having with a student and try out different interventions and really get the feel for how to instruct students behaviorally the same way we do academically, which is critically important.

[05:28:32] I think that's the challenge that we need to continue to keep our eyes on in order to support our teachers that are dealing with those challenges day in and day out. Are there questions or comments here? Dr. Norther?

[05:28:49] So if I could recommend one thing to read for our teachers and educators, I'm a big fan of Nate Levinson. I believe we had worked with him for a little while here, but he was a school superintendent in Massachusetts and had a real heart for special education and did some pretty phenomenal things in Arlington, Massachusetts. And the article's called Something Has Got to Change, Rethinking Special Education. It's a little dated, 2011, but it's very user-friendly.

[05:29:22] he's also written a book for school leaders called six shifts to improve special education, a common sense approach for school leaders. Some of the things that he said over the years that really resonated with me is reading, reading, reading, reading. And it's, it's really that that's one of the primary

ways that we raise the achievement of a special of kids with special needs, because reading is obviously the gateway to all of the learning. You've got to read to know, you know, social studies and science and math and word problems and math.

[05:29:52] and the other point he's made quite a bit is that sometimes kids with special needs just need more time to learn and so um i think in his district he would often give them um take the same course like twice a day and maybe the second time you take the course it's maybe like 12 or 15 like a smaller class size but just it's sometimes i guess what i'm saying is it's not like this huge thing right it's like you need more time give them another class or and with the behavior that's the other thing that points he makes he's like a lot of these kids need a behavioral specialist they don't necessarily have a learning disability they need a behavioral specialist that can often

[05:30:29] get them out of that diagnosis if they get that behavioral specialist and I think yeah I don't know I just would advise us to look at some of the work that he did in that state because I really think it resonated with a lot of folks and we actually did a study and looked at some of the of things he did and found that the interventions that he was implementing in other states because now he owns his own consulting firm goes around talking to this about the country was that he was actually doing things interventions that were less expensive and that the kids saw higher gain

[05:31:05] kind of like a win-win here yeah absolutely dr northern one i really appreciate that feedback too we we are big fans obviously dr levinson worked with us directly on the 2024 special education Roadmap. But we also have copies of his book, Six Shifts, that we bought for our whole staff and for the T-Tax. And so you're right. And I hope you see it in this presentation as well, like these first two slides. Nothing here is earth-shattering or different. If you're in special ed, you know there's no mystery to the work that we do. It's hard work, but we know what works for the students we're talking about. So I agree 100%. And a lot of the work we're doing boots on the ground in those

[05:31:43] sessions for our professional development, you'll see things like school and class level scheduling to make sure the intervention is timed so kids aren't missing out on direct instruction, God forbid, right? How can we support behavioral modifications? Working closely with folks like ABA therapists within our school settings. So absolutely, I think that's great advice. And I was really excited actually a couple of weeks ago to be with other state leaders in special education, including Jamie Camacho, who runs Massachusetts. And we all talk frequently and are benefiting from that online discussion and continuing collaboration to not recreate the wheel, to just get better at

[05:32:17] this work. Yeah. Dr. Ackerman? Along the behavior, though, I mean, I think our colleagues would be interested to know there's been a lot of changes and funding issues that make some of that a little bit of a challenge. I mean, they used to have day treatment in a lot of the schools, and then that ran into some challenges with funding. And then, you know, they actually have separate funding in Virginia that you've heard people talk about as guests on Community Services Act. It might be worth the board understanding some of those things, but there are things in place that make

[05:32:50] some of the abilities of third-party behavioral specialist interventionalist harder to work with the public schools. And so there are interesting barriers that consist in how we can, since behavior came up from both you and dr hollins um there are interesting however there was a lot of money just recently put into some of the mental health initiatives and i think that's kind of a new avenue but at some point we might want to park on on behavior as a board and figure out how to

[05:33:27] help our preschool early childhood kindergarten folks because we often hear from them begging for help so but anyway just some little tidbits and sidebars no and both piggybacking on dr Ackerman and Dr. Northern. You know, literacy is so important, not only for academic achievement, but also for helping with behavior. If a student is having trouble reading that, that can contribute to a lot of issues. So it's no mistake that when Chief Conway and I sat down to do this presentation that we focused on a literacy example. And Dr. Wallace isn't here, but I can feel her presence.

[05:34:00] And she would remind us that Nate Levinson is also continuing to partner with us on our federal literacy grant, and many of our divisions are working closely. So it's just great to hear the questions that are really highlighting the work that we're doing and and amplifying that so i'm so appreciative to the board for that superintendent colleagues great thank you um member ackerman number one this is why we thought it was so strategic to realign as part of our reorg at the agency um to move special education and special populations under this new overarching

[05:34:36] branch that's early childhood through the continuum of adult learners so i'm so glad you raised that so that Dr. Hollins and Chief Conway can work closely together on that continuum, data sharing, etc. The other question that was asked earlier by Member Hansen, I just want to echo what Dr. Hollins noted. We have a great collaborative partnership with U.S. Ed. We are very pleased with their selection of Diana Diaz as their Deputy Assistant Secretary for Special

[05:35:09] education and the team that she's building up around her and a proud virginian so great for us to have that additional thought partnership and collaboration especially going into this 50th anniversary of ida and all dollars continue to flow which i will say again into the microphone our federal grants especially for ida are still being fully reimbursed and have not had any disruption or changes there so we are maximizing dollars to work for students if i can may i i just

[05:35:49] want to echo what you shared about diana diaz um and the deputy superintendent i've gotten to know her a little bit as well and she's a son with autism and um just really has a heart for special education and i really do believe we're in a good place with the usdo as a matter of fact her son she shared with me her son's name is sam holland so she never forgets our our um dr holland's name because of that so anyway sam holland's the better thank you all so much here so i do have a couple

[05:36:26] of well just one question really we were talking earlier about our gifted um some shifts in our gifted greener and just generally um can you talk to me a little bit about the historical conversations, if there ever have been, around students in Virginia. So us having more of a student services type approach to special education that's broader than students with disabilities, but it's also including gifted students, particularly in the area of like an IEP for gifted students. Yeah, that's a great question, President Creasy. And I will say there

[05:37:06] have been fluctuations over time within the agency. However, as Superintendent Gullickson mentioned, one of the more recent changes we've made have been to realign the support of student services, which for us includes everything from behavioral wellness to student safety under the same umbrella. I will say that's been really helpful for school divisions. One, it streams line our approach to school-based mental health, which is such a key factor for many of our most vulnerable students. But two, Virginia has a robust history in offering a lot of guidance and support when it comes to twice exceptional students as well. And we know that that goes hand in hand with students. And so I'm really excited to be working with the team on a lot of the advances

[05:37:42] we're making to gifted learning as well. And I think our collaboration is incredibly important and Superintendent Gullickson has taken it upon herself to help thread that needle across our three columns of work. And so I think the answer for now is while there's been a lot of work to date, I think the work now and moving forward is much more strategic and will offer us an opportunity to partner closer together and support students that have a lot of unique needs across multiple of our offices where we provide that direct technical assistance. And I'm certain you would love to work with Ms. Nevitral to kind of hone in some of her recommendations as far as

[05:38:19] the regulatory changes that we suggested she come back to us with. So maybe that's a way to further thread the needle there. 100%. That's a wonderful suggestion. We'll be tuned to that. And I know she was headed to meet with some other folks across states this week. So we're anxious to hear back and we'll definitely keep our ear to the ground thank you my pleasure any other questions or comments here thank you all so much for your time okay so now we are moving to unless you all need

[05:38:52] a break do we need a break really quickly who needs a break are we okay keep going okay we'll keep going we'll keep going okay good afternoon again board members and I am here need to pull the memorandum of understanding slide so while they are doing that i am here with two of my team members in the office of school improvement dr ballard and dr holliman who will support this

[05:39:31] presentation today and we're going to go over the history of the memorandum of understanding school divisions and the whole purpose of this connection with these divisions is really to help improve student outcomes to strengthen support to those school divisions so that we can help to support improvement of those students the mou it is this formal agreement between the board of virginia board of education and that local school board the mous they look different for every school division so when you look at your attachments attachment one is the tool that has historically been used to

[05:40:12] initiate a division level review and then you have the each mou for the current divisions that are in mou status and the way that this has historically worked is that when a division is identified for an mou they first must undergo a division level review and then the outcomes of that division level review informs the mou and so dr ballad is going to walk us through the history

[05:40:40] of MOUs starting in 2004. Thank you, Deputy Superintendent Booker Dwyer. To President Creasy, members of the board, State Superintendent Gullickson, agency leaders and viewers, my name is Quentin Ballard, as it has been shared. I have the pleasure of serving as the director in the Office of School Improvement, and it truly is a pleasure to be with you this afternoon.

[05:41:14] So as presented here, since 2004, eight school divisions have entered into a Memorandum of Understanding Agreement with the Virginia Board of Education after the completion of a division-level academic review. The division-level academic review, a process used to conduct an analysis of a division's systems and practices in a variety of areas, was actually first approved by the board in 2004. Shortly thereafter, in 2004 to 2005, division-level reviews were conducted in Lee

[05:41:51] County, Sussex County, Petersburg City, and an MOU agreement were developed and implemented. In 2005, a division-level academic review was also conducted in Richmond City Public Schools, and an MOU was subsequently developed and implemented. Two school divisions exited MOU status two years after entering into an agreement with the board, which were Lee County Public Schools in 2006 and Richmond City Public Schools in 2007. And so in 2009, two years later, the board

[05:42:30] revised the MOUs for Sussex County and Petersburg City and later revised the division level academic review criteria in 2012. Two years later, Franklin City Public Schools had a division-level academic review conducted and actually entered into an MOU with the board while Sussex County Public Schools MOU was revised. And it was in 2015 and 16 that Petersburg City Public Schools MOU was revised.

[05:43:04] Again, one year later in 2017, Sussex County Public Schools exited and Richmond City Public Schools requested a division-level review. The review was conducted and resulted in a new MOU for Richmond. In 2018, Franklin City Public Schools exited MOU status and Greensville County Public Schools was identified for a division-level review and subsequently had an MOU developed and implemented as well.

[05:43:33] Finally, it was in 2019-2020 that Danville City Public Schools and Prince Edward County Public School Board requested division-level reviews that led to the existing MOU agreements both divisions are operating within today.

[05:43:50] To date, we have five divisions operating within a memorandum of understanding agreement with the board. These divisions have been operating within these agreements with the board ranging from five years up to 21 years.

[05:44:13] I'd like to note that for two of the total years that you see at this time, these divisions that these divisions have been in MOU status. They could not exit because school accreditation ratings were waived due to the impact of COVID.

[05:44:29] for accreditation years 2020 2021 and then 2021 2022. Now out of the five three of those out of the five uh existing divisions three of the five wrote to the state superintendent and or the Virginia board president to request the division level uh academic review one volunteered in 2004 which was Petersburg to undergo the division level review back in 2004 and then there was one division, Greensville County Public Schools, which was identified by the board to actually

[05:45:02] undergo a division level academic review in 2000 and I believe it was 2018. And so the MOU, the division level review was conducted and the division is currently operating under the existing MOU that it has. While there are commonalities among the MOU agreements, for instance, many of them are actually grounded in four to five division level review categories or priorities that you see before you. And those categories are academic and student success, leadership and

[05:45:38] governance, operations and support services, human resource leadership, community relations, and communication. In addition, many of these divisions that have actually had a change in leadership at the division superintendent level upon entering into these agreements. And the state superintendent board chair have supported them through the process of identifying a new superintendent in the event that there is a vacancy. And so while there are commonalities,

[05:46:18] there are differences in these MOUs as well, which one of them, one of the major differences you'll find would be the exit criteria here that is presented before you. Several of these divisions certainly have shown improvement in the numbers of schools I guess in the old system you know the number of schools that are accredited or fully accredited without conditions however the exit criteria for these divisions the exit criteria actually differ and it ranges as you can see between one year of all schools being accredited or fully accredited or having

[05:46:52] to obtain a status where two for two consecutive years that all schools are accredited without any uh condition yes ma'am hold for just a second we have a couple of questions absolutely um i know uh mr green has some questions and so do i go right ahead mr green uh i guess so my question at the slide before where it talks about the total number of years that each of these uh specific school divisions has been under mou and i'm sure i'm looking at the same list my colleagues here

[05:47:32] are looking at and i see where for example petersburg city public schools has been under MOU 21 years. 21 years, my math is right, it's about two decades plus one year. And over the course of 21 years, I'm sure the state has worked very closely with the city of Petersburg and their school board and their leadership to address certain academic deficiencies to get them on a path where they can exit from their MOU. I'm sure a lot of money has been invested, that a lot of supports have been identified to help them work with their student body

[05:48:11] to get them onto a path of academic success. Based on what you know and based on what your team has been able, I guess, to learn, do you see in the foreseeable future where there's a path to exit for Petersburg City from this MOU that has been under over two decades?

[05:48:40] The answer to that question would certainly be that there certainly is a path forward, and I think the revised standards of accreditation kind of outline a different exit criteria, if you will, for these divisions to be subject to have to undergo a division-level academic review and or subsequently enter into an MOU.

[05:49:03] What I will say to you is, and, you know, President Creasy has been an active participant in more recently. My tenure here at the agency has been for about, you know, I'll be approaching about four years, and so I can certainly speak to that. One of the challenges that I would say that we've certainly have been working more recently over the last four years that I have experienced would be that the division has had turnover, what I would say, at the division superintendent level.

[05:49:30] As I approach about my fourth year here at the agency, they've had, if you count the interim, number of interim superintendents and current superintendents, they've had about five. And so we have been leaning in and are really excited about the new superintendent that is there, who appears to certainly have a commitment, has worked to put student academic performance and outcomes, I think, at the forefront.

[05:50:00] has worked to hire and recruit, if you will, division and school leaders nationally to bring them in, to be of service to Petersburg and get some stability, not only at the division leadership level, but also into their schools. Because when she came about 15 months ago, there was one assistant superintendent that was on the division team, and she had to also hire about four four principals. So what I would say to you, sir, is, you know, as an agency, we continue to leverage

[05:50:38] working with our department offices to provide, prioritize professional development to our MOU divisions, and that includes Petersburg. We prioritize seats for professional learning and technical assistance and have been intentional in trying to walk alongside them shoulder to shoulder.

[05:51:01] I can speak to this current administration and say that, you know, I can say from what I'm seeing, things are going in the right direction. But this type of system change, to be candid with you, certainly does take does take time. You need people and it takes time, people that are committed and it takes time.

[05:51:19] Got you right. So with so much turnover in a relatively short period of time with respect to division leadership, specifically superintendent, because they are on the MOU, do we, meaning DOE, participate or I guess participate, for lack of a better word, for right now, in the selection of superintendent or division leader?

[05:51:43] Great question. Yes, sir. What we can say with the recent hire, President Creasy certainly was a part of that process and works alongside the state superintendent in division having to submit applicant criteria to the state superintendent and to the board president for the information to actually be reviewed.

[05:52:09] and again working alongside a division school board chair and leadership to select leaders in that division. And that applies to all five of them. We have certainly worked alongside Prince Edward County Public Schools as well. They're in year one of their new superintendent. Dr. Jones is in year one there, who has transitioned from Cumberland to Prince Edward. And right now, Greensville County Public Schools. We're supporting them. They have an acting superintendent that is in

[05:52:44] place right now and supporting them. I would also like to just simply highlight in leveraging external partnerships that we've also been working with VSBA, who has been a great partner in not only providing board governance training for these boards, but also helping them with their superintendent search process. And so I do want to take an opportunity to say that it's not all on the agency, we leverage these external partnerships in working with them. And I would say also VAST has been instrumental and helpful as well when we may have an unexpected transition. And if it is

[05:53:21] such that we need to recruit or help the division with identifying an interim qualified candidate to assist them and support them, they have been also helpful in that regard. And so I would want to take an opportunity to lift that up. And can I just jump in as well, Dr. Ballett. So this just speaks to, we have to do some things differently.

[05:53:41] And that's what Dr. Ballard is talking about. And I'm just very excited, for instance, with Petersburg. On Monday, we're taking a whole team of people from the State Department. We're all gonna go down and sit and meet with the superintendent, her titles team. We have our, you just heard Chief Berta present.

[05:53:57] We're taking members of her team and we're all coming around the table to strategize how can we move this and make sure that, you know, the finances, the school improvement, Everything's in alignment. So when we're talking about working cross-divisionally, Dr. Ballard set that whole meeting up for us so that we can all come to the table and start working because 21 years is too long.

[05:54:22] Dr. Ballard, can I ask a question, though? So I guess one of the things that I want us to talk about, too, besides just what's kind of been going on for a really long time in Petersburg, is the exit, the entry and exit, and then re-entry of Richmond City Public Schools.

[05:54:49] Do you have a little bit more historical information about that 2005 to 2007 MOU and why it was such a brief period of time? and what were the, what were the criterion used for exit, as well as what was the environment at the time that allowed for that exit? If you, if you know that historical information that you could provide for us, please. Question, if you don't mind, I'm going to actually, I think, throw the alley hoop up to my colleague here, Dr. Yvonne Holloman, who is our special projects

[05:55:29] coordinator. She is actually the former interim director and associate director in the office of school improvement. And so she would be able to certainly share with the board not only this, more

details about the division level academic review process, and subsequently the processes associated with the development and implementations of these MOUs, but she also is our subject matter expert Miss Creasy in this arena and she led our office efforts in the last division level review and MOU developments for Danville and Prince Edward she was also here in the agency

[05:56:06] at the time that you just asked a question about and so I think if it's okay with you I'm going to turn it over to her to maybe be able to answer that that predate that predates me

[05:56:25] good afternoon everyone I'm Yvonne Holloman the special projects coordinator with the office of school improvement I've actually been with the agency since 2007 and so President Creasy I actually joined the agency the year the month that Richmond exited what I can share from my experience in the agency at the time with richmond city they linked they had a different superintendent of course at the time but they leaned into the work and so you will notice that they exited in

[05:57:03] 2007 and then a decade later they came back so it's not just exiting you have to sustain those practices and when they exited a few years later they had a new superintendent and then an interim superintendent and then another superintendent and so um we see the same thing with um greensville and also with petersburg as dr ballard stated a moment ago that the transitions from superintendent

[05:57:37] to superintendent it's not just the superintendent that changes their central office leadership changes so many of the people for example in richmond that were there in 2007 when they exited a few years later they were no longer there and so that's one of the issues that we see that continues across school divisions that people have to lean into the work and you have to have a superintendent a school board and everyone along that vertical spine the school board superintendent

[05:58:13] principals teachers community students everyone has to believe that this is all of our work and if we don't see that or if we see that it is not consistent because often with mous people will be very active in the first year the superintendent will be active the school board members will be active and then throughout the process we don't see a lot of consistency and then in our agency we have change also so every four years we get a new governor and a new state superintendent

[05:58:49] and people's philosophies change and so it's change abounds and so we have to figure out a system where it can actually work regardless of who's sitting in the superintendent's seat and that's why culture is so important that you and there's this saying that if one person can make something happen or not happen then you really don't have a system you should that's that's actually a risk for an agency it's a risk for a school division if one person or two people

[05:59:24] can upset the whole apple cart and so that's why i talked about that vertical spine everyone needs to be involved in the process including our agency so that if the superintendent leaves he or she still has a great deputy superintendent um chief academic officers that can fill in so i hope that answered your question yeah i think it's just frustrating um for those of us native richmonders um because all we want is to see our city be successful um and so i know so many of us

[06:00:04] are willing to put forth whatever we have to put forth from our perspective to help make that happen um and like you said it's change that that makes things and it is fragile the whole system is very and so many components to that fragility so um thank you for that answer oh you're welcome and so my time today i'm going to spend giving you some background the history of the division level review process it actually originated in 20 2004 with the passing of house bill

[06:00:42] 1294 by the general assembly and then it was subsequently signed into law on april 15 2004 and this legislation amended the code of virginia to give the virginia board of education the authority to require division level academic reviews prior to their that time there was no such thing as a division level review and this was based on the findings of school level academic reviews because at that time schools had ratings of either accredited with warning or accreditation

[06:01:17] denied and so the findings of the review were used to determine whether one of the criteria used to determine whether or not a division would be required to enter into a MOU as a result of a division level review. This action was critical at the time because the division and we talked about this a moment ago, the division is the point of entry for school improvement, since it is the entity which influences key resources that are essential to a school's success, such as school leadership, instructional quality, personnel policies, budget, assessment practices, and

[06:01:57] curriculum. And so when you think about Richmond City, Petersburg, they've been with us for a while. when you look at some of, and even Greensville, some of the divisions that have been under an MOU for a while, you have to have all those pieces working together. So after the legislation was passed that governed the board's authority to require a division-level academic review, the board selected, developed selection criteria for which divisions would be selected for the

[06:02:33] review. And so on this particular slide, you will see that there are three, there were three selection criteria that were originally adopted by the board on June 23rd, 2004. And it's important to note that during this time, Virginia operated under two accountability systems. We had our state system, which focused on the standards of learning results. And then we had our federal system. And at that time it was the No Child Left Behind Act. The state system focused on how the whole school performed, but the federal legislation introduced the practice of disaggregating data. Prior to that

[06:03:13] time in Virginia, we did not disaggregate data. We looked at the school as a whole. And to be considered for a division-level academic review, three criteria were required that emphasized both the state and the federal accountability systems and so let's review them quickly first the school division did not meet adequate yearly progress or at that time it was referred to as ayp and with ayp you looked at how student groups performed such as your white students black economically disadvantaged students with disabilities english learners and so if a school division did not meet

[06:03:52] adequate yearly progress on the interim benchmarks in the same content area being either reading or math for two consecutive years that's the first criteria and in and if that same division had the percent of students attending schools that are not fully accredited that exceeded the statewide average and in that same division the school level academic review findings showed that the reason that schools are not accredited in the division is due to the division's non-compliance with the standards of quality and so just a moment about the school

[06:04:29] level academic review process because that was a huge part of this and with schools that were accredited with warning at the time they would be required to undergo a school level academic review we looked at curriculum alignment use of data professional development instructional practices school culture and we would send a team into the school for approximately two days and the team would conduct interviews with everyone who worked in the school we would observe in classrooms and then we would review a number of pertinent documents to determine

[06:05:05] the instructional but also the organizational factors that are impacting student achievement and so findings for the school level academic review informed whether or not we felt we needed to take a look at what's happening in a division and i'll give you a quick example in one division that where we conducted a division level review they had several schools that were accredited with warning due to science and as a result of the academic reviews across all of the schools we found something rather interesting teachers opted to spend more time with reading at the

[06:05:42] expense of science and so when we reviewed their use of time their master schedules we found that it was consistent across those schools that were accredited with warning that they were not actually teaching science and that's a school issue but it's also up here a division issue because there's someone from the division that oversees the work that the principal the principal's assistance what happens in that building someone at the division should have been aware that this was happening not just in one school but it was across multiple schools and so in that particular

[06:06:18] example we used that as one of the criteria when we were determining whether or not the division should be recommended for a review that was the original criteria but in 2012 the board at that time had to update the criteria because federal legislation changed and we transitioned from the every student succeeds at to the elementary and secondary education act flexibility waiver so virginia joined other states in requesting and receiving flexibility from certain provisions of

[06:06:54] the no child left behind act and as a result the board needed to revise their division level review selection criteria and so in the second column of this slide you'll see the updated at the time criteria and so you'll notice that the first criterion changed that the school division had not met federal benchmarks for any proficiency gap groups so that was new terminology that was added and meaning that there were groups of students there were three different gap groups you had a gap group one which was your students with disabilities your English language learners and your

[06:07:33] economically economically disadvantaged students you had your gap group two which were your black students that were also students with disabilities black students that were also students um that um were economically disadvantaged and then finally black students that were english learners and then with gap group three were your hispanic students that were students with disabilities english language learners and economically disadvantaged so if a division had had not met the proficiency the benchmarks for proficiency gap groups they were

[06:08:07] considered or in that same division if they had priority which were the bottom performing five percent of title one schools or any focus schools which were the lowest performing 10 percent of any school for proficiency gap group performance they met the first criteria the second criteria remained the same that the percent of students attending schools that were warned on the state side exceeded the statewide average and the school level academic review findings showed that the reason that the schools were struggling was because the division was not in compliance with the

[06:08:45] standards of quality and so the Virginia Board of Education makes the decision about whether or not a division will undergo a division level review but we have had some instances since 2004 where the lea actually requested the review and so for example in october of 2016 the richmond city school board voted to request that the virginia department of education conduct a division level review and so that was brought to the board on november 17 2016 and the board approved that and

[06:09:22] we conducted the review of richmond and in 2019 both prince edward county and danville city requested a division level review and so as you can see the academic review selection criteria at the time in 2004 and also in 2012 focused not on not only on our state side but also on the federal side and so now we're going to talk about moving forward if you recall from the previous slides virginia schools

[06:09:59] were governed by our accountability system requirements related to the standards of learning and also the no child left behind act and the esea or elementary and secondary education act flexibility waivers so in 20 december 2015 we transitioned from the no child left behind act to the current every student succeeds act so things changed once again and in addition there were changes at the state level for example we added the graduation and completion index

[06:10:34] and there were several revisions to our content area standards and so as a result the department determined a need to revisit the division level review process that had been in place for over a decade and so we contracted with strong and associates to take a look at what the research said about what is it and miss creasy is kind of to your question what are some things that high performing school divisions do and do well and so there was a research brief that strong and

[06:11:10] associates developed for us and what was great about the brief they identified some focus areas For example, academics and student success, leadership and governance, operations and support services, human resource leadership, and community relations and communications.

[06:11:30] And what we asked the team from Strong and Associates to do, we wanted them to look at the research, but we also wanted them to tie this to the standards of quality, what our laws say at a minimum that a school division is expected to provide.

[06:11:46] And so on this slide, you will see a crosswalk of the five areas of division level review. And so the first category is academics and student success. This category is aligned with our SOQ component related to SOL aligned instruction or standards of learning.

[06:12:08] aligned instruction, our targeted programs for gifted students, remediation programs, effective classroom instructional practices, and professional development. Because in order for a school division, any school division to make progress, you have to make sure that people are teaching from our aligned curriculum. And of course, now using our high quality instructional materials, but also what's the process for professional development in a school division?

[06:12:37] is it you go in you receive the professional development and then no one talks about it again or is there a cycle where you go you participate in the professional development you know why you are attending the professional development there are some actions for you as the participant when the professional development concludes is my principal going to come into my classroom and observe me implementing the new strategies and providing me with feedback and then at the end the day what's the nexus between my participating in this professional development practicing it

[06:13:13] and improvement at the student level in my classroom so that was the first area the second area is leadership and governance and this category emphasizes the soq components that are related to all of the people that are involved in in supporting students including the teachers the administrators the guidance counselors and paraprofessionals because before you can ensure that students have high quality instruction you have to make sure you have the right people at the table it also examines the role and the relationship between the superintendent and

[06:13:51] the local school board you would be surprised in in some of our divisions that are that have been under a division level review and are currently under a division level review some of the contributing factors is the relationship between the superintendent and the board but we also look at or look at how decisions are made in the school division is it a top-down approach is a bottom-up you know how do you involve all of the stakeholders in that process including parents and community members under operations and support services this particular category emphasizes the soq

[06:14:31] components related to processes executed in the division related to the fiscal and other resources to support student achievement. So if we're working backwards you have to have those resources to provide support to the leadership in the school and also to support academics and student success.

[06:14:51] So as you can see these different pieces should fit together and then with our next category human resource leadership i think personally this is what i consider the most important category because school divisions have to have a robust process for recruiting supporting and retaining personnel and not just in the divisions that are under a division level review process and mou that's something that's constant across the country and additionally in this particular

[06:15:26] category again we focus on how job embedded professional development and the evaluation processes are correlated with student performance outcomes and so we look at how is a teacher's evaluation connected to student outcomes so if you have all teachers that are excellent exceed standards but the school has been consistently underperforming there is misalignment there

[06:15:55] And so something that I hope you all notice across these categories, that there is a common thread that is woven between all of these, among all these categories, and that's the SOQ component, Standard 7, regarding school board policies.

[06:16:14] That's really where the rubber meets the road. The school board has to have policies regarding human resources, regarding operations and support services, regarding leadership, regarding academics and student success, because effective and current policies ensure coherence across the system.

[06:16:37] and it clarifies lines of responsibilities because sometimes when we conduct division level reviews it's not always clear who's responsible for what and so through this process we look at it like systems thinking that all of these categories are like pieces of a puzzle and they should be interconnected and once you do that you should have students that are college career and life ready and so we want to look at the relationship among all of these different categories and so we

[06:17:14] ask strong and associate and associates to help us marry the research which are the categories to our standards of quality and what they did they produced a tool for us and you all have that as your attachment one in your board packet and what they have done and this is a snapshot of one of the tools. There is a tool for each of the categories that I just reviewed with everyone, but we're just going to talk about this first one

[06:17:48] as an example. So under academics and student success, there are subcategories. You have student achievement components, professional development and support, research and innovation. Some of our divisions that have been, that undergo a a division level review have a special education corrective action plan and so we follow up with them about that and then finally the targeted component targeted

programs component and so with the division level review tools for all of the different areas we don't use all of them i'm

[06:18:27] sure you all flipped through the document and we don't have any divisions where we would use all of these what we do we look at the data over a three-year period of time and we look at what are some trends and then if you recall i talked about the academic review earlier we use the academic review findings to help us determine over a number of years what were some of the recurring themes and those are the areas that we're going to focus on and so if you look at the parts of the tool

[06:19:03] and all of the tools are are designed the same it starts out with the tool name and then it shows that it's evidence for a particular area for example academics and student success then you'll see some sample artifacts these are samples that a division may submit to us they are it's not an all exhaustive list and in some instances we tell the division what it is that we want to see during the division level review and then it is it is organized as a rubric so we look at gradations

[06:19:38] of performance across the area starting with the functional implementation we always start there and so in this particular example there are two components here under student achievement expectations for example communicates clear division vision mission and goals for student achievement to all stakeholders so say for example we looked at the strategic plan we're looking for evidence in that particular artifact that shows that there's clear division vision mission and goals and achievement for all stakeholders so we take a look at that um you get points you get two

[06:20:16] points if it's functional if we see everything is functional then we move up to full if it's not functional we move down to limited or no implementation and then in the bottom where it says evidence that's where the team enters their notes because that's going to help us develop what are called essential actions and so i'm going to quickly before i finish i'm going to quickly discuss what happens before during and after a division level review before i turn it back over to dr ballard before the review the office of school improvement director

[06:20:56] selects and trains the team members and so people in our office from the office of school improvement we would serve as the team leads and we would have representatives from other offices in the agency such as special education instruction federal program support services business and risk management, CTE technology. They serve on the team based on the tools that are selected for the division. Then we look at the academic review findings and our analysis of the three-year data

[06:21:32] trends to determine exactly which tools we want to use. And then we assign teams for each tool. So there is a team for academics and student success. If that's a tool, there's a team for leadership and governance. There's a team for operations and support services. And then we meet with the superintendent. So back in 2019, when I led the last two reviews, I met separately with the superintendents of Prince Edward and also with Danville to share the tool. And Danville actually invited me to come to their board meeting to present the entire tool during their board

[06:22:11] meeting because there was lots of interest in this process that was about to occur in their division. During the review, the team members conduct the activities. So we start out with the desk audit. So we ask the division to send us artifacts that are aligned with the areas that we're going to focus on. So we review those documents because they help us to focus on our activities once we are on site. When we're on site, we conduct interviews with the school board chair, the superintendent, division staff, parents, community members, and

[06:22:47] students. We've already talked with teachers because remember we've already conducted division level reviews. I mean school level academic reviews. We also on some occasions go into classrooms if we want to observe instruction in the schools that are accredited with warning but also in the schools that are not because sometimes we will see the same practices and just by happenstance a school that's fully accredited made it but they are using some of the same practices that led to us determining that a division level review was necessary and then

[06:23:26] we review documents. Then finally after the review all of our teams get together with their groups and they debrief based on their notes using the tool and they identify essential actions and the last two reviews we did both divisions had over 40 essential actions but we won't have 40 essential actions in the end so all of the team leads got together they met with me in a in a conference room we put up chart paper around the room and each team listed all of their essential

[06:24:06] actions and we looked for themes across the different areas so for example if i was on the team that focused on academics and student success did i see something that you saw in human resources did you see something that someone saw with operations and support services and then some themes emerged across all of the groups and then we developed the report of findings and that was written and presented to the superintendent of public instruction for review and feedback and then it was presented individually to the division superintendents to share with their local school

[06:24:45] boards and then it was presented to the virginia board and they use this information to begin development of the memorandum of understanding and yes and so we just want to pause here because we know it's a lot of information that you just received so um if there's any questions we can pause here quickly i just kind of want to go over what's on i guess slide 13 um where you're deep diving on the actual process of the review let me step back so what we've talked about is essentially

[06:25:25] self-selecting the need for a division level review in many cases right so it's not done based on continued or is it or is it not done on continued lack of accreditation or any of that so let's yeah okay add that component okay i'll i'll give you some more context often when a division and i'll just speak from my experience since 2007 often when a division elects to request a division level review they've been meeting with the director and staff in the

[06:26:04] office over a period of time and remember divisions they have their data over the summer so they know that it's coming that we may so they're weasing that you know we tell them yes we tell them that there is a high likelihood because normally and if you remember some of the dates that i share it with you they were before the public release of data so you really don't know that you're actually act you know accredited with warning until the public release many of them are proactive and they know that when the actual public release happens that the next conversation is the

[06:26:43] recommendation for a division level review we can't request it until we know for certain for example that you're going to have schools that are going to be accredited with warning and remember you have to meet number one number two and number three right we won't know that until the public release for sure so i guess sorry this is totally flipping me out today uh because the ones in the library you have to really scream into um okay so what as i'm looking at slide 13

[06:27:18] i guess my bigger question is why is doe conducting these reviews why are we not using third party we have but is that consistent third parties consistently reviewing it depends on the board and the director in the office of school improvement the state superintendent those are the people that make the

decision and so as we transition from one administration to another administration. We've had different entities predating me, and I believe the review with

[06:27:55] Franklin City, we used a third party. Okay, I just say that because those of us who live in this world of doing accreditation reviews, and those like Dr. Ackerman down there who receives accreditation reviews, we have teams that come from all over the country that come in to do those reviews from different places. And so it's really a value add more than a gotcha, right? It's a value add to be able to hear what others, their experiences are. And so I really think it would behoove us to set

[06:28:34] up a system where, because when we talk about continuous improvement, we want to hear from more than what's going on in Virginia. We want to see the best practices that are being instituted all over the country to better our practices and to improve student outcomes. So I only raise this issue because I do think that it really will make us a better system if we focus on the opportunity to use, to source outside experts come in and not just experts in Virginia, you know, to do this

[06:29:09] work. And I know it's not necessarily the cheapest thing in the world to actually do this whole process, but I mean, if you remember, you've been here long enough, you remember accreditation reviews and we didn't do it all the time, Virginia, as Virginia. We had other, we had other accreditors that did this work that went in and did reviews and our schools did have to pay for it then. Yes, it's not, it's not something that is foreign to our school divisions. So I do just think that it's really critical that we talk about that third party

[06:29:46] review process yes um that's a great point for franklin city we actually used advanced it conducted the reviews for franklin city may i madam president i i guess i mean you you may be probably i think you did already answer this but just for clarification so we stopped using sacks and other people just shifts in administration and okay yes and so and and that's one of the things that um as we were looking to do a new process that was the first thing actually that Dr. Bowlett and her team talked with me about they actually developed an RFP and like just have it

[06:30:21] waiting ready to go um until we meet with the board um and so we so that is something that has been on our um on our radar but we just have not we because with that we need to know how many schools are going to be identified how many but so third party is something that we have thought about um and then we're also prepared to keep it in house as well if I may again I have to say i mean one of my favorites is i and i'm pretty sure it has a change but cape and higher ed do kind of a combination um so they have they have some doe partners that are trained in those these

[06:31:00] doe standards right because now we've created all these amazing standards it may not match that it's in your rfp but um anyway i just a combined approach is a nice way to kind of keep the virginia identity and maybe that's why we keep going back and forth so much um so just something to think about and so just i'm going to um take us through i think you all have a pretty good understanding of the history now and so with um just some lessons learned from the these from the divisions that have successfully exited um there were a couple of key things that we noticed it

[06:31:36] was that number one uh there was a uh a staff member was in someone from the state department serving as a board member coming to their board meetings regularly you had the strong accountability from the board of ed and the state superintendent as well as with their local board and the local superintendent so it was this team approach everyone was working together um there was monthly

meetings with finance with the finance teams to make sure that the funding was was going well and that um these external partnerships and so the all of these pieces all those bullet points

[06:32:13] are what we're looking towards incorporating in the new in the in this revised approach and then just understanding that it's not going to happen in one year it shouldn't take 21 years but three to five years we should uh we plan to that they should exit and there has been success stories that we have celebrated such as with sussex county and so with the next steps um so So we have aligned, so you heard Dr. Holloman talk about how there was this, the two different systems for accountability and accreditation and federal accountability and state accountability.

[06:32:48] So because these systems we've worked so hard in Virginia to strengthen that alignment. So if you have a certain number of comprehensive support and improvement schools or an additional targeted support improvement schools, you will be an MOU school division and that will trigger the division level reviews.

[06:33:06] And so we want to make sure that we are tightly aligning the entry and the exit criteria. So as we look to do new MOUs, we really want to focus on what got you in. That is what gets you out. And our timeline. So this is the proposed timeline.

[06:33:23] If we're keeping it in-house, this is the proposed timeline that's presented on the screen where MOU divisions are identified. And then we start that whole division-level review process with the idea that, you know, that there will be an MOU come March, April after that process is complete, while recognizing that you're going through this division-level review.

[06:33:47] You have comprehensive support and improvement schools. They have requirements that need to be completed in addition to all the other requirements that may be completed, may be required from the state. And so we're really working to align all of that so it doesn't feel like you're filling out a bunch of paperwork that we're all aligned to to push forward systemic improvement and and so with the next steps we are revising the approach and we're still keeping the office of school improvement at the league coordinating the teens and there's three different the three last bullet

[06:34:22] points so as we're preparing for the accountability outcomes to be released if a new divisions if they are identified to enter mou status then we will start that division level review process we currently have divisions who are in mous if we see that from these accountability outcomes that they will still be in the mou what we're going to do is undergo a division level review process to revise the mou and then if this accountability if the outcomes of the accountability will exit the those mou divisions then we'll work with the board to to look at how we can exit them from mou status

[06:35:01] i got a couple things real quick thank you um so i i don't know i'd like to hear everybody else's comments here but i'm really stuck on the fact that i i feel strongly about a third-party review this situation here um uh i feel strongly that this the department of education can benefit from the recommendations from a third party in how it supports the schools.

[06:35:39] And I feel strongly that schools and school divisions themselves are going to get so much out of a third, so much more out of a third party than they are out of simply the department coming in and evaluating.

[06:35:55] So I guess my recommendation may be that we direct Emily Ann to Superintendent Gullickson to talk to Ms. Velasquez about an additional SOQ that would say, you know, if we are committed to school

improvement and we want to get us, we want to get every school division out of an MOU status, it is our goal to ensure that every, no school in the Commonwealth reaches is the criteria for an mo you right that we move towards this third party review process

[06:36:34] and get schools to where they need to be i'd love to hear some feedback on that miss mcpherson concern i have is that the schools that are already under an existing mou i have a feeling that maybe they should be reviewed according to internally because they already have a set of expectations and they were operating under that and then once if they get re-identified under the new category and they get thrown to a third party i'm thinking that the crisscross for

[06:37:10] them could be difficult so it could very well be that maybe with the existing ones that we might want to do those in-house i don't know how anybody else feels about it but i guess i feel like they need the most evaluation from a third party view miss ashton um i've been going through this accreditation process myself right now the benefit is it's most rigorous self-reflection process where the team is fully engaged in it and can look at the data set and so it is a lot of work

[06:37:48] but it is um i think um actionable for the people who are doing it and so i do recommend having a third party um evaluator i think you know having schools or school divisions have options in terms of who they can work with is important but if you're if you're really talking about improvement and it coming from the people who are doing the work then i don't know any other way to actually do it we can have a top-down approach which i think will have you know maybe immediate

[06:38:26] impact but for the long term the way i experience accreditation is that the people who are front and center on the ground go through it and they're able to inform their practices and they come up with real action steps so i am fully supportive of the third part or third party accreditation partners to help our schools get better madam president dr rackerman i guess something that i mean just obviously ruby knows i love that idea but but the timeline would be interesting um and so i think i have some questions around that i mean usually to gear up for accreditation

[06:39:02] they'll tell you six months to 18 months for your first visit so i think we need to remember that this is around particular criteria um and so it would really be a what you recognize as a self-study type opportunity would be really a self-study in those cri the criteria where the schools are not meeting um the benchmark uh and so i think that it's it's a means by which to build this kind of system that's sort of based on what what what you're talking about as that process of peer

[06:39:41] review okay all right so it's not the full process of you know that that long process you're you're referring to it's more around and then my next point would be is there a way we can keep this from being a yo-yo i don't know what kind of power we have it's legislative if it starts involving something else but that it you know we're not doing sex and doing then doing a peer review and then during the OE reviews and for our schools to have some consistency around it I would just make me so happy but those are my two kind of concerns President Creasy member Ackerman that as I will

[06:40:20] remind you to one of our prior presentations from our deputy superintendent is why we're really leaning in on a multi-year infusion of school improvement dollars this team has been very gracious in these nine month hustle grants and then three three months review and onboarding the new grant cycle and as i said previously but want to reiterate now that it's timely um that was one of the top recommendations when we first met on what needed to be improved so that as schools do improve they have some of that continuity even as they level up so that it's

[06:40:57] not as jolting also on some of the dollars tools and we can really embed the systems change that the board is seeking so i don't know if this is a question directly for you dr booker dwyer or dr holliman um giving her institutional knowledge and i certainly appreciate it and giving us some historical context with respect to mous and some of those very specific uh school divisions that was referenced earlier but my question is specifically pertaining uh to the city of

[06:41:33] richmond uh to the richmond uh public uh school board one of those bullet points one of those um slides that you had dr booker dwyer was uh was how some of these school divisions have successfully exited uh from the um mou do we know as of today if the city of richmond have fulfilled any of those

[06:41:59] actions where other school divisions have been successful in their exit so we're waiting to see what the data says for account the current accountability year but as we let me orient myself here to the slide that you're referencing here right those items right there a consultant that's at the school board presented at state board of education meetings etc etc we we currently

[06:42:36] do not have uh uh an education consultant that serves as an ex-officio member for that board I believe you can take a look at the MOU. I believe the MOU speaks to, it kind of outlines the requirements there. And then, you know, the monthly meetings piece has not occurred, but we continue to, you know, maintain a cadence of meeting with division level leaders, conducting and monitoring their federal schools, et cetera, not only Richmond, but the other four as well,

[06:43:12] as it are so as it is related to those corrective action plan meetings got you so i guess my other follow-up question um again based on what dr holliman was able to reference you know uh rps unilaterally uh entered into a mou with doe what 2016. um recently there's been i guess some conversation dialogue etc around the city of richmond exiting from the mou um based on any of your dialogue or meetings or contact with RPS. And I think in that original MOU, they agreed,

[06:43:52] signed off the school board, the superintendent to 100% of the schools being fully, 100% of the schools being SOL credited. In your recent dialogue, if there's been any, have they been able to give any substantial rationale as to why they should be exit from the MOU and why they shouldn't be held to that hundred percent goal right so we are in the process of uh releasing the new accountability data which is going to um identify school divisions um and so if we look at

[06:44:28] so so richmond currently has an mou if it is identified under our new accountability system when we release those results then we will um revisit their mou to revise it and so that's kind of where we are right now with so we're just waiting on that accountability data to come out because what we don't want to have happen is to say okay you you exit and now the data comes out tomorrow and you're i'm not saying it's coming out tomorrow i'm just saying the data comes out and then you're re-identified and so um we really want to see that accountability data to see where the school divisions falls to see how many uh comprehensive support improvement schools have

[06:45:04] been identified in richmond because that will determine whether or not they stay in mou status okay thank you any other questions before they exit okay we're going to take a quick break and

[06:45:22] then reset for essa for everyone in um watching from the public we are going to move item j the

[07:00:03] performance task overview and next steps that presentation will take place during our business meeting tomorrow we are moving to item k um the essa update so mr jennings take it away president creasy superintendent gullickson board members thank you for having me today we will be discussing amendment nine to Virginia's consolidated state plan or ESSA plan uh today I'll be speaking specifically to changes in under the title one section accountability uh there will be other changes that will come before the board in future meetings and today in this work session we're just talking through some of the proposed changes as we move into the public comment phase again we

[07:00:41] did discuss this in June I was with you in October and so we've discussed these items but we want to bring more details to you and so the public has transparency and knows uh just what's for consideration. So the outline for today's presentation is to share with you the purpose for seeking the amendment, the stakeholder engagement we've done thus far and will continue to do, the overview of the proposed revisions, and the process and timeline for Amendment 9 that will include other areas as I mentioned. So when we talk about the purpose, when the board adopted the framework, the school performance support framework, the board identified areas

[07:01:17] for future consideration. They said we're going to look at things after the first year for year two and beyond. They noted at that time areas they wanted to talk about during the adoption initially, and so we're bringing those before you now. Secondly, in our Amendment 7, we noted to USED that we would return with data to answer some of the questions around pieces that were adopted in the framework, and so that's another reason for this amendment. And then thirdly, from public comment, stakeholder engagement, there have been questions, feedback about maybe making some tweaks in some of their areas so it's an opportunity to look at the first year of implementation

[07:01:55] full implementation and to see about making revisions in that area as well so stakeholder engagement we've been ongoing with stakeholder engagement again throughout the year there's regular meetings with school division leaders getting feedback the superintendent has a superintendent's council we met with the virginia association of secondary principals around some of these changes we met went to the vast conference a few weeks ago esea coordinators academy title three consortium, CTE conference, just to name a few. So there's been ongoing public engagement with some of these proposals, really since June, and we've continued and we will continue with

[07:02:33] presentations, listening sessions and public comment moving forward. So I'm going to go through each of the components to sort of seek them sequence for you and then pause and take questions as they develop. And so the first one we'll look at is a mastery index. When we adopted this a year ago, we looked at, you know, some tests have four performance levels. You know that from all your conversation with the proficiency cut scores, and some assessments have three. And so to bring balance to the system, the proposal is that for assessments with three performance levels, and you see those listed here, our EOC test, history, social science, Virginia alternate

[07:03:11] assessment program, the VAP test, that we would use three weights. So we would keep the one point, the 1.25, the change is that we would go from a 0.75 to a 0.5 to bring some more variability and some balance to the system. So that's one of the proposed changes. Next, we want to talk about science. So with the changes to the performance levels, grade five and grade eight science only had three performance levels. And we got feedback on, you know, reading and math have four performance levels. Why doesn't science in the elementary and middle schools? And so we work with our and we use some methodology. You see it listed there, the chance cut, standard error of measurement.

[07:03:49] We look to see students who are not successful, where do we know they're guessing versus they have content knowledge? Where do you draw that line between below basic and basic? And so our psychometricians met and they analyzed the data and you see their proposals there that with their methodology, 95% probability of knowing about grade level science than would be expected by chance.

[07:04:11] and that was using this methodology. And so you see the tables below grade five science would be below basic zero to 355, basic 351 to 399, grade eight science below basic zero to 370 and basic 371, 399. What this will allow is that for students who are not successful on the science test, they can earn the 0.75 because as I shared with you the slide before, you know, three performance levels is a 0.5. So now we're increasing opportunities for these students, but also the four performance levels really helps you differentiate data to really see where

[07:04:44] students are. And so this is a proposal, a revision that the field has given us positive feedback on to sort of really see where students are in science and bring alignment between our reading math science grades, really three through eight. Now, this slide looks a little overwhelming. You've got quite a bit of language from USED, ESSA, the Every Student Succeeds Act. And what this is stating that under federal law, schools are required and student groups have 95% participation.

[07:05:16] That was in ESSA that was signed in 2015, implemented in 2017. And so you have non-participants and participants. Either a student takes the test or doesn't take the test. And if they do not take the test, they're a non-participant and they're a score of zero. Now we have Virginia statute you see listed there around parent refusals. These are parents who select to, we don't call it opt out they're refusing for their child to take the assessment. And you have the language there that the board shall not include in its calculation and the passage rate student calculations of parents who refuse. But you see, unless it would result in the school not meeting any required

[07:05:54] state or federal participation rate. So we can remove zeros from parent refusals if the school is over 95%. And when our meetings, our consultations with USED, they've been very consistent across the nation about this 95%. There is no waiver. There's many dear colleague letters very much. They say there's a 5% allowance. That is what you get. There are, there's no exceptions. Whether it's parent refusals, absences, medical emergencies, you have 5%.

[07:06:21] The incentive is to test the students and see where they are. And so they're very firm on that. So we have to obviously abide by that. And so we want to be clear about students who are scoring zero Y, you know, where that's coming from. So we are honoring state law as we're allowed under the federal. And so we're meeting both. But we want to be clear about the 95% participation.

[07:06:43] And I want to also share with you that Virginia is committed to developing Ready for Life graduates. We have a profile of Virginia graduate that was developed long ago in partnership with the Board of Education, General Assembly, working with the department and stakeholders. And so you see here the Board of Education determined that a life-ready Virginia graduate achieves and applies appropriate academic and technical knowledge demonstrates productive workplace skills qualities and behaviors builds connections and values interactions with others as a responsible and responsive citizen we think of community engagement and civic responsibility and aligns

[07:07:19] knowledge skills and personal interests with career opportunities career exploration we do this in multiple ways throughout the department uh throughout the child's school you know even before we talk about uh jenna conway talks about you know pre-k the work that they do in early childhood we think

about all the experiences our academic career plan uh the way through our 3e framework to encourage community engagement and civic responsibility and so this is built in we talk about the five c's across the board and the importance of that collaboration citizenship communication and all those areas critical critical thinking as well i want to share that because we get to our next slide about a proposal that we have and i also want to share

[07:07:58] about house bill 1957 which i know you've heard of and we brought some information before you in that legislation that was signed that's effective july 1st 2026 the board will develop guidelines around local alternative assessments and performance assessments and through there we're standardizing these local alternative assessments performance-based assessments and that's what the legislation requires that the department will do work the board will adopt it will be sent back to local school divisions and so that's going to be important for the next slide I share with you in sort of moving forward. This is work that's been done and ongoing with subject

[07:08:34] matter experts in the area of history. You can see that they have participated in consultant, consulted in the work around the 2023 history, social science standards of learning, the instructional guide work, the re-release of instructional guides is upcoming and those stakeholders being involved in that process. And then our last bullet there talks about Virginia educators, including subject matter experts in these several content areas, we have new assessments in these areas using the 2023 standards. So this spring, students will take a new test in history

[07:09:10] in the areas of Virginia studies, civics and economics, world geography, world history, world history too, and then Virginia and U.S. history. So these are new assessment items. They're not just multiple choice. They have technology enhanced. They were developed in partnership with our educators, and they will go live. They've been field tested, but they will be operational this spring. And so I share with you all that background because now I move to the idea of the indicator in history and social science. And so our proposal is that next year, beginning in 2026, 2027, Virginia will calculate a mastery index to measure student performance.

[07:09:48] We will use the Virginia Studies SOL test in elementary school. Middle school would use the and Economics SOL test, high school would use the Virginia U.S. History SOL test. Now these tests do use the three performance levels as I mentioned before. The department would continue work to develop a new VAP, a Virginia Alternate Assessment Program test for students who qualify. There's a criteria set for those students. Now I want to jump back. I know I've just given you so much information, but I want to lay the foundation for you as we talk about House Bill 1957 because part of our conversation is these SOL tests are standardized. This is, you know, how we can look

[07:10:25] statewide at reliable, consistent data, which is required both by federal law, Every Student Succeeds Act, and it's also in our regulations. Our regulations talk about the board having authority to include new indicators if it meets certain criteria, and this does meet that criteria.

[07:10:42] For us to use a performance-based assessment or local alternative assessment, we would need data, consistent statewide data. And through House Bill 1957, we can begin that process. The board can adopt guidelines, we can have consistent scoring rubrics, we can collect data and make sure it's consistent statewide and reliable. We need some years of data for that. And then we can take it to USDD and ask for permission to use that as our assessment. So I want to share with you the pathway for that. But to begin,

we need to begin with our assessments that we do have that meet the criteria set forth by both federal and our regulations.

[07:11:17] Mark, is there a means by which we can create some kind of document that shows pre-House Bill 1957 and what House Bill 1957 changed? Yes. I think that would clarify some things for a lot of the communication that has been received because I think it's either misinformed or not fully informed communication that we've received, and I don't know if you've seen any of it, and if you would agree at that.

[07:11:48] I think it would be an excellent idea, and we certainly can, because I do think the misunderstandings or the misinformation around what House Bill 1957 does, the authority of the board there about developing guidelines, the consistency that's embedded there around these local alternative assessments and performance-based assessments, the scoring rubrics, is to bring what we would need to then move forward to make the performance-based assessments used statewide, we could bring into the accountability system so it's lined up very very well but i think the misunderstanding of those terms and not reading the legislation carefully i think people uh have there's misunderstanding and so we would be happy to show sort of what's there and then what's to

[07:12:25] come and it's in alignment with this i do want to show you the proposed weights with this model again this would be for 26 27 you see in red there the changes in the weights reading and math mastery you see and i'll explain those as i go to some other items but you see virginia studies there in elementary school with 5%. You see in middle school 7.5% for civics economics. I'll explain that. You see in high school, Virginia U.S. history, 5%. So now I haven't talked about it yet, but since you're looking at the screen, if you're sort of looking at points, readiness is 5% for integrated reading and writing, which I will speak to later. And then you see the same for

[07:13:05] middle school. So where are the points coming from? So elementary school science is a cumulative assessment. It's three years of material, third, fourth, and fifth grade. And so it is weighted 10%. Virginia studies would be one year of content. It's 5%. Middle school, we know the importance. If you watch the news, I read to you about the five C's profile of graduate. I think we can all agree the importance of civics and I think economic literacy as well. And so the proposal is 7.5% there. You'll see some points from reading were moved to integrated reading of writing, which I'll speak to later. And I'll share with you some thoughts around chronic

[07:13:41] absenteeism. High school biology is a one-year assessment. It's one year of content. It had been 10%. Our proposal is to give 5% to Virginia U.S. history, which is also one year of content. And so hopefully as you look at that, you see the balance of why aren't they all the same?

[07:13:57] Why is science weighted more? And so that was the thinking behind the point distribution. I'm going to pause there because I realize there's quite a bit of content. We're going to leave master in a moment to go to growth, but I'm going to pause there for any questions or comments you might have. Mr. Jennings, one of the questions that's come up from email correspondence from constituents is around if we include civics and economics, is that going to force folks to change their master schedule and calendar into either seventh grade only, eighth grade only? Can you address that briefly? Absolutely. So state statute talks about the flexibility local school divisions

[07:14:35] have for their master schedule. And this is not requiring school divisions to give the assessment of seventh grade or eighth grade. They would maintain that flexibility. And so we're not stating

there has to be a move in your master schedule. We're just saying during the time of middle school that this assessment is administered. May I? Dr. Ackerman? Maybe this is later in the slide, but is there a timeline on, is this, has this been, I feel like this is the first time being presented correct no this has been i brought this to the board back in june and so i presented

[07:15:12] to the secondary principals i presented to the superintendents and so i'm bringing it again so we've had conversations they're ongoing and even today it's a work session it's ongoing conversation and so as we've talked with stakeholder groups and gotten feedback how many points and where does it fit things like that this again is to continue that conversation so from here one of my last slides is next steps there will be future stakeholder engagement and we'll bring more people to the table especially in these areas and hear from them about this but the the items in red wish or were those in june as well and they were in june as well okay thank you um how many other

[07:15:51] states include history in their state accountability some question we've been researching that and sort of which state scan you look at and when they last looked at state plans you get different numbers um so i don't want to give you a precise number but there are definitely we saw uh definitely over 10 sometimes we saw up to 24 and it varied when they did it some did it uh during high school they used it in the high school as far as uh readiness especially even with the civics or the u.s history or government uh and so we saw it in different places but that is something we're continuing to provide for the board to say how many states do this and when do they do it but like i said we looked at different state scans and the numbers based on when they did it the numbers

[07:16:28] varied should i notice before the mastery index um for the three subjects can you talk a little bit more about what that so yes so we have our reading and math test have four performance levels so as you know you just did the cut scores you have below basic basic proficient and advanced our end of course test uh currently our science test uh the history test that only had three performance levels so it was students who fail students who pass students who pass advanced and And so the proposal here is that to help with the weight distribution, currently it was if students

[07:17:06] failed, they got a 0.75. And so there was no differentiation of how you failed. Did you get a 399 or did you get a 200? And so they're all getting 0.75. So to balance the calculations, the proposal is to do a 0.50, half a point. Right. So going back, it's for the areas of, it'd be end of course, your high school test, VAP, our alternate assessments, and then history.

[07:17:33] Those would be the tests, which really is the only change is changing the 0.75 to 0.50. We're not changing how the tests have had performance levels. Well, the next slide, talk about science. That would be a change making 5th and 8th grade go to 4. We have the non-test history.

[07:17:52] Yes. My other question is, you talked about we've already got new tests, redesigned. Yes. So did we just break the trend line, or how much did we change that? yeah so we we can provide data on that it was a whole new right rewrite of the standards of 2023 so it's been a while since they've had new assessments and so that committee had not met for a while reading and math every year they meet so this committee had not met for a while so they did meet they looked at it you'll see in my presentation tomorrow with the performance task i'm going to talk about some of the new items in that uh i know a little preview they created

[07:18:29] cluster sets very much like the new science test to really get kids to think more critically and to think more deeply. So these are new assessments. They were field tested, but I just bringing that to the

board's attention, even the public around, you know, it's not the old multiple choice sort of rote memorization that I've heard. It's a new redesign of the assessment. And the practice items are out there. They can be seen by the public to what that looks like. SCAR-TAC can still compare the last of its best. Sometimes when you change so many items, you've broken the tree, just not

[07:19:03] comparable after this iterated reliability stuff that equates the last test to this um so anyway it just would be good I mean we have the same conversation uh on different about different tests um and it's like even on the Nate like if we change so many items we break the trend line so we're always talking about okay how many 30 items we can change I mean so it's always a dance in terms of how to keep the trend line so I'll be just curious what they say about that so just to remind everyone in our June board meeting packet in the public comment section, although we had

[07:19:38] talked about it along for two years about adding history, it never got accomplished under the request that had been going on because of someone else who was here. And so there was a letter that was issued to the board by Senator Van Valkenburg, specifically requesting this addition. And that was part of our public comment packet in June. And it's just, I think it's something that

[07:20:13] holistically is an important piece that needs to be a part of our system as we move forward, just simply based on the fact that we are Virginia and we love our history.

[07:20:32] You're welcome. Are there any questions on the mastery? Because if not, I'll move to growth. And you can always go back if you want. I'm going to move to growth as we talk about growth in reading and mathematics. And so again, you see the headline there, transparently measuring growth.

[07:20:52] Our proposals to you is to use the word return to the progress value tables. These measures where students are on the performance levels based on their test scores. And you can denote when they move from one level or one range year over year. This again, as you see in the second bullet, we shared this at our last meeting with you in October, but the value tables were recommended by our TAC, our Technical Advisory Council, and as they looked at the data, they had our conversations with us, the transparency, consistency, the familiarity of Virginia, the statistical reliability, they evaluated those measures. Again, this would allow us to use value tables both for

[07:21:30] SOL test and VAP. Our current vendor or previous vendor using the value added was unable with their formula to come up with a formula to use VAP. And so we use progress tables for VAP and we use value added for the SOL test. So this would allow us to use one consistent metric across. When we have talked with educators, again, the stakeholder engagement ongoing, their thoughts around the better communication with families and the public. They can plan ahead and know where the targets are.

[07:21:56] They can calculate their data more quickly. Again, that word transparency. And I should share with you too, the department head of the, actually the general assembly had requested a study back in 2016 for the department to investigate growth models. And so they funded a study and looked at value added. They looked at student growth percentile, they looked at progress tables. And at that time, the conclusion was very similar to where we are today, that progress tables or value tables were the best fit for Virginia. And so the appendix, the very end of the presentation does show you the current progress or value tables. And I'm using those terms because the literature calls

[07:22:33] them value tables. But if you go out, you know, to any school or principal, they know them as progress tables. So I'm trying to, I want to honor that. And so the reading and mathematics that are on a

vertical scale, which you'll see in the demonstration. So these are our proposed calculations. What I'll say to you is when we use these in the past, the way it worked, a number of pieces that are important for you to know is it was only being calculated for students who had failed. So when this was used in the past in Virginia, it was only students who failed.

[07:23:02] And the rule, the calculation was, if you moved up one range, then you received a point. That was it. I mean, it was simple, simple to know. But as I show you this, you might go, this is very complicated. And we showed this to the superintendents a few weeks ago. But in complexity, we're honoring more where students are. And I think as the superintendents saw it, that we've received very positive feedback about this and so we open it to the public for additional feedback as well so when you see this if we begin we've got it highlighted here and animated for you that in our first range a student who regresses or move it back on this vertical scale from year over year then they're receiving no points it's very clear the student did not grow they regressed

[07:23:41] and so i think you would understand why the student would not receive any points and that's something we definitely draw attention to in our next example here a student is not passing so if if you look at the way it's set up below basic basic proficient advanced the eight ranges each performance level is divided into two subsections and so ranges one through four these students did not pass they were not proficient and so this student in range four did not pass year over year and so we're giving some partial growth it didn't pass but they maintained and so the next assessment it's vertically aligned it's a little more challenging and so there's half a point there

[07:24:19] In our next example, this student is proficient, but you notice the proficiency went down. And so maybe they scored 489 in one year, and the next year they score closer to the 400. And so in that example, the student, again, you see regression.

[07:24:34] And so it's not a one-point value because, yes, the student did pass, but could you really say they grew when we have clear regression? They went down on the vertical scale. And so this student has a 0.75. And in this example, a student is scoring advanced. They're not all the way advanced.

[07:24:50] There's two subsections in advanced. they're in range seven not in range eight and so year over year they're receiving a point again they pass the test uh and they're advanced in both years but there still was room to grow they did not grow and so they receive a point i'll take you to the next slide now in this example you'll see a student moves from one range to another range and when they do that they're receiving a point so this student still did not pass but they moved from one range to another so we are seeing some growth on the vertical scale so they receive a point. In the next example we have a student moving

[07:25:27] from basic and this is true of any of the ranges one through four. My example is just you know showing you the line but this student did not pass the test and in the spring of the next year they did pass the test and so you see it's a 1.25. The student moved from failing in one year to the next year passing and so we've given an additional quarter of a point to show that recognition of failure to proficient. Our old system, when we use this, didn't even, wasn't even used for students who had passed. It was only used for students who failed. So this is a change that we've received positive feedback on. And then you see in this example, similarly, a student who scores proficient

[07:26:03] in one year and then scores advanced in the next year, again, 1.25. When we think about the guiding principles of the board and the accountability system was to motivate, move students to advanced

mastery over growth. We will emphasize growth, but we really want to incentivize proficiency in advance. And so you see that here with the 1.25 value. And then finally, you see advanced the highest end. This is the students at the top of the range for that year. The next year, they take the assessment. They're still in the top of the range. There's nowhere else to grow. They might still grow within that range, but they're at the high end. And so they would receive a 1.25.

[07:26:39] And so, as you see, I know it looks very complicated, many animations, much movement, but in that complexity, we're trying to honor where the students are in the different movement and honor the growth that they've made. So what this looks like, as you see in the next slide, I'm going to show you one more example, and that is this student who moves two ranges.

[07:27:01] And so, again, not just moving one range, but moves two ranges, this student earns a 1.25. They moved, in this example, from range two to range four. Still did not pass, but that's tremendous growth within a year. And so they received 1.25.

[07:27:18] And so you'll see with the weights, there's no proposal to change the weights for growth. What we're changing is how we calculate growth. It's very individualized. You can see it's very predictable. As schools know where the students are, they would have access to the vertical scales. And as the results come in, they could see exactly where students are.

[07:27:35] set goals, smart goals with the students and families for that ease of communication. So I'll pause here on growth and take any questions you might have. Dr. Northern. I just feel philosophically, I'm trying to wrap my head around to stay in the same range, get 0.5, 0.7, haven't grown, haven't lost, but you haven't grown.

[07:28:06] So I guess I could make the case that that should be zero too. So I guess talk to me a little bit about thinking there, because in my mind, if we call it growth, didn't grow, but you still get, I guess, to talk through that. But philosophically, I get that we need to be careful with that. Excellent, excellent questions here. So the vertical scale is important, and I can put a demonstration for you next time we meet. Very much picture a trend line. And so, again, with that vertical scale, you're starting at, in our example, we go from

[07:28:41] 900 to 2,000. And so with that, the next year, you're expected to grow, as you know, but also you're getting a more challenging assessment at the end of our sol test there are six additional items and those items are either above grade level below grade level or on grade level they do not count in the student's scaled score so the cut score conversation all the work the zero to 600 they do not factor into that they are used strictly for this and so with those our vertical scale becomes more precise and so we're able to use that to see with this partial growth a student staying in that range again it's a range there's some calculations to say there was minimal growth

[07:29:18] so not as much as we would want to move into a new range but there was some minimal growth with a new assessment and these six items we can see sort of with the off grade level questions how below grade level how much on grade level how much above grade level and so for those factors because some this we're calling it again a progress table or value table with the vertical scale it's a little different because of those factors and so that that's our rationale for adding the 0.5 maintaining that range saying with these six additional items are actually i mean that's informing yes 0.5 you actually do have some data that says that within that range they were closer

[07:29:57] to growing than not right and that's a part of that computer adaptive test so it uses the data from the test you took and then the last six questions the students know that everyone knows the last six questions do not count but it's informed by the previous from the scaled score the previous items you were assessed on and then it sees you know if we're going to go below grade level how far below grade level and if we're going to be on or above how far can we go so those six items inform this vertical scale so when you see it in the appendix i know it'll be confusing like wait we've been talking about zero to 600 and now we see 900 to 2 000 that's why it's again going all the way through it's a through line but it's also using those six items to see more precisely

[07:30:34] where should you fit they don't have that's probably it depends on the school the division we provide that transparently it's in our test blueprint it talks about it but yes i i mean for better data yeah we would like the students to stay the best do the best they can throughout

[07:30:50] any other questions mark i think we're gonna go up to 3e and then halt and finish the presentation tomorrow if you don't mind so we'll we'll get through the integrated reading and writing and then halt there if you don't mind so we'll talk about readiness we're going through our major

[07:31:30] components we've done uh mastery we've done uh growth we'll do readiness and so we'll talk about advanced coursework uh you'll see here in science and i want to be clear it's in bold for you there uh the proposal that in 26 27 so this would be two years from now that we'll be talking about students in grade eight who are ready to take high school or science uh would take that assessment in grade eight need to be clear that both under federal and state law students will be required to take the grade eight assessment first they would be required for the grade six science content, life science, and physical science. You're not going to wait in 27, 28 or 26. Oh,

[07:32:07] my apologies. Thank you. So two years from now. Years from now. So 27, 28. Thank you. Yes. We're very, yes. I need to be very clear about that. So in 27, 28 school year, two years from now, uh, to prepare students, give time for master scheduling, preparation, acceleration. Uh, so yes, thank you. And so you see there again, that, that very important first bullet, uh, around the sequencing that could be done to accomplish this so that earth science could be assessed during middle school with students have already taken the grade eight science because the grade eight science is accumulative over those three areas and then students would be able to take the earth

[07:32:42] science the indicator here is important it's twofold first is performance well how did the students do if they took the earth science assessment how did they do the second is access how many students had access to the course and so we're looking at that as far as you know looking across the board at Fairness looking to see that it meets the requirements under ESSA as far as the indicator being available to all students. Also in 27-28, school year 27-28, let me be clear about that, we also have the proposal for world geography. So again, this is not given to a specific grade

[07:33:22] level. It says students who are ready for world geography, they could do it different times at the middle school level. And so again, also during middle school, they take the civics economics test

[07:33:32] You see the similarity there. Performance will be measured by their proficiency on the assessment and then also students who have access. And so we're looking to see how many students are enrolled. I'll say to you with both of these, we have school divisions doing this. This is not such a surprise. We have school divisions who do this in some of their schools who do it division-wide, do it in different

ways. And so we have data on that. More students are taking world geography than world history. That was a question we'd received before. We talked about this back in June and we brought this forward.

[07:34:02] you know why world geography and not world history i share with you some of the instructional concerns around world history but more students at the middle school are taking world geography right now than in world history one and so that is the proposal again in two years to provide school sufficient time to plan accordingly and then we talk about the integrated reading writing which i know we talked about last board meeting uh in this uh proposal yes um so just talking about this advanced course work in the world geography i know that's been somewhat of a sticking point

[07:34:38] for some school divisions or not school divisions but we've heard from some social studies teachers that there are issues here i would say that i think we have that that's kind of fizzled out a bit but i know you've seen some of those um communications too so um i'd like for you to comment here on that particular those particular issues that have been raised um but also you know i feel strongly that this course particularly world geography and i mean i also feel strongly

[07:35:14] about my civics and economics course but um both of them are crucial to the underpinning of a strong foundation in social in the social sciences these students are going into high school taking world history one world history two and if they don't have a strong understanding of world geography or even the opportunity to take that course it it hurts it hurts the future of their success in world history one and world history two so and dr northern might have some further comments on

[07:35:53] that i don't know but um uh so i'd just like to hear your comments on that too i would echo what you shared and even as we talk with school divisions who do this that is the rationale as well um that we have students who are ready for this and some divisions you know that they do this division wide and the thinking is this helps prepare students for the world today we live in a global society we know you turn as any news and you're seeing what's happening other countries at lightning speed and so our students need to know how the world has changed country lines have changed and so to prepare them for that when they go into high school and start connecting even more in the content areas especially world history they have some background knowledge to these lines and cultures and understanding we talk about the diversity of virginia diversity of the world

[07:36:32] that geography is going to help you with that to understand you know just through time countries and cultures and sort of you know respecting others through that so we've received again uh with that curriculum it also has a new assessment as well that they worked very hard on uh to really understand sort of the content uh and assess you know the content of it but it's everything you shared really preparing kids you know you think about our students today we want more pathways for students 3e has been very very much embraced i think soon when you see the data you'll see very strongly and we were at the supertents association they they had a whole session on 3e they offered

[07:37:11] ideas but you do see how that's implemented as pathways for students and where they are exploring not putting them on track but exploring and so what we're offering here through advanced coursework are more pathways there are students who are ready and so what we're saying is do not hold them back this is a pathway for students to offer it for them if they're ready to help them be successful in high school to explore other other areas well and not only that let's double down on the fact that this is advanced this is not standard course um and so i think there's a really big difference there if this was a requirement for standard coursework that would be very a very different

[07:37:45] conversation um dr northern is this ap no okay that's my biggest concern because we have a gold standard for advanced placement at high school so i'm worried that this is going to water down because that's what happens right um advanced and i think that's a real danger especially if we're not using ap and i don't see a reason why we couldn't be using ap i'm sure you know there's probably reason but um i guess i i just feel like what are we going to start just kind of you know

[07:38:25] putting advanced you know things on courses without them actually being vetted by the college board and being advanced okay this is this course is not taught in high school this is a course that's being taught in eighth grade all right yes no no it yes it's a high school course offered to middle school students we're calling it advanced coursework in the accountability system because it's advanced because it's not in the middle school sequencing it's the high school course coming down to middle school so that's the advanced piece it's the high school class for that middle schoolers are taking

[07:39:04] just like your algebra one it's your algebra one algebra two geometry that middle school students take earth science is a high school class that middle school students take that world geography is a high school class that middle school students take week week yeah but to your point it might keep them from taking the sorry excuse me now um it wouldn't okay like they would then later choose not to take AP geography because they took it I don't even know that there are any offers of AP world geography I would have to look and see but with students having if students are able to

[07:39:41] complete more high school coursework during middle school it frees up credits in high school to have more time to explore other areas which could be AP and they could do dual enrollment I mean you realize there's only so much time in a schedule and so again as students are being asked I want to do AP dual enrollment even CTE by doing more in middle school you free up your schedule so students could take more AP dual enrollment let's just keep an eye on whether we're changing the syllabus right because it should be the same I guess that's you know what I mean like you can have something be called something absolutely and I really appreciate your lens there I mean advanced coursework's the indicator because it's a middle school uh if a student is enrolling it

[07:40:19] it's called world geography we don't call it advanced world geography anything like that we don't send a message to parents that it is and it's advanced because it's a high school class but we don't call it like there's a special advanced world geography it's just world geography

[07:40:29] Great question. So integrated reading and writing. This is an assessment that's been operational since 2024. Their proposal is, you know, students have been using it at the schools, looking at the data. We've not, we've had different conversations on how it might fit. Would it fit in reading? You know, again, you brought up concerns on the longitudinal data and how we would maybe for those two grade levels, fifth and eighth grade, provide that information. And so the proposal is next year, want to be clear about 26, 27, that this would be in readiness.

[07:41:02] it is a cumulative assessment it's it's looking at really k through five reading writing the integration of those areas this assessment again the way it works is students read they uh something a passage on history or science content they have some questions technology enhanced items and then they respond to a prompt and so we're looking to see are they ready for the next level uh and so it would happen at fifth and eighth grade uh as a way to make sure they're ready for the next level which would be either middle school or high school and so you see the weights once

[07:41:37] again again to be clear about the dates here uh these weights for 27 28 and what you're seeing in this change is uh as we move now talking about advanced coursework is you're seeing math would be six percent currently it's ten percent you would see science is two percent one percent access one percent performance and then the history the world geography would be two percent broken down again performance and access the integrated reading and writing again would have been offered in 2627 of the year prior we we had talked around you know it's a readiness factor should the five percent come from chronic absenteeism and come from reading and i'll say to

[07:42:14] you you know as we talked about this and you probably recall uh the past couple years talking about the weights in the framework you know people had great concerns around chronic absenteeism great concerns uh and in the old system i think because post pandemic if you had a level three you were conditioning credit you know just the way the old system did not differentiate uh performance the feedback we received is we have more control of chronic absenteeism we can offer recovery we're seeing gains and so the feedback we received was do not make chronic absenteeism five percent elementary middle school keep it ten percent now we're going to put this out for public comment we'll hear from more uh but that was some surprising feedback we received was you know we

[07:42:54] We really think chronic absenteeism is a school-wide effort. And so we'd like to see that continue to be weighted more significantly. And so, you know, initially we had thought it was going to be 5% across the board for all the models. You know, high school is 5%, elementary and middle. But the feedback we received was, no, make it, keep it 10.

[07:43:10] You know, it's a whole school effort. We're putting all this initiative into it. We've had the all-in. Let's continue that and keep it 10%. And so 5% came from the reading as there's a partnership between the integrated reading, writing, and the reading assessment. so again to be clear about dates this is the proposal to begin in 27 28 so schools have time to prepare for this scheduling communication parents all the necessary steps so we're going to go to 3e or did you want to all right we do we have any questions before we pause for the death

[07:43:47] yeah just go ahead is the the advanced in history is it similar to what we're doing in math where the denominator is just the kids who have already taken x y course and no this this one it's a one percent it's an access it's basically students who just enroll math is students who take the course the advanced course but also we said if a student scored advanced in seventh grade math the expectation is they're ready to move into algebra this there is no sort of enrollment factor it's just students who elect to enroll in it and do they have to pass it the calculation does use the

[07:44:23] percent of students who do pass so there is there so if you put students that are not successful that percentage would be in your calculation so it is it's meant to be for students who are ready but there's no sort of, you know, we're directing who's ready. That would be a local school decision or local, well, the school or school board. No disincentive. Well, it could be if the students aren't ready and they're not successful in the assessment, then they would see the percentage with a decrease in mastery. So it would affect you there. I mean, it's intended for students who are ready. So it's sort of, you just want to make sure students are ready for it. Small. Yeah, I was

[07:45:00] just trying to figure out how, because we always got to think about incentives, right? Incentives now just to put all the kids in a lot of participation and they do have to pass they do get negatively right and i'll add this as well we do have divisions like i shared using this and currently we if moving forward we

would ask for a waiver from uscd we do not count the earth science eoc assessment so if we move in this direction we would apply for a waiver from uscd to calculate earth science which you're seeing it how it works in advanced coursework it would also help those

[07:45:36] students in science mastery because there are schools right now who give the grade eight science tests in seventh grade their students take earth science in eighth grade we cannot use that assessment if we move forward on this it helps those divisions those schools who do it again whether it's all students some students so it would help in advanced coursework but also it would help them in mastery other questions here before we pause for the day thank you mr jennings we will pause and pick up with three readiness tomorrow um once we get to that point in our

[07:46:12] agenda. I will inform everyone at that time when we'll move into that particular presentation. So thank you all. We will pick up tomorrow. Good night.